MUSTARD SEED INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL

Cambridge International Education Centre | Nakuru, Kenya
"A Home of Quality, Fun and Care"

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURES

OPERATIONS MANUAL

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SECTION A: ACADEMIC PROCESSES

SOP 01: Student Admission

Purpose: To establish a consistent, fair and thorough process for admitting new learners to MSIS, ensuring that all applicants are appropriately assessed and all required documentation is in place before the learner joins the school.
Scope: Applies to the Admissions Officer, Receptionist, Head of Section (HOS), Accountant and Head of Centre (HOC). Covers all new learner admissions from initial enquiry through to the first day of school.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Enquiry — Parent contacts the school to inquire about admission	Enquiry Register	Receptionist / Admin	1. Missed or incomplete information given to the parent during the enquiry 2. Parent contacts multiple channels and receives inconsistent information 3. Enquiry not recorded; no follow-up action taken 4. Parent given incorrect dates or fee information, leading to confusion	1. Maintain an up-to-date enquiry register; assign a staff member to respond same day 2. All enquiries to be routed through a single designated contact point 3. Record every enquiry in the register with date, parent name, and outcome 4. Provide parents with an official information pack containing accurate current details	Same day of enquiry
2	Filling of Assessment Form — Parent completes the assessment form	Assessment Form	Parent / Admin	1. Incomplete or inaccurate details submitted on the assessment form 2. Parent does not understand sections of the form and leaves them blank 3. Form submitted with missing medical or emergency contact information 4. Incorrect year group entered, leading to placement in the wrong assessment	1. Verify the form before accepting it; guide the parent through each section if needed 2. Provide a bilingual or simplified guide for parents who need assistance 3. Make medical information and emergency contacts mandatory before form is accepted 4. Admin to cross-check the year group against the learner's date of birth before submission	Same day of assessment
3	Assessment Fee — Accountant collects and receipts the assessment fee	Receipt	Accountant	1. Wrong amount collected due to outdated fee schedule being used 2. Payment not receipted immediately; cash goes unrecorded 3. Parent disputes the fee amount after payment has been made 4. Duplicate receipting of the same payment	1. Cross-check the fee schedule with the current approved rate before collecting payment 2. Issue an official receipt immediately upon receiving any payment; no exceptions 3. Display the assessment fee prominently and confirm verbally with parent before payment 4. Use a sequential receipt book or system; check the last receipt number before issuing a new one	At the time of fee collection
4	Assessment Test — HOS administers the assessment to the learner	Assessment Papers, Results Form	HOS	1. Wrong year group assessment papers administered to the learner 2. Assessment conducted in a disruptive or inappropriate environment 3. Learner finishes early with nothing to do; behaviour becomes disruptive 4. Results lost or misfiled after assessment	1. Confirm the learner's target year group before selecting assessment papers 2. Conduct all assessments in a quiet, dedicated room away from other learner activity 3. Prepare extension tasks for learners who complete the assessment early 4. File results securely in the learner's assessment file immediately after marking	During the assessment session
5	HOS Approval / Concerns — HOS reviews	Assessment Report	HOS	1. Delayed decision causes the parent to seek admission elsewhere 2. HOS approves placement without reviewing all sections of	1. Aim to complete the assessment review and give a decision on the same day where possible 2. Use a structured assessment review checklist to ensure all sections are	Same day as assessment , after results are

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	results and makes a placement recommend ation			the assessment 3. HOS recommends an incorrect year group due to misreading the results 4. Concerns not communicated clearly to the parent, causing misunderstanding	evaluated 3. HOS to cross-check year group recommendation against the marking rubric before confirming 4. Communicate any concerns to the parent clearly and in writing, with a next-steps plan	reviewed
6	Releasing of Results — HOS communicat es assessment results to the parent	Assessment Papers	HOS	1. Delay in communicating results causes the parent to feel uncertain and disengage 2. Results communicated verbally only; no written record retained 3. Incorrect result communicated to the parent due to misfiling 4. Results released to the wrong parent due to lack of identity verification	1. Ensure results are communicated to the parent on the same day the assessment is completed 2. Provide results in writing; retain a signed copy or email confirmation in the learner's file 3. Cross-check the result against the learner's name and assessment file before release 4. Verify the identity of the parent before releasing any assessment result	Day of assessment
7	HOC Input / Approval — HOC reviews the HOS recommend ation and gives final approval	Assessment Papers, Recommend ation Form	HOC	1. Miscommunication between HOS and HOC leads to approval for the wrong class or year group 2. HOC approves admission without reviewing the fully completed assessment form 3. HOC unavailable; approval delayed causing the admission process to stall 4. Learner admitted to a class that is already at maximum capacity	1. All forms must be fully completed and the class recommendation clearly stated before HOC review 2. HOC to review the full assessment report including HOS comments before signing off 3. Designate a Deputy HOC to provide approval in the HOC's absence 4. HOC to check current class capacity against the class list before giving approval	Same day as assessment and HOS recommen dation
8	Instructions for Joining — Administrat or issues joining instructions to the parent	Joining Instructions Document	Administrator	1. Key details omitted from the joining instructions, leading to confusion on first day 2. Instructions issued before HOC approval is confirmed 3. Parent does not read the instructions thoroughly and misses critical dates 4. Joining instructions not updated to reflect current term dates or uniform requirements	1. Use a standardised joining instruction template covering all required information 2. Issue joining instructions only after HOC approval has been given and recorded 3. Request the parent to sign an acknowledgement confirming receipt of the instructions 4. Review and update the joining instruction template at the start of each term	Same day as HOC approval
9	Payment of Commitmen t Fee — Accountant collects the commitment fee	Receipt / Payment Record	Accountant	1. Non-payment or underpayment of the commitment fee goes undetected 2. Admission process continues before the commitment fee is confirmed 3. Parent disputes that the commitment fee was paid due to lack of documentation 4. Fee collected but not recorded in the financial system	1. Confirm full payment of the commitment fee before releasing admission documents 2. No admission documents to be issued until commitment fee payment is verified in the system 3. Issue an official receipt immediately; retain a copy in both the financial file and the learner's file 4. Update the financial system on the same day payment is received	On the day payment is made
10	Learner Admission via Mzizi — Administrat or enters learner data into the Mzizi	Digital Admission Record (Mzizi)	Administrator	1. Data entry errors result in incorrect learner information in the system 2. Duplicate entry created for a learner already in the system 3. Admission recorded in the wrong year group or class in Mzizi	1. Apply double-entry verification: a second staff member reviews all data entered 2. Search the system for existing records before creating a new learner profile 3. Cross-check the class and year group in Mzizi against the HOC-	Same day payment is confirmed

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	system			4. System downtime prevents timely entry of the admission record	approved admission form 4. In case of system downtime, record admission manually and update the system within 24 hours	
11	Admission Documents Issued — Administrator prepares and issues the full admission pack to the parent	Admission Pack	Administrator	1. Missing documents in the admission pack discovered only after the parent has left 2. Admission pack issued without the HOC-signed joining instructions 3. Admission pack handed to the wrong parent due to inadequate identity verification 4. Documents issued before the learner's Mzizi record has been created and confirmed	1. Pre-prepare admission packs using a checklist; verify all documents are present before issuing 2. Confirm that HOC-signed joining instructions are included in every pack before it is sealed 3. Verify the parent's identity by cross-referencing with the assessment form before handover 4. Issue the admission pack only after the Mzizi record has been created and verified	Same day as Mzizi admission

APPROVAL

Approved by: _____ Date: _____

Head of Centre (HOC) Signature

SOP 02: A-Level Enrolment

Purpose: To provide a structured and transparent process for enrolling learners into the MSIS A-Level programme, ensuring all entry requirements are verified, subject combinations are appropriate, and Cambridge registrations are completed on time.
Scope: Applies to the Academic Coordinator, Admissions Committee, Marketing Officer, Admissions Officer, Academic Office, Guidance Counsellor, Accounts Department and HOC. Covers A-Level enrolment from programme review through to material provision.

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Review A-Level subject combinations and curriculum offerings	Curriculum guide, Subject clusters	Academic Coordinator	1. Subject combinations offered may be misaligned with university entry requirements 2. Outdated curriculum guide used, leading to incorrect advice to applicants 3. Staff delivering subject guidance are not fully briefed on current combinations 4. Review not completed before the enrolment window opens	1. Consult with universities and review current UCAS/KUCCPS requirements annually before the enrolment window 2. Update the curriculum guide at the end of each academic year; circulate to all relevant staff 3. Brief all staff involved in subject guidance before the enrolment window opens 4. Schedule the curriculum review at least 8 weeks before the enrolment window opens	2 months before term start
2	Define and publish admission criteria for A-Level	Past performance data, School policy	Admissions Committee	1. Ambiguous or unstated criteria lead to inconsistent selection decisions 2. Criteria published too late for applicants to prepare adequately 3. Criteria not aligned with current Cambridge subject entry requirements 4. Criteria applied differently by different staff members	1. Publish clear, merit-based, subject-specific criteria on the school website and notice boards 2. Publish admission criteria at least 6 weeks before the application window opens 3. Cross-reference all criteria with current Cambridge International Education subject guides 4. Brief all admissions staff on the criteria before the window opens; document criteria decisions	6 weeks before term start
3	Promote the A-Level programme to prospective learners	Flyers, Website, Social media	Marketing Officer	1. Low awareness or turnout due to limited reach of promotional activities 2. Incorrect information published in promotional materials 3. Target audience not reached through selected channels 4. Promotional materials not approved before distribution	1. Use multiple platforms including social media, school noticeboards, feeder school visits and open days 2. All promotional materials to be reviewed and approved by HOC before publication 3. Identify target audiences (Y11 completers, feeder schools) and tailor communication accordingly 4. Submit all promotional materials for HOC sign-off at least one week before publication	1 month before term start
4	Receive and register all applications	Application forms (online/paper), Student file register	Admissions Officer	1. Applications lost due to absence of a tracking system 2. Incomplete applications accepted and processed without all required information 3. Application forms not backed up, risking data loss 4. Application window closes with insufficient applicants due to late communication	1. Use a numbered application register; log every application on receipt with date and reference 2. Use a required documents checklist; return incomplete applications with clear guidance 3. Maintain digital backups of all applications; store originals in a secure file 4. Issue communication about the application window at least 4 weeks before it opens	Throughout the application window (4 weeks)

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
5	Verify KCSE/IGCSE results and supporting documents	KCSE/IGCSE results, National IDs	Academic Office	1. Forged or altered documents submitted by applicants 2. Documents verified by an unqualified staff member who misreads the results 3. Key documents not verified before placement decisions are made 4. Inconsistent verification standards applied across different applicants	1. Authenticate original certificates; cross-reference with issuing bodies where any document is suspect 2. Assign a specific qualified staff member to conduct all document verification 3. No placement decision to be made before all documents are verified and signed off 4. Use a standardised verification checklist applied consistently to every applicant	Within 1 week of application deadline
6	Provide academic counselling and subject advisory	Subject guides, Career pathway tools	Guidance Counsellor	1. Learner selects a subject combination that conflicts with their career aspirations 2. Counsellor lacks up-to-date knowledge of university entry requirements for specific subjects 3. Subject advisory is not documented, leaving no record of recommendations made 4. Learner feels pressured into a combination they are not comfortable with	1. Link all subject choices to the learner's academic ability, interest and stated career pathway 2. Counsellor to complete an annual update on university and KUCCPS requirements before advising 3. Document all advisory sessions and the final subject combination agreed upon; learner to sign 4. Ensure advisory sessions are private, unhurried and learner-led; record learner's own stated preference	During the application window
7	Issue placement or admission letters to selected applicants	Admission form, Subject allocation letter	Admissions Office	1. Delay in issuing letters causes confirmed learners to accept offers elsewhere 2. Letter contains incorrect subject combination or class allocation 3. Letter issued before HOC approval of the final selection 4. Letter not received by the applicant due to incorrect contact details	1. Issue all placement letters within 5 working days of the final selection decision 2. Cross-check every letter against the approved subject allocation list before issuing 3. No letter to be issued without HOC sign-off on the final admitted cohort 4. Confirm receipt of the letter by SMS or email; use multiple channels	1 week after final selection
8	Collect registration fees	Fee schedule, Receipt books	Accounts Department	1. Partial or non-payment accepted; learner placed before fees are settled 2. Fee collected but not entered into the financial system promptly 3. Parent disputes the fee amount after payment has been made 4. Incorrect fee charged due to an outdated fee schedule being used	1. Confirm full payment or a formally approved payment plan before confirming placement 2. Update the financial system on the same day payment is received; issue an official receipt 3. Display the current fee schedule prominently; confirm the amount with the parent verbally before payment 4. Accounts team to work from the HOC-approved current fee schedule only; update at start of each term	2–3 weeks before term starts
9	Confirm student registration and update records	Enrolment register, Student files	Admissions Officer	1. Inaccurate records entered due to data entry errors 2. Learner registered in the wrong stream or class 3. Duplicate records created for the same learner 4. Registration completed without fee payment being confirmed	1. Double-check all data entry against the original application form and admission letter 2. Cross-reference class and stream allocation with the Academic Coordinator before finalising registration 3. Search existing records for the learner before creating a new profile 4. Confirm payment receipt is on file before completing the registration	1 week before term starts
10	Assign students to	Class list, Academic	Academic Coordinator	1. Unequal class distribution leaves some classes	1. Cap class size and adjust allocations to ensure balanced distribution across all	1 week before

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	appropriate streams and classes	background		overcrowded and others underpopulated 2. Learner assigned to a stream that does not match their academic background 3. Class lists not circulated to teachers before the first day of term 4. Subject combination conflicts are discovered only after class allocation is complete	streams 2. Base all stream assignments on verified KCSE/IGCSE results and subject advisory records 3. Circulate finalised class lists to all subject teachers at least 3 days before term starts 4. Cross-check all subject combinations for compatibility before finalising class allocation	term starts
11	Provide learning materials to enrolled A-Level learners	Textbooks, ID cards, Stationery	Admin Office	1. Material shortages mean some learners begin the term without required textbooks 2. Wrong edition of a textbook issued to learners 3. ID cards not ready by the first day of term 4. Materials not distributed equitably across all streams	1. Order materials based on the provisional enrolment list at least 4 weeks before term 2. Confirm the correct edition with subject teachers before ordering and distributing textbooks 3. Begin ID card production at least 2 weeks before term to allow for printing time 4. Maintain a distribution log and confirm each learner has received all required materials on day one	Start of term

APPROVAL

Approved by: _____ Date: _____
Head of Centre (HOC) Signature

SOP 03: A-Level Scholarship Programme

Purpose: To define a fair, merit-based and transparent process for establishing, advertising, selecting and managing A-Level scholarships at MSIS, ensuring the programme supports deserving learners while maintaining institutional integrity.
Scope: Applies to the Scholarship Committee, School Leadership, Finance Office, Admin/Marketing Team, Admissions Office and Academic Office. Covers the full scholarship cycle from criteria-setting through to recipient performance monitoring.

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Set scholarship criteria and determine number of awards	Past performance data, financial aid budget	Scholarship Committee	1. Unclear or inconsistently applied criteria lead to unfair selection outcomes 2. Number of awards set without reference to available budget, creating a financial shortfall 3. Criteria not documented, making future decision-making inconsistent 4. Criteria fail to distinguish academic merit from other considerations	1. Base criteria explicitly on documented institutional priorities and academic performance data 2. Confirm available budget with Finance before setting the number of awards 3. Document all criteria formally and have them approved by the HOC before publication 4. Include a minimum academic threshold (e.g. specific KCSE/IGCSE grades) as an objective benchmark	2 months before application window
2	Approve scholarship budget	Finance reports, Donor commitments	School Leadership + Finance Office	1. Scholarship announced before budget is confirmed, creating financial commitment risk 2. Insufficient funds to cover all awards if more than expected candidates qualify 3. Donor commitments not formalised before budget is approved 4. Budget approved for the wrong financial period	1. Verify and confirm available funds before any public announcement is made 2. Build a contingency buffer of at least 10% into the scholarship budget 3. Obtain written confirmation from all donors before including external funding in the budget 4. Cross-reference the budget approval with the current financial year planning cycle	6 weeks before application window
3	Announce scholarship opportunity to prospective recipients	Posters, School website, Local radio	Admin / Marketing Team	1. Announcement reaches a limited audience; deserving candidates are unaware 2. Incorrect eligibility information published in announcement materials 3. Announcement made too close to the application deadline; insufficient time to apply 4. Announcement not approved before publication, containing unauthorised information	1. Use multi-channel communication: school noticeboard, website, social media, feeder school liaison and local radio 2. All announcement materials to be reviewed for accuracy by the HOC before publication 3. Announce the scholarship at least 4 weeks before the application deadline 4. Obtain HOC sign-off on all public-facing scholarship materials before release	1 month before application window
4	Distribute and receive scholarship applications	Application forms, Checklist	Admissions Office	1. Incomplete applications submitted and accepted without all required documents 2. Application forms not numbered or tracked; risk of loss 3. Applications received after the deadline accepted inconsistently 4. No acknowledgement of receipt issued to applicants	1. Provide applicants with a clear checklist of required documents; return incomplete applications 2. Use a numbered application register; record every application on receipt with date 3. Set and enforce a firm deadline; communicate it clearly in the announcement 4. Issue a written or digital acknowledgement of receipt to every applicant	2–4-week application period
5	Verify eligibility — grades and	KCSE/IGCSE results, Income declaration	Scholarship Committee	1. False or misrepresented academic or financial data submitted by applicants 2. Verification carried out by a	1. Cross-verify all submitted documents against originals; contact issuing institutions where necessary 2. Declare and manage all conflicts of	1 week after application deadline

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	financial need	forms		committee member with a conflict of interest 3. Results verified against copies rather than original documents 4. Financial need assessment not conducted consistently across all applicants	interest before verification begins; recuse affected members 3. Require original certificates at the verification stage; return copies after verification 4. Use a standardised financial need assessment form applied consistently to all applicants	
6	Shortlist qualified candidates	Scoring matrix, Eligibility summary	Scholarship Committee	1. Bias or favouritism influences shortlisting decisions 2. Shortlisting completed without reference to the documented eligibility criteria 3. Inconsistent scoring due to subjective interpretation of criteria 4. Shortlist not documented or signed off before proceeding to interview	1. Apply a blind review process where candidate names are removed during initial scoring 2. All shortlisting decisions to be made with reference to the approved criteria and scoring matrix 3. Use a structured scoring rubric with defined weightings for all criteria 4. Document the shortlist and have it signed off by the HOC before candidates are notified	1 week after verification
7	Conduct interviews or written assessments of shortlisted candidates	Interview panel guide, Writing prompts	Academic + Admin Panel	1. Candidate nervousness leads to performance that is not representative of true ability 2. Panel bias influences assessment scores 3. Interview questions differ significantly between candidates, making comparison unfair 4. Assessment notes not recorded properly; decisions cannot be justified after the fact	1. Provide candidates with clear information about the interview format and expectations in advance 2. Assemble a diverse panel; apply a consistent structured scoring rubric across all candidates 3. Use a standardised set of interview questions applied consistently to every candidate 4. Panel members to complete structured score sheets for every candidate during the interview	Within 2 weeks after shortlisting
8	Select final scholarship recipients	Interview scores, Academic results	Scholarship Committee	1. Conflict of interest influences final selection decisions 2. Final selection made without reference to all assessment scores 3. Tied scores not resolved using a defined tiebreaker process 4. Selection decision not documented and signed before notification	1. All committee members to declare and manage conflicts of interest; exclude conflicted members from final vote 2. Final selection to be based on all available data: academic results, eligibility check, and interview scores 3. Define and document a tiebreaker process before the assessment stage begins 4. All selection decisions to be documented in writing and signed by all committee members	Immediately after assessments
9	Issue scholarship award letters to recipients	Letter templates, Contact list	Admissions Office	1. Delay in notification causes recipients to accept other offers or make alternative plans 2. Award letter contains incorrect terms, scholarship amount or duration 3. Regret letters not issued to unsuccessful candidates 4. Award letters issued without HOC sign-off	1. Issue award letters within 5 working days of the final selection decision 2. Cross-check every award letter against the scholarship terms document before issuing 3. Issue respectful, prompt regret letters to all unsuccessful candidates 4. All award letters to carry HOC's signature; no letter to be issued without HOC approval	1 week after selection
10	Confirm student acceptance of scholarship offer	Acceptance form, Award conditions	Admin Office	1. Student accepts the scholarship without understanding or agreeing to the conditions 2. Acceptance deadline not communicated, leading to uncertainty about who has accepted	1. Provide all award conditions in writing; require the student and parent to sign and return the acceptance form 2. Set a clear acceptance deadline of 5 working days; communicate this in the award letter 3. Accept only written acceptances; retain signed acceptance forms in the	Within 5 days of offer

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
				3. Acceptance received verbally only; no written record retained 4. Student later disputes the conditions they were not clearly informed of	scholarship file 4. Brief the student and parent on all conditions during a face-to-face meeting before acceptance is signed	
11	Track academic performance of scholarship recipients each term	Grade reports, Class attendance records	Academic Office	1. Scholar underperforms without any early intervention from the school 2. Performance monitoring not conducted consistently for all scholars 3. Performance data not reviewed against the minimum scholarship retention GPA 4. Scholar loses the scholarship without adequate warning or support	1. Review all scholarship recipients' academic results and attendance at the end of every term 2. Apply the same monitoring process to every scholarship recipient without exception 3. Cross-reference all results against the minimum GPA or grade threshold stated in the award conditions 4. Issue a formal warning and put a support plan in place if a scholar falls below the threshold before withdrawing the award	End of each term

APPROVAL

Approved by: _____ Date: _____
Head of Centre (HOC) Signature

SOP 04: New Learners Induction

Purpose: To ensure that all new learners joining MSIS receive a structured, welcoming and effective induction that helps them integrate academically and socially into the school community as quickly as possible.
Scope: Applies to HOS, Admin, Class Teacher, Librarian, School Nurse/Matron, HODs, Subject Teachers and the Careers In-charge. Covers all induction activities from day one through to a two-week follow-up feedback session.

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Welcome new learner and conduct school orientation	Orientation booklet, School map, School magazine	HOS / Admin	1. Learner feels lost or unwelcome on their first day 2. Orientation not personalised; learner receives generic information not relevant to their year group 3. Welcome materials not ready on the day the new learner arrives 4. Multiple new learners arriving on different days; no consistent welcome process applied	1. Provide a personal greeting from the HOS on day one; assign a dedicated member of staff to accompany the learner 2. Tailor orientation materials to the learner's specific year group and relevant school sections 3. Prepare the orientation pack (booklet, map, magazine) at least 2 days before the learner's confirmed start date 4. Apply the same structured welcome process to every new learner regardless of the date they join	Day 1
2	Allocation of furniture, stationery and school materials	Textbooks, Desks, Chair, Exercise books, Pigeon hole	Librarian / Class Teacher	1. Items misplaced or lost immediately after allocation due to lack of labelling 2. Incorrect textbooks issued due to year group confusion 3. Pigeon hole not allocated before the learner arrives 4. Stock insufficient to issue a full set of materials to the new learner	1. Label all issued items with the learner's name and admission number before allocation 2. Confirm the learner's year group with the HOS before issuing any textbooks or subject materials 3. Assign a pigeon hole and issue the key or lock before the learner's first day 4. Conduct a stock check at least 3 days before a new learner is due to arrive; reorder any shortfalls	Day 1
3	Guided tour of all school facilities	School map	Class Teacher	1. Learner has difficulty navigating the school after the tour due to information overload 2. Key areas missed during the tour (sanatorium, fire exits, counselling room) 3. Tour not conducted because no staff member is assigned or available 4. Learner with physical accessibility needs not accommodated during the tour	1. Conduct the tour in small, manageable sections; provide a labelled school map for the learner to keep 2. Use a tour checklist to ensure all key areas are covered without exception 3. Assign the class teacher as the designated tour guide; confirm assignment before the learner's start date 4. Check for accessibility requirements before the tour; adapt the route accordingly	Day 1
4	Introduction to school rules, regulations and code of conduct	School rules document, Code of conduct	HOS / Class Teacher	1. Learner misunderstands rules due to a language barrier or complex document 2. Rules communicated verbally only; no written copy given to the learner 3. Learner not given an opportunity to ask questions about the rules 4. Rules presented in a way that feels punitive rather than welcoming	1. Use plain, accessible language in all rule's documents; provide a simplified version for younger learners 2. Issue a physical copy of the rules and code of conduct to the learner; ask them to sign the acknowledgement 3. Allocate time for a Q&A session after presenting the rules; address all questions before moving on 4. Frame the presentation positively — focus on community values, not consequences — to create a sense of belonging	Day 1
5	Health and safety briefing	Health and safety manual,	HOS / Class Teacher /	1. Learner unaware of emergency procedures and assembly points 2. School Nurse unavailable for	1. Include assembly points, fire exit routes and emergency contacts in the health and safety briefing on day one	Day 1

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
		Emergency policy, Evacuation plan	School Nurse	the briefing; health information not covered 3. Insufficient safety signage in the school for a new learner to navigate independently 4. Medical conditions of the new learner not communicated to the school nurse before briefing	2. Assign the Class Teacher as a backup to cover the health and safety section if the nurse is unavailable 3. Conduct a signage audit at the start of each term; ensure all key safety signs are clearly visible 4. Request the learner's medical information from the parent before day one; share with the school nurse before the briefing	
6	Introduction to learning practices and curriculum	Exercise books, Subject syllabuses	HOS / HOD / Class Teacher / Subject Teachers	1. New learner significantly behind in syllabus coverage due to joining mid-term 2. Learner overwhelmed by multiple subject teachers on day two 3. No catch-up plan put in place for missed content 4. Subject allocation confirmed without verifying compatibility with previous school's curriculum	1. Assign a senior learner or class teacher to help the new learner copy and review missed notes 2. Introduce subject teachers gradually; prioritise core subjects on day two 3. Develop a personalised catch-up plan with the HOS within the first week 4. HOD to review the learner's previous school curriculum against MSIS requirements before finalising subject allocation	Day 2
7	Assignment of mentor and induction buddy	Mentorship schedule	Class Teacher / Mentee	1. Assigned mentor is not adequately briefed on their responsibilities 2. Mentor and new learner are not compatible in personality or year group 3. No structured check-in schedule set between mentor and mentee 4. Mentorship fizzles out after the first week without any follow-up	1. Brief all assigned mentors on their role, responsibilities and expected check-in frequency before assignment 2. Select mentors who are well-adjusted, approachable and ideally from the same or adjacent year group 3. Set and document a check-in schedule (at least twice per week for the first two weeks) 4. Class teacher to check in with both mentor and mentee at the end of week one and week two	Day 2
8	Review of subject selection and timetable confirmation	Personal timetable, School uniform	Class Teacher / Careers In-charge	1. Learner picks or drops subjects without proper guidance 2. Timetable issued contains errors or timetable clashes 3. Uniform not complete by day one, causing the learner to feel different from peers 4. Subject selection not reviewed against the learner's academic background and career goals	1. Involve the Careers In-charge in all subject selection decisions; no changes to be made without guidance 2. Cross-check the timetable for clashes before issuing; HOD to review and sign off on the allocation 3. Advise parents to ensure the full uniform set is ready before the learner's first day 4. HOD to review the learner's previous academic record before confirming subject selection	Day 7
9	Q&A and feedback session with the new learner	Feedback forms, Induction checklist	HOS / HODs / Class Teacher	1. Concerns raised by the learner go unaddressed after the feedback session 2. Learner reluctant to share honest feedback in a group setting 3. Feedback not recorded; patterns of recurring induction challenges go unnoticed 4. Session conducted too early; learner does not have enough experience to provide meaningful feedback	1. Assign a specific staff member to follow up on every concern raised; close the loop with the learner within 3 days 2. Provide an individual written feedback form in addition to any group discussion 3. Record all feedback; HOD to review completed induction checklists at the end of each term 4. Conduct the feedback session on day 14 to allow the learner enough time to form an informed view	Day 14

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Approved by: _____ Date: _____

Head of Centre (HOC) Signature

SOP 05: Learner Induction On-Boarding – Kindergarten & Playgroup

Purpose: To provide a nurturing, structured and developmentally appropriate induction process for new Kindergarten and Playgroup learners, ensuring a smooth and emotionally safe transition into the MSIS early years learning environment.
Scope: Applies to Class Teachers, Teaching Assistants, Section Leads and Parents/Guardians. Covers the daily induction routine from arrival through to end-of-day communication with parents, spanning the first several weeks of enrolment.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Receive child and settle them into the classroom at arrival	Arrival Register, Learner Info Card	Class Teacher + Teaching Assistant	1. Child experiences severe separation anxiety that disrupts classroom settling 2. Parent does not follow the handover routine, prolonging the separation process 3. Child's arrival not recorded in the register due to rush at arrival time 4. Caregiver inconsistency (different adults doing the handover) increases child's anxiety	1. Apply a warm, consistent handover routine; assign a dedicated adult to receive each child at the door 2. Brief parents on the handover routine before the first day; politely but firmly maintain the routine daily 3. Record every child's arrival time immediately in the arrival register before engaging with the next arrival 4. Maintain the same Class Teacher and Teaching Assistant as the primary greeters for the first two weeks minimum	Daily from Week 1 onward
2	Engage child in a calming entry activity upon arrival	Tabletop activities, Playdough, Books, Plasticine	Teaching Assistant	1. Child's morning distress is not addressed and escalates 2. Calming activity is not age-appropriate or engaging for the child 3. Activity not set up before children arrive, creating a disorganised arrival environment 4. Child refuses all offered activities; no alternative plan in place	1. Have the calming activity already set up at each child's seat before arrival begins 2. Offer a variety of sensory and fine motor activities; rotate them to maintain novelty and engagement 3. Prepare the classroom for arrival at least 15 minutes before the first child is expected 4. Have at least two alternative calming activities ready if a child refuses the primary option	On arrival daily
3	Follow and reinforce the visual daily routine	Daily Visual Schedule	Class Teacher	1. Child is confused or distressed by unpredictable changes to the daily routine 2. Visual schedule not displayed or referred to consistently 3. Child's language barrier prevents them from understanding the routine 4. Routine is adult-led only; children not taught to read or predict the schedule independently	1. Maintain the same daily routine sequence during the induction period; avoid unnecessary changes 2. Display the visual schedule at child eye level; refer to it explicitly at every transition point 3. Use visual symbols, pictures and actions — not just words — to convey the routine to all learners 4. Teach children to point to or select the next activity on the visual schedule to build independence	Daily from Week 1 onward
4	Monitor key transition points throughout the day	Learner Observation Notes	Class Teacher	1. Behavioural or emotional signals missed during busy transition moments 2. Observation notes not completed, leaving no record of the child's daily adjustment progress 3. Same transitions observed every day without a structured observation focus 4. Concern identified but not escalated to the Section Lead or parents promptly	1. Assign the Teaching Assistant to lead a transition activity while the Class Teacher observes and records 2. Complete a brief observation note for each child at every monitored transition; file in the learner's record 3. Rotate the observation focus (emotional, social, engagement, motor) across the week for comprehensive data 4. Escalate any concern identified during monitoring to the Section Lead on the same day it is observed	Daily
5	Record	'Today with	Class	1. Communication gaps between	1. Complete the diary entry for every	Daily at

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	child's day in the 'Today with Me' diary at dismissal	Me' Diary, Routine Score Chart	Teacher + Teaching Assistant	school and home due to diaries not being completed daily 2. Diary entries are vague or incomplete; parents cannot understand how the child's day went 3. Diary not sent home with the child; parents receive no daily update 4. Negative or alarming information communicated in the diary without a prior parent conversation	child every day without exception during the induction period 2. Use the structured score chart and add a brief, specific note about one positive moment from the child's day 3. Confirm the diary is in the child's bag before dismissal every day; add it to the dismissal checklist 4. If the diary entry contains a concern, call the parent first and then follow up in writing in the diary	dismissal
6	Parent reviews and responds to the diary each morning	'Today with Me' Diary	Parents / Class Teacher	1. Parent does not read the diary; feedback opportunity is missed 2. Parent writes negative or distressing comments in the diary that the child can access 3. Parent concerns raised in the diary are not followed up by the class teacher 4. Diary is used to deliver difficult news rather than as a positive communication tool	1. Briefly remind parents to read and respond to the diary at every morning drop-off during the first month 2. Guide parents during orientation to use the diary for positive, general observations; sensitive concerns by phone 3. Class teacher to read all parent diary responses during morning preparation and respond to any concerns that day 4. Position the diary as a two-way celebration tool; celebrate progress and highlight positive moments	Daily — morning check during preparation
7	Use diary score trends to identify adjustment concerns or celebrate successes	Weekly Review Log	Class Teacher + Section Lead	1. Patterns in diary scores not reviewed regularly; slow adjustment issues go undetected 2. Concerns identified but Section Lead not informed in a timely manner 3. No differentiated response plan put in place for children showing persistent adjustment difficulty 4. Positive adjustment milestones not communicated to parents; opportunity to celebrate is missed	1. Conduct a weekly review of all diary scores; flag any child showing consistent low scores for discussion with the Section Lead 2. Share any pattern of concern with the Section Lead no later than the end of the week in which it is identified 3. For children showing persistent difficulty, develop an individual support plan in consultation with the Section Lead and parent 4. Celebrate adjustment milestones explicitly with the child and communicate them to the parent in the diary and at pick-up	Weekly review / daily monitoring

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Approved by: _____ Date: _____

Head of Centre (HOC) Signature

SOP 06: Beginning of the Academic Year

Purpose: To ensure a smooth, organised and well-prepared start to the academic year at MSIS, covering all planning, staffing, physical preparation, communication and curriculum readiness activities.
Scope: Applies to the School Management Team, HR/HOC, DHOC/QA Officer, HODs, Teachers, Procurement team, Academic Coordinator, Facilities Manager, Support Staff Supervisor, Admin and the Communication Officer. Covers all preparation from 4–6 weeks before reopening through to the first day of term.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Review school calendar and set key dates for the new academic year	Ministry circulars, Previous year calendar	School Management Team	1. Calendar conflicts with national holidays or Ministry of Education directives 2. Key dates set without consulting all departments, causing scheduling conflicts 3. Calendar not distributed to staff and parents before the start of the year 4. Previous year's calendar used in error, with incorrect term dates	1. Align all dates with Ministry of Education circulars and Kenya National Examination Council schedules 2. Consult HODs, the Academic Coordinator and the Boarding Master before finalising key dates 3. Distribute the approved calendar to all staff and parents at least 2 weeks before the year begins 4. Cross-reference the draft calendar with the previous year's version to identify and remove outdated dates	4–6 weeks before reopening
2	Confirm staff availability, roles and reporting dates	Staff list, Employment contracts	HR / HOC	1. Understaffing on day one due to staff not confirming their return in time 2. Role changes or new assignments not communicated to affected staff before term 3. New staff not inducted before learners arrive 4. Staff contracts not renewed before term begins, creating employment uncertainty	1. Send written return-to-work confirmations to all staff at least 3 weeks before reopening 2. Communicate all role changes or new assignments in writing at least 2 weeks before term 3. Schedule induction for all new staff to be completed before the learner reopening date 4. Confirm all contract renewals with HR and sign new contracts at least 4 weeks before term	3–4 weeks before reopening
3	Update school policies and learner/staff handbooks	Previous year documents, Regulatory updates	DHOC / QA Officer	1. Outdated policies distributed to staff and learners at the start of the year 2. Policy changes not reviewed and approved by leadership before distribution 3. Handbook updates not aligned with current Kenyan education regulations 4. Revised policies not communicated to parents	1. Review all policies against the previous year's version and any new Ministry guidelines 2. All policy updates to be reviewed by HOC and signed off before inclusion in the handbook 3. Cross-reference all policies with current KICD and Cambridge International requirements 4. Communicate all significant policy changes to parents via letter or the school communication platform	3 weeks before reopening
4	Procure and prepare all learning materials and equipment	Stationery, Books, Equipment lists	Procurement team + HODs	1. Delayed deliveries leave classrooms without required materials on day one 2. Materials ordered without consulting HODs on current curriculum requirements 3. Budget overspent on procurement due to lack of prior approval 4. Wrong edition or grade-level materials ordered	1. Initiate the procurement process at least 4 weeks before reopening to allow for delivery lead time 2. HODs to submit material requirements to procurement at least 6 weeks before term 3. All procurement to be approved against the available budget before orders are placed 4. HODs to specify edition and grade level precisely on all purchase orders	4 weeks before reopening

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
5	Finalise class lists and prepare timetables	Student register, Subject selection data	Academic Coordinator	1. Class lists contain errors due to unapproved mid-year transfers not being updated 2. Timetable clashes discovered on the first day of term 3. Class sizes exceed the agreed maximum 4. Timetable not circulated to staff before term begins	1. Cross-check class lists against the admissions register and any approved transfer records 2. Use scheduling tools and review the timetable with HODs before finalising 3. Confirm class sizes are within the approved cap before finalising the list 4. Circulate the approved timetable to all staff at least 3 days before term starts	2 weeks before reopening
6	Review schemes of work and curriculum plans with all departments	Curriculum documents, Teacher planners	HODs + Teachers	1. Teachers begin term without approved, current schemes of work 2. Curriculum gaps from the previous year not identified and addressed 3. New teachers not briefed on scheme of work requirements 4. Scheme reviews conducted individually without HOD oversight	1. Hold departmental scheme of work reviews chaired by each HOD before term begins 2. Review previous year's student performance data to identify and address curriculum gaps 3. Include all new teachers in the scheme of work review session 4. All schemes to be approved and signed off by the HOD before term starts	2 weeks before reopening
7	Organise and conduct a staff induction and briefing session	Agenda, Presentations	DHOC / HOC	1. Low attendance due to late notice or poor communication of the session 2. Session is information-heavy and passive; staff leave disengaged 3. New staff not introduced or welcomed formally 4. Key operational updates for the new year not covered	1. Issue a formal invitation and agenda to all staff at least 2 weeks in advance; make attendance mandatory 2. Design the session to be interactive; use group discussions, Q&A and team activities 3. Formally introduce all new staff members during the session 4. Include all operational, policy and academic updates for the new year on the session agenda	1 week before reopening
8	Inspect all classrooms, facilities and safety features	Inspection checklist, Maintenance log	Facilities Manager	1. Safety hazards (broken fixtures, faulty electrical fittings) not identified before learners arrive 2. Incomplete maintenance from the previous term not finalised before reopening 3. Inspection not documented; liability risk if an incident occurs 4. Classrooms not ready for use due to uncleaned or incorrectly set-up spaces	1. Conduct a full structural and safety inspection using a standardised checklist at least 3 weeks before reopening 2. Identify and prioritise all outstanding maintenance items immediately after inspection; track completion 3. Record all inspection findings and corrective actions in the maintenance log 4. Facilities Manager to sign off all classrooms and spaces as 'ready for use' before learners arrive	3 weeks before reopening
9	Clean the school compound, buildings and all common areas	Cleaning supplies, cleaning rota	Support Staff Supervisor	1. Unhygienic conditions on day one create a poor impression and a health risk 2. Cleaning not completed uniformly across all areas 3. Cleaning supplies run out before all areas are covered 4. High-risk areas (toilets, kitchens, sanatorium) not given priority 5. No sign-off process to confirm cleaning has been completed to	1. Implement a detailed cleaning rota covering all areas; start at least 5 days before reopening 2. Assign specific teams to specific zones; supervise completion of each zone before moving to the next 3. Conduct a stock count and order all required cleaning supplies at least 2 weeks before cleaning begins 4. Prioritise sanitary areas, the kitchen, the sanatorium and high-	1 week before reopening

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
				standard	traffic zones in the cleaning schedule 5. Supervisor to sign off on each zone after inspection; Facilities Manager to conduct a final check	
10	Set up all classrooms and offices with furniture and supplies	Desks, Seating plans, Supplies inventory	Class Teachers + Admin	1. Classrooms disorganised on day one, causing wasted lesson time 2. Furniture set up incorrectly for the class size or learning activities planned 3. Supplies not available in classrooms due to late delivery 4. Admin offices not operational on day one due to incomplete setup	1. Assign specific staff responsibility for each classroom and office area setup 2. Class teachers to set up classrooms according to the approved seating plan before learners arrive 3. Confirm all supplies are available and in classrooms at least 1 day before reopening 4. Admin team to complete office setup at least 2 days before reopening	1 week before reopening
11	Send reopening communication to all parents and guardians	Letter/Email/ WhatsApp, School calendar	Admin / Communication Officer	1. Parents confused about reopening dates due to incorrect or late communication 2. Communication not reaching all parents due to outdated contact details 3. Communication sent as a single message with no follow-up reminder 4. Key information (term dates, new fee structures, policy changes) omitted from the communication	1. Issue the first communication at least 3 weeks before reopening; send a reminder 1 week before 2. Update parent contact details at the end of each term; verify before sending mass communications 3. Send communications through at least two channels: SMS/WhatsApp and written letter 4. Use a communication checklist to ensure all key items are included before the message is sent	2–3 weeks before reopening

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Approved by: _____ Date: _____

Head of Centre (HOC) Signature

SOP 07: Class Teacher

Purpose: To define the core daily, weekly and termly responsibilities of a Class Teacher at MSIS, ensuring consistent, professional and learner-centred practice across all classes.
Scope: Applies to all Class Teachers at MSIS. Covers the full scope of class teacher duties from morning assembly registration through to report writing and academic monitoring.

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Morning Assembly / Gender Meeting / Class Meeting / PPI — Class teacher leads or attends the morning session	Assembly ground, Classrooms	Class Teacher	1. Learners arriving late disrupt the assembly or morning session 2. Important announcements not communicated to all learners due to absenteeism 3. Class teacher arrives after the session has started, leaving learners unsupervised 4. Minutes of the class meeting not recorded; issues raised are forgotten	1. Parents to be reminded of the 7:30 AM drop-off expectation via the school's communication platform 2. Record attendance and circulate a summary of announcements to absent learners via the class register 3. Class teacher to be in position at the assembly area or classroom by 7:45 AM daily 4. Maintain a class meeting minutes book; record all issues raised and actions agreed	Monday to Friday — 7:55 AM
2	Update class inventory at the start of each term	Class inventory list (furniture, TV, equipment)	Class Teacher	1. Breakages or missing items go undetected until the end of term 2. Inventory not updated at the start of term; new damage cannot be attributed to the current term 3. Learner responsible for damage cannot be identified due to lack of individual allocation 4. High-value items (TV, projector) not included in the inventory	1. Conduct a full class inventory check on the first day of each term and record all findings 2. Compare the current inventory against the previous term's record and note all discrepancies 3. Allocate each learner a numbered desk and chair; record the allocation in the inventory 4. Include all fixed and movable assets in the inventory, including technology and display equipment	At the start of each term
3	Conduct morning registration accurately	Attendance register, Pen	Class Teacher	1. Late arrivals not recorded, leading to inaccurate attendance data 2. Absent learners not followed up, creating an undetected safeguarding risk 3. Register marked before all learners have arrived, resulting in inaccurate records 4. Attendance register not submitted to the HOS on time	1. Mark the register only after the formal start time; all late arrivals to be recorded with the time of arrival 2. Any learner absent without prior notification to be followed up by 9:00 AM via parent contact 3. All learners must be physically present in the room before their name is marked as present 4. Submit the completed attendance register to the HOS by 8:30 AM each morning	Daily — start of school day
4	Manage classroom behaviour and enforce school rules	School rules, Code of conduct	Class Teacher	1. Defiant learners disrupt the class and are not consistently managed 2. Behavioural issues not escalated to the HOS when required 3. Consequences applied inconsistently, creating a perception of unfairness 4. Behaviour incidents not documented, making it impossible to identify persistent patterns	1. Apply the school's behaviour framework consistently; involve the HOS for extreme or persistent cases 2. Escalate to HOS any behaviour that the class teacher has addressed twice without resolution 3. Apply consequences strictly in line with the school's disciplinary framework 4. Record all significant behaviour incidents in the class discipline log on the day they occur	Throughout the school day
5	Collect notices, homework and assignments from learners	Homework diary, Exercise books	Class Teacher	1. Books or homework diaries left at home by learners go unchecked 2. Submitted work not collected promptly and goes missing 3. No record of which learners	1. Follow up with learners who have not brought their books; send a reminder home the same day 2. Collect and store all submitted work securely; issue a receipt	Daily — after morning registration

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
				have not submitted their work 4. Submitted work not returned to learners within the agreed timeframe	acknowledgement in the learner's diary 3. Maintain a submission register; mark non-submissions clearly and follow up with parents 4. Return all marked work within 5 school days; use the homework diary as a communication tool	
6	Monitor learner uniform and general presentation	School rules, Expected dress code	Class Teacher	1. Non-compliance with uniform requirements becomes normalised without consistent monitoring 2. Learners in non-compliant uniform allowed into class without any consequence or communication 3. Non-compliance not reported to parents promptly 4. Class teacher applies the uniform rules inconsistently across different learners	1. Check uniform compliance every morning; address any non-compliance immediately and without exception 2. A learner in non-compliant uniform is to be issued a note to parents on the same day 3. Contact parents by phone or message on the same day if non-compliance is observed 4. Apply the uniform standard uniformly across all learners in the class; no exceptions	Daily — morning and throughout the day
7	Facilitate a class meeting with learners	Class meeting minutes book	Class Teacher	1. Important learner issues raised in meetings are not acted upon 2. Minutes of the meeting are not recorded; accountability for actions is lost 3. Meeting is delayed or cancelled regularly due to time pressure 4. Only some learners participate; others feel unheard	1. Follow up on all action points from the previous class meeting before the next one 2. Record minutes of every meeting in the class meeting minutes book; share summary with HOS monthly 3. Schedule the class meeting as a fixed weekly commitment — not to be cancelled without HOC approval 4. Use structured facilitation techniques to ensure all learners have an opportunity to contribute	Weekly — Thursday
8	Provide counselling, guidance and pastoral support to learners	Records of learners involved	Class Teacher (refer to Counsellor as needed)	1. Learners do not feel comfortable opening up to the class teacher 2. Class teacher attempts to handle complex pastoral issues alone without referring to the Counsellor 3. Sensitive conversations held in public areas without privacy 4. Welfare concern identified but not referred to the Counsellor or HOC	1. Create a friendly, non-judgmental environment; use restorative communication approaches 2. Refer any case involving mental health, family crisis, or safeguarding to the Counsellor immediately 3. Hold all pastoral conversations in a private space; never in front of peers 4. Log all welfare concerns and referrals; do not manage safeguarding concerns independently	As needed throughout the term
9	Communicate with parents regarding learner progress and conduct	Phone, Email, Class WhatsApp platform	Class Teacher	1. Parents do not respond to calls or messages; concerns go unaddressed 2. Communication not recorded; disputes arise over what was said 3. Personal or sensitive information shared on a class group platform 4. Communication delayed until the end of term rather than being timely	1. Maintain a parent communication log; record all call attempts with date, time and outcome 2. Follow up all verbal communication with a written note or message; file a copy 3. Use the class WhatsApp platform for general updates only; contact parents individually for sensitive matters 4. Contact parents as soon as a concern arises; do not wait until report writing time	As needed / weekly for updates
10	Monitor academic progress and provide interventions	Academic progress record, Lesson attendance sheet	Class Teacher	1. Lack of updated learner records means performance issues are not detected early 2. Parents not interested in engaging with academic concerns raised by the class teacher	1. Update the academic progress record at least twice a term for every learner 2. Escalate persistent parental disengagement to the HOS; do not accept non-response as a final outcome 3. Document all academic interventions	Twice a term minimum

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
				3. Interventions not documented; impact cannot be measured 4. Class teacher attempts academic intervention without involving subject teachers	in the learner's progress record with dates and outcomes 4. Liaise with subject teachers before initiating academic interventions; involve the HOS as required	
11	Compile and submit academic and behaviour reports for each learner	Case history, Academic reports, Mzizi system	Class Teacher	1. Inaccurate data in reports due to failure to cross-check with subject teachers 2. Reports submitted after the deadline, delaying distribution to parents 3. Missing information for learners who were absent during assessment periods 4. Reports not reviewed by the HOS before distribution to parents	1. Cross-check all academic data with subject teachers at least 1 week before the reporting deadline 2. Submit draft reports to the HOS no later than 5 days before the distribution date 3. Collect assessment data for absent learners proactively; consult the subject teacher 4. All reports must be reviewed and signed off by the HOS before being sent to parents	Fortnightly / twice a term

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Approved by: _____ Date: _____
Head of Centre (HOC) Signature

SOP 08: Quality Assessment of Teaching

Purpose: To establish a systematic, evidence-based process for monitoring, evaluating and continuously improving the quality of teaching and learning at MSIS through observations, feedback, data analysis and professional development.
Scope: Applies to the Academic Coordinator, HOS, DHOC, QA Officer, Subject Teachers, HODs, Peer Teachers, SMT and QA Lead/DHOC. Covers the full quality assurance cycle from lesson observation scheduling through to leadership reporting.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Schedule and communicate classroom observation programme	Observation schedule, Teacher timetable	Academic Coordinator	1. Teachers feel ambushed by unannounced observations; resistance increases 2. Observation schedule conflicts with examination periods or major school events 3. Not all teachers included in the observation cycle for a given term 4. Schedule not communicated to teachers in advance; anxiety reduces performance on the day	1. Communicate the observation schedule to all teachers at the beginning of each term with a minimum of one week's notice 2. Cross-reference the observation schedule against the examination calendar and school events calendar before publishing 3. Ensure every teacher is included in the observation cycle at least once per term; keep a tracking record 4. Frame observations as a professional development tool, not a performance judgment, in all communications	Beginning of each term
2	Conduct structured lesson observations using a rubric	Observation checklist, Notebook, Rubric	HOS / DHOC	1. Observer bias influences the assessment of the teacher's performance 2. Observation conducted without the teacher being informed of the rubric criteria 3. Key observation domains (questioning, differentiation, assessment) not assessed consistently 4. Observer interrupts the lesson in a way that disrupts learner engagement	1. Use a standardised, multi-domain observation rubric; assign multiple observers for senior staff where possible 2. Share the observation rubric with all teachers at the start of the year so they know the criteria 3. Ensure all rubric domains are assessed during every observation; no domain to be left blank 4. Observer to enter the classroom unobtrusively at the agreed time; remain silent throughout the lesson	Monthly
3	Provide individual feedback to the observed teacher	Feedback form, 1-on-1 meeting notes	Observer + Teacher	1. Teacher becomes defensive and disengages from the feedback 2. Feedback is too vague to be actionable; no specific improvement areas identified 3. Feedback delivered in a public or group setting, embarrassing the teacher 4. No follow-up to check whether the feedback has been acted upon	1. Deliver feedback privately in a 1-on-1 meeting; use a coaching rather than a judgmental tone 2. Use the observation rubric to anchor feedback to specific, observable behaviours with concrete examples 3. All observation feedback to be delivered in a private, confidential meeting — never in a group setting 4. Schedule a follow-up observation within 4 weeks to assess whether agreed improvements have been implemented	Within 48 hours of observation
4	Prepare and distribute learner feedback forms to classes	Paper or digital feedback forms	Class Teachers	1. Learners provide dishonest or superficial responses due to fear of identification 2. Feedback forms distributed and collected in front of the subject teacher, compromising anonymity 3. Low response rate due to poor timing (e.g. before a test or late in the day) 4. Feedback not collected from all classes; a partial data set is used for analysis	1. Ensure anonymity is guaranteed and clearly communicated to learners before they complete the form 2. Class teacher to distribute and collect feedback forms in the absence of the subject teacher 3. Schedule feedback collection during a calm period in the day — not immediately before examinations 4. Track form distribution and collection across all classes; follow up any class where forms were not returned	Mid-term and end of term

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
5	Analyse learner and staff feedback data	Feedback forms, Excel or analysis tool	QA Officer / HOS	1. Misinterpretation of feedback leads to incorrect conclusions about teacher performance 2. Analysis conducted using only feedback data without cross-referencing with observations 3. Data not analysed promptly; findings become less relevant by the time they are shared 4. Analysis not disaggregated by year group or subject, masking important trends	1. Cross-analyse feedback data with observation records, learner results and scheme of work reviews 2. QA Officer to triangulate feedback from at least three sources before drawing any conclusions 3. Complete feedback analysis within one week of collection; share findings at the end-of-term staff meeting 4. Disaggregate all analysis by year group, subject and teacher; present disaggregated findings to HODs	Within 1 week of collection
6	Share key findings and recommendations with all teaching staff	Summary report, Staff meeting	QA Lead	1. Staff feel demotivated by negative findings if not presented constructively 2. Key findings shared only with HODs and not cascaded to all classroom teachers 3. No action plan developed from the findings; the cycle repeats without improvement 4. Staff meeting dominated by other agenda items; QA findings receive insufficient attention	1. Frame all findings as growth opportunities; highlight strengths before areas for improvement 2. Share a written QA summary report with all teaching staff, not only HODs 3. For every finding, include a specific recommended action and responsible owner with a deadline 4. Reserve dedicated time on the staff meeting agenda for QA findings; do not allow it to be displaced	End of each term
7	Analyse student assessment results to identify performance trends	Test results, Mark sheets, Analysis software	Subject Teachers + HODs	1. Incomplete or unverified data used in the analysis, leading to inaccurate conclusions 2. Analysis conducted at the class level only; school-wide trends not identified 3. HOD not involved in the analysis; results reviewed by the subject teacher in isolation 4. Analysis of results not compared against previous terms; improvement or decline not detected	1. Ensure all marks are entered and verified before analysis begins; HOD to sign off on completeness 2. Compile a school-wide results analysis in addition to subject and class-level analysis 3. HOD to lead or co-lead the analysis with each subject teacher; do not leave analysis to the individual teacher 4. Include a comparison against the previous term's results in every analysis report	After each assessment cycle
8	Identify specific learning gaps from performance data	Performance data, Gap analysis template	Teachers	1. Bias towards focusing on the strongest or weakest learners, missing the middle cohort 2. Learning gaps identified but not documented; no systematic approach to addressing them 3. The same learning gaps recur each term without any structural intervention 4. Learning gap analysis not shared with the HOD for departmental oversight	1. Use an evidence-based, structured gap analysis template covering all performance bands 2. Document all identified learning gaps in the lesson plan for the following unit 3. Escalate any recurring learning gap to the HOD with a proposed intervention plan 4. Submit the learning gap analysis to the HOD within 5 days of receiving the results	Ongoing — after each assessment cycle
9	Adjust teaching plans to address identified gaps	Lesson plans, Curriculum map	Teachers	1. Time constraints prevent meaningful revision of teaching plans 2. Adjusted plans not shared with the HOD before implementation 3. Adjustments address surface symptoms rather than	1. Prioritise the top three learning gaps for each class; address these within the next teaching cycle 2. Submit revised lesson plans to the HOD for review before implementing them in class 3. Identify the underlying cause of the learning gap (misconception, pace, prior	Within 1 week of gap analysis

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
				the underlying learning gap 4. Teachers make adjustments independently without consulting colleagues teaching the same subject	knowledge) before adjusting plans 4. All teachers of the same subject to review and align their adjusted plans together in a departmental meeting	
10	Submit schemes of work and lesson plans for peer review	Curriculum documents, Peer review checklist	Teachers	1. Low engagement from peer reviewers leads to superficial or uncommitted feedback 2. Peer review process not completed before the new term begins 3. Reviewers avoid giving critical feedback to protect collegial relationships 4. No clear criteria for the peer review; different reviewers assess different things	1. Assign rotating review partners each term to prevent familiarity bias 2. Set a firm peer review submission and return deadline at least 1 week before the new term starts 3. Provide a structured peer review form with specific criteria; anonymous submissions encouraged 4. Provide all reviewers with a structured checklist so all reviewers assess the same criteria consistently	Twice a term
11	Identify CPD training needs from observations and feedback	Evaluation reports, Teacher feedback	HOD + QA Coordinator	1. Training needs identified but not prioritised; too many topics pursued simultaneously 2. Training needs identified for individual teachers but whole-staff workshops are planned instead 3. HOD's own professional development needs not considered in the CPD planning 4. CPD needs identified but not actioned due to budget constraints	1. Prioritise the top two or three high-impact training needs per term; do not pursue too many topics at once 2. Differentiate between whole-staff CPD needs and individual coaching needs; plan both separately 3. Include HOD and senior teacher CPD needs in the planning cycle 4. Include CPD in the school budget planning at the start of the year; do not allow it to be deprioritised	Mid-term review
12	Organise and deliver CPD workshops for teaching staff	Trainers, Venue, Workshop materials	SMT	1. Low attendance or disengagement from staff during CPD sessions 2. CPD content not relevant to the identified needs of teachers 3. No follow-up to assess whether learning from the CPD has been applied 4. CPD scheduled during peak operational periods when teachers are unavailable or distracted	1. Design sessions to be participatory and practically relevant; avoid lecture-only formats 2. Base all CPD content directly on the training needs identified in the evaluation and observation data 3. Schedule a follow-up observation or check-in within 6 weeks to assess application of new learning 4. Schedule CPD sessions during low-intensity periods in the school calendar; avoid examination weeks	Once per term minimum
13	Monitor implementation of new practices from CPD	Observation tools, Implementation checklist	QA Team	1. New practices learned in CPD not applied in the classroom after the session 2. Monitoring not conducted systematically; follow-up is informal and inconsistent 3. Staff revert to old practices within a few weeks without reinforcement 4. Positive implementation not recognised or acknowledged, reducing motivation to continue	1. Include implementation of CPD learning as a specific focus area in the next scheduled observation 2. Use a structured implementation checklist to assess new practice adoption consistently across all staff 3. Schedule coaching check-ins within 2 and 4 weeks of each CPD session to reinforce new practices 4. Publicly acknowledge staff who are successfully implementing new practices in staff meetings	Ongoing — following each CPD session
14	Compile the termly QA report	QA templates, Feedback data, Observation	QA Officer	1. Inconsistent data collection across terms makes it difficult to track trends over time 2. Report produced without input from HODs, missing	1. Use standardised QA templates every term to ensure data comparability across terms 2. HODs to provide a departmental summary to the QA Officer at least 3 days	Termly

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
		scores		important departmental context 3. Report not submitted by the end-of-term deadline 4. Report is descriptive only; no recommendations included	before the report deadline 3. Set and enforce the QA report deadline; it must be submitted before the final staff meeting of the term 4. Every QA report to include a minimum of three specific, actionable recommendations with named owners	
15	Present QA findings to school leadership	PowerPoint presentation , Summary briefs	DHOC / QA Lead	1. Leadership does not act on the findings; the same issues recur each term 2. Presentation is data-heavy but does not connect findings to strategic priorities 3. Not all members of the SMT are present at the presentation 4. Findings presented but no follow-up on the previous term's recommendations	1. Each QA presentation to open with a review of actions taken on the previous term's recommendations 2. Connect each key finding explicitly to the school's strategic priorities and development plan 3. Schedule the leadership QA presentation as a fixed item in the SMT calendar at the start of each term 4. Require the SMT to formally assign an owner and deadline to each recommendation during the presentation meeting	End of each term

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Approved by: _____ Date: _____

Head of Centre (HOC) Signature

SOP 09: Local Trips

Purpose: To provide a structured, safe and educationally purposeful framework for organising and executing all local off-site trips undertaken by MSIS learners, ensuring proper approval, preparation, supervision and post-trip reporting.
Scope: Applies to Class Teachers, the Trips Committee, School Administrator, HOS, Cateress, Trip Staff and all accompanying staff. Covers the full local trip cycle from destination selection through to post-trip review.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Destination selection for the local trip	List of local educational sites, Past trip records	Class Teacher / Trips Committee	1. Repetitive destinations reduce learner engagement and educational value 2. Destination selected without verifying its suitability or accessibility for the age group 3. Destination chosen without checking operational status or availability on the proposed date 4. Learner input not considered, reducing ownership and excitement	1. Vary destinations each term; consult the past trip records before making a selection 2. Research each proposed destination to confirm it is age-appropriate and fully accessible 3. Contact the destination at least 4 weeks before to confirm availability and operational status 4. Where appropriate, allow learners to suggest or vote on destination preferences during class meetings	First week of term
2	Trip proposal submission and approval	Trip proposal form, Trip calendar	Trips Committee / School Administrator	1. Delay in approval disrupts transport and destination booking timelines 2. Proposal submitted without all required information, causing back-and-forth delays 3. Request letter to the destination not sent promptly after approval 4. Trip approved without budget confirmation being in place	1. Submit proposal with all required details at least 3 weeks before the intended trip date 2. Use a standardised trip proposal form that captures all required information before submission 3. Send the formal request letter to the destination within 48 hours of receiving internal approval 4. Confirm budget availability with the accountant before submitting the proposal for approval	First week of term
3	Parental notification and consent collection	Consent letters, Class communication platforms	HOS / Class Teacher	1. Parents unaware of the trip due to delayed or missed communication 2. Consent forms not returned by the deadline; learners unable to participate 3. Parents unaware of the trip cost; payment not made in time 4. Consent collected verbally only; no written record retained	1. Send trip notice and consent form to all parents at least 1 week before the trip date 2. Set a firm consent return deadline; follow up with non-respondents via phone call and SMS 3. Include clear payment details and deadlines in the initial notice; follow up with reminders 4. Only written or digitally signed consent to be accepted; verbal consent is not sufficient	At least 1 week before the trip
4	Transport arrangement and confirmation	School buses, Fuel, Driver schedule, Destination charges	School Administrator	1. Bus breakdown on the day of the trip with no contingency plan in place 2. Missing or expired vehicle documentation prevents the trip from proceeding 3. Driver not briefed on the route or scheduled departure and return times 4. Insufficient vehicle capacity for the number of learners travelling	1. Confirm transport booking in writing at least 1 week before; identify and brief a backup option 2. Check all vehicle documentation (insurance, road licence, inspection) at least 3 days before the trip 3. Brief the driver on the route, stops, departure time and expected return time at least 1 day before 4. Count confirmed participants and match to vehicle capacity before finalising transport arrangements	1 week before the trip
5	Meals, snacks and refreshmen	Menu plan, Catering	School Administrator	1. Dietary restrictions not considered, causing health risks for learners with	1. Collect information on all dietary restrictions and allergies from the class	1 week before the

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	t planning	supplies	/ Cateress	allergies 2. Insufficient food prepared due to inaccurate attendance figures 3. Food not packed hygienically, causing spoilage or food safety issues 4. Meal planning not communicated to the Cateress with enough lead time	teacher before planning 2. Base the quantity on the confirmed attendee list plus a 10% buffer 3. Use sealed, labelled food containers; avoid high-risk perishables for off-site trips 4. Inform the Cateress of the meal requirement at least 3 days before the trip	trip
6	Staff allocation and duty assignment for the trip	Staff duty roster, Attendance list	Trips Committee	1. Insufficient staff assigned relative to the number of learners travelling 2. Staff not informed of their specific roles and responsibilities before the trip 3. A key staff member cancels at the last minute with no replacement identified 4. Staff roles not communicated in writing; confusion on the day	1. Maintain a staff-to-learner ratio of at least 1:10 for all local trips 2. Issue a written duty roster to all assigned staff at least 3 days before the trip 3. Identify a named backup for each key role before the trip; brief the backup in advance 4. Communicate all roles and responsibilities in writing and confirm receipt with each staff member	1 week before the trip
7	Pre-trip briefing for learners and staff	Itinerary, Safety rules, Emergency contacts, Trip questionnaire	Class Teacher / Trip Staff	1. Learners unaware of behaviour expectations and safety rules during the trip 2. Staff not trained on first aid or emergency procedures before departure 3. Itinerary not shared with all accompanying staff 4. Briefing conducted too close to departure; insufficient time for questions	1. Conduct an in-class briefing for all learners covering behaviour expectations, safety rules and the itinerary 2. Confirm that at least one accompanying staff member holds a valid first aid certificate before the trip 3. Share the finalised itinerary with all accompanying staff at least 2 days before departure 4. Conduct the learner briefing at least 3 days before the trip; allow time for Q&A	3 days before the trip
8	Trip execution on the day	Travel checklist, Emergency contact list	All assigned staff / Administrator	1. A learner becomes ill or is injured during the trip 2. A learner goes missing during the trip 3. A learner arrives late and the group departs without them 4. Learner misbehaviour disrupts the visit for the entire group	1. Carry a fully equipped first aid kit and the school nurse's emergency contact on every trip 2. Conduct three mandatory head counts: before departure, at the destination, and before return 3. Conduct a full head count before departure; establish a clear late-arrival protocol before the day 4. Enforce the trip code of conduct consistently; remove disruptive learners from activities if necessary	On the day of the trip
9	Post-trip review and reporting	Trip report template, Learner feedback forms	Class Teacher / Trips Committee	1. Learner feedback forms and questionnaires not collected or filed after the trip 2. Post-trip report not submitted within the required timeframe 3. Incidents that occurred during the trip not documented in the report 4. Lessons from the trip not captured and used to improve future trips	1. Collect all learner feedback forms before learners are dismissed on return from the trip 2. Submit the completed post-trip report to the Trips Committee within 48 hours of return 3. Include a specific incident log section in every post-trip report; state 'none' if no incidents occurred 4. Trips Committee to review all post-trip reports and use findings to update the trip planning process	Within 48 hours of return

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Approved by: _____ Date: _____

Head of Centre (HOC) Signature

SOP 10: Educational Trips and Sports Events

Purpose: To provide a structured, safe and educationally purposeful framework for planning, approving and conducting all educational trips and sports events undertaken by MSIS learners, from initial proposal through to post-event evaluation.
Scope: Applies to Event Coordinators/Teachers in Charge, PE Staff, Class Teachers, Admin, Cateress, and HOC. Covers all off-site educational trips and sports events, including swimming and other physical activities, from proposal to post-event reporting.

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Identify event purpose, location, and activities (e.g. swimming, sports)	Event Proposal Request	Event Coordinator / Teacher in Charge	1. Poor alignment with school goals or curriculum 2. Safety issues at the proposed location not identified early 3. Event duplicates or clashes with another planned activity 4. Purpose of the event not clearly defined for approval	1. Ensure alignment with the curriculum and school calendar 2. Conduct an initial feasibility and safety review before proposing 3. Cross-check the school events calendar before submission 4. State clear learning or developmental objectives in the proposal	6 weeks before event
2	Seek event approval and budget approval	Event Approval Request, Budget Breakdown	Event Organiser (Teacher in Charge), HOC	1. Event denied due to insufficient justification 2. Event underfunded relative to actual costs 3. Approval delayed, compressing the planning window 4. Budget submitted without supporting cost breakdown	1. Provide detailed justification, risk assessment, and cost estimate 2. Benchmark costs against similar past events before submission 3. Submit the request with adequate lead time for review 4. Attach itemised quotations to support the budget request	5–6 weeks before event
3	Conduct pre-visit to venue (sports facility/swimming pool)	Site Visit Report, Venue Safety Check	Event Organiser (Teacher in Charge)	1. Inadequate facilities discovered too late to adjust plans 2. Unknown hazards at the venue not identified in advance 3. Venue safety certification not verified 4. Emergency procedures at the venue not confirmed	1. Conduct an on-site inspection ahead of the event 2. Check facilities, equipment and hazard points directly 3. Request and verify the venue's safety certification 4. Confirm the venue's emergency procedures and contacts in writing	4–5 weeks before event
4	Book the venue, transport, and other logistics	Booking Confirmations, Transport Request Form, Requisition Form	Event Organiser (Teacher in Charge), Admin, Cateress	1. Overbooked or double-booked venue 2. Transport unavailable or unreliable on the day 3. Catering arrangements not confirmed in time 4. Logistics booked without written confirmation	1. Book early and confirm all bookings in writing 2. Use approved, vetted vendors and transporters only 3. Confirm catering requirements with Cateress in advance 4. Retain written confirmations as proof for all bookings	4 weeks before event
5	Send parent consent forms	Consent Form	Class Teachers, Teacher in Charge of the Activity	1. Students attend without signed parental consent 2. Consent forms lost or not returned on time 3. Medical information on the form incomplete 4. Non-responses not followed up before the deadline	1. Set a strict return deadline for consent forms 2. Follow up non-responses directly with parents by phone/SMS 3. Cross-check medical information against the school nurse's records 4. Withhold participation for any learner without a signed form	3 weeks before event
6	Submit list of participating students and staff	Final List of Attendees	Event Coordinator	1. Incomplete or inaccurate attendee records 2. Roster not cross-checked against consent returns 3. Staff-to-student supervision ratio not met 4. List submitted late, affecting	1. Double-check the roster against class registers 2. Cross-verify the list with signed consent returns 3. Confirm the supervision ratio meets school policy before finalising 4. Submit the final list within the	2–3 weeks before event

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
				transport and catering counts	agreed deadline	
7	Risk assessment for swimming and sports activities	Risk Assessment Form (incl. water safety)	PE Teacher, Event Coordinator	1. Drowning or near-drowning during swimming activities 2. Injury from sports equipment or physical exertion 3. Heat stroke or dehydration during outdoor activities 4. Risk assessment not reviewed or signed off before the event	1. Deploy qualified lifeguards and trained first aiders 2. Provide shaded rest areas and enforce hydration breaks 3. Ensure the risk assessment is signed off by the HOC 4. Brief all supervising staff on the risk assessment findings	2–3 weeks before event
8	Allocate roles: supervision, first aid, team coaches	Staff Roles and Responsibilities	Event Coordinator	1. Supervision gaps at high-risk points of the event 2. Roles assigned without confirming staff availability 3. First aid coverage not confirmed for the full duration 4. Ambiguity over who is responsible for specific groups	1. Assign specific groups of learners to named staff 2. Brief all staff clearly on their roles beforehand 3. Confirm first aid coverage for the entire event duration 4. Circulate a written roles and responsibilities sheet to all staff	1–2 weeks before event
9	Pre-trip student briefing (rules, gear, behaviour, safety)	Briefing Notes, Packing List	Student Teachers	1. Misconduct due to unclear behavioural expectations 2. Missing gear or equipment on the day 3. Students unaware of safety rules for the activity 4. Briefing not acknowledged or understood by all students	1. Give clear, written instructions ahead of the trip 2. Require a signed acknowledgement of rules from each student 3. Provide a checked packing list well in advance 4. Confirm understanding through a short question and answer session	1 week before event
10	Final communication to parents (itinerary, reminders)	Final Communication to Parents, Packing Checklist	Teachers	1. Parents unaware of last-minute updates or changes 2. Itinerary details inconsistent across communication channels 3. Pickup/drop-off times not clearly communicated 4. Emergency contact details not reconfirmed	1. Send digital and group message reminders to all parents 2. Keep itinerary details consistent across all channels used 3. State pickup/drop-off times clearly in the final communication 4. Reconfirm emergency contact details in the same message	1 week before event
11	On the day: transport, roll calls, supervision	Roll Call Sheets, First Aid Kit, Emergency Contact List	All Attending Staff	1. Late arrival affecting the event schedule 2. Injury during transport or transition between locations 3. Lost or unaccounted-for student 4. Roll call not conducted at a key transition point	1. Conduct roll calls at departure, arrival, and return 2. Use a buddy system throughout the event 3. Maintain visible staff presence at all transition points 4. Carry the emergency contact list and first aid kit at all times	Day of event
12	During event: manage activities, monitor safety	Whistles, Equipment	PE Staff, Lifeguards, Teachers	1. Overexertion or heat-related illness during activity 2. Conflict or unsafe behaviour between students 3. Injury from equipment misuse 4. Safety monitoring lapses during high-activity periods	1. Schedule hydration breaks and rest periods 2. Maintain visible, active staff presence throughout 3. Enforce correct equipment use and supervision at all times 4. Rotate supervising staff to sustain alertness during the event	During event
13	Return journey and dismissal	Roll Call, Parent Pickup List	All Staff	1. Student left behind or not picked up 2. Miscount during the final roll call 3. Parent pickup list not matched against collectors 4. Dismissal chaos due to lack of a structured process	1. Confirm all students are accounted for before departure 2. Use the parent contact list to verify each pickup 3. Match collectors against the approved pickup list 4. Follow a structured, staff-supervised dismissal process	End of day
14	Post-event	Staff Feedback,	Event	1. Unresolved issues from the event	1. Hold a staff debrief meeting soon	Within 1

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	debriefs and report	Incident Report (if needed), Evaluation Form	Coordinator, Staff	left undocumented 2. Missed learning goals not identified for future events 3. Incident, if any, not formally reported 4. Feedback not collected while still fresh	after the event 2. Conduct an incident review where applicable 3. Collect feedback from staff and students promptly 4. File the evaluation form for reference in future planning	week after event

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Approved by: _____ Date: _____

Head of Centre (HOC) Signature

SOP 11: Internal Exams

Purpose: To ensure internally set examinations are prepared, proofread, printed, packed, stored, distributed and collected in a secure, accurate and timely manner.
Scope: Applies to Subject Teachers, HOS, HODs, Subject Experts, School Administrator, Receptionist, and Invigilators. Covers the process from setting of exams through to collection of completed scripts.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Setting of exams	Syllabus, Schemes of Work, Exam Templates, Assessment Objectives	Subject Teachers	1. Late submission of exam papers 2. Poor quality exams not aligned with the syllabus 3. Assessment objectives not fully covered 4. Exam templates used inconsistently	1. Set clear deadlines and provide guidelines 2. Align every paper with the syllabus and schemes of work 3. Cross-check coverage against assessment objectives 4. Use the standard exam template for all subjects	Two weeks before exams commence
2	Proofreading of exams	Proofreading Checklist	HOS, HODs, Subject Experts	1. Rushing to complete the task 2. Errors in exam content going undetected 3. Proofreading done by only one reviewer 4. Checklist not used consistently	1. Create enough time for thorough proofreading 2. Use a structured checklist and double-check content 3. Involve a second, independent reviewer 4. Require sign-off on the proofreading checklist	Two weeks before exams commence
3	Submission for printing	Final Exam Copies (soft copy)	HOS, HODs, Administrator	1. Loss or corruption of exam files 2. Unsecured transfer of exam files 3. Wrong version submitted for printing 4. Submission delayed beyond the deadline	1. Use secure submission channels (USB/email backup) 2. Password-protect exam files during transfer 3. Confirm the final version before submission 4. Enforce the submission deadline strictly	Two weeks before exams
4	Printing of exams	Printer, Printing Papers, Printing Log	School Administrator, Reception ist	1. Printing errors affecting exam quality 2. Leakage of exam content during printing 3. Printing conducted in an unsecured location 4. Printing log not maintained	1. Print in a controlled environment 2. Maintain a printing log for every exam printed 3. Restrict access to the printing room during the process 4. Verify printed copies for accuracy before packing	One week before exams
5	Packing exams into pockets	Exam Pockets, Masking Tape, Permanent Markers, Packing List	HOS, HOD and Subject Teachers	1. Misplacement or wrong subject grouping 2. Missing papers within a packet 3. Packing done without cross-checking 4. Pockets not clearly labelled	1. Cross-check each packet with the subject list 2. Count papers against the expected class size before sealing 3. Label each pocket clearly with subject and class 4. Have a second person verify the packing	3–5 days before exams
6	Storage of packed exams	Storage Room Logbook	HOS	1. Unauthorized access to exams 2. Storage room left unlocked 3. Access not logged 4. Exams stored in an unsuitable location	1. Use secure storage with limited access 2. Keep the storage room locked at all times 3. Log every access to the storage room 4. Store exams in a dedicated, secure location	Until day of exams
7	Distribution on exam day	Distribution Schedule, Exam Registers	HOS, HODs, Invigilators	1. Late collection of papers by invigilators 2. Wrong pocket distributed to the	1. Plan and confirm early preparation of the distribution schedule 2. Cross-check pockets against the	On exam day

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
				wrong room 3. Distribution schedule not followed 4. Registers not used during distribution	room allocation before distribution 3. Follow the distribution schedule strictly 4. Use the exam register to confirm receipt	
8	Collection of the exams done	Marked Exams Registers	HOS, Invigilators	1. Learners hiding their exam paper 2. Scripts miscounted at collection 3. Collection register not used consistently 4. Missing scripts not identified before leaving the room	1. Use the exam register when collecting the scripts 2. Count scripts against the class register before dismissal 3. Verify all scripts are accounted for before leaving the room 4. Report any missing script immediately to the HOS	On exam day

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Approved by: _____ Date: _____

Head of Centre (HOC) Signature

SOP 12: Examination Administration, Marking and Reporting

Purpose: To ensure that all internal examinations at MSIS are administered fairly, marked consistently and results reported accurately and on time to all stakeholders.
Scope: Applies to the Exam Officer, Academic Head, Subject Teachers, Moderators, Academic Committee, Support Staff, Invigilators, Class Teachers and Admin. Covers the full internal examination cycle from timetable development to performance analysis and reporting.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Develop and publish the examination timetable	Academic calendar, Subject list	Exam Officer + Academic Head	1. Two or more examinations scheduled simultaneously for the same learner group 2. Timetable not circulated to learners and teachers with sufficient notice 3. Timetable conflicts with a major school event or national holiday 4. Subject teachers not consulted before the timetable is finalised	1. Review all subject allocations across year groups before drafting the timetable; check for clashes 2. Circulate the draft timetable to HODs at least 3 weeks before examinations for review 3. Cross-reference the draft timetable with the school calendar and Ministry of Education holiday schedule 4. Consult all HODs and confirm subject teacher availability before finalising the timetable	4 weeks before examinations
2	Request or set internal examination papers	Exam templates, Past papers, Marking guides	Subject Teachers	1. Examination papers submitted after the stipulated deadline 2. Papers set without reference to the current scheme of work or syllabus 3. Poorly formatted papers cause confusion during the examination 4. Sensitive examination content shared informally before the examination	1. Set clear paper submission deadlines communicated in writing; issue reminders 5 days before the deadline 2. Each question to be linked explicitly to a topic covered in the scheme of work 3. Provide all teachers with a standardised examination paper template 4. Treat all submitted papers as confidential; handle and store on a strict need-to-know basis	3 weeks before examinations
3	Moderate and approve all examination papers	Moderation rubric, Review checklist	Academic Committee	1. Moderation not completed before papers go to print 2. Poor quality questions or factual errors not caught during moderation 3. Moderation conducted by the same teacher who set the paper 4. Papers approved without a second check of the marking guide	1. Complete moderation at least 2 weeks before examinations; no paper to go to print before moderation 2. Use a structured moderation rubric covering accuracy, clarity, curriculum alignment and difficulty balance 3. Assign an independent HOD or senior teacher to moderate each paper; setters cannot self-moderate 4. Review the marking guide as part of the moderation process; confirm it aligns with the paper	2 weeks before examinations
4	Prepare and inspect all examination rooms	Desks, Spacing plan, Invigilator allocation	Support Staff	1. Insufficient spacing between desks increases the risk of copying 2. Examination rooms not inspected before learners are seated 3. Required materials (answer booklets, water, clock) not in the room before the session 4. Unauthorised materials (textbooks, notes) left in the examination room	1. Pre-arrange all desks in accordance with the approved spacing plan; inspect before each session 2. Conduct a full room inspection checklist at least 1 day before examinations begin 3. Ensure all required materials are in each room before learners are admitted 4. Remove all potentially unauthorised materials from every examination room before learners enter	1 day before examinations
5	Distribute sealed examination papers to invigilators	Sealed paper envelopes, Distribution register	Exam Officer	1. Papers opened before learners are seated and the session is formally started 2. Wrong paper distributed to the wrong examination room 3. Distribution not documented; disputes arise over which	1. Open sealed envelopes only in front of invigilators, immediately before learners are admitted 2. Cross-check the subject, year group and room before handing each envelope to the invigilator 3. Maintain a signed distribution register; invigilator to sign on receipt of each sealed	30 minutes before each session

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
				invigilator received which paper 4. Distribution happens too early, increasing risk of leakage or tampering	envelope 4. Distribute papers no earlier than 30 minutes before each session; maintain control at all times	
6	Supervise examinations in accordance with approved procedures	Attendance register, Exams papers & Answer booklets	Invigilators	1. Malpractice occurs and is not detected or acted upon during the session 2. Learners using unauthorised materials (phones, notes) not identified 3. Invigilators sitting for extended periods without patrolling the room 4. Disruptions during the examination are not managed promptly	1. Implement and enforce clear pre-examination rules: no phones, no bags, silence maintained throughout 2. Require all mobile phones and bags to be stored outside the examination room before the session starts 3. Invigilators to patrol the room continuously; no sitting for extended periods during active examinations 4. Handle any disruption immediately; remove disruptive learners from the examination room	During each examination session
7	Collect and account for all scripts after each session	Script collection register, Security seals	Invigilators + Exam Officer	1. Scripts lost between collection and secure storage 2. Scripts collected without being counted against the attendance register 3. Scripts mixed up between year groups or subjects during collection 4. Scripts accessed by unauthorised individuals after collection	1. Count all collected scripts against the examination attendance register before leaving the room 2. Seal scripts in labelled envelopes immediately after counting; invigilator signs the sealed envelope 3. Label every bundle clearly with subject, year group, date and number of scripts 4. Hand sealed scripts directly to the Exam Officer or HOC; no scripts to be left unattended	Immediately after each session
8	Distribute scripts to subject teachers for marking	Answer scripts, Marking guide	Exam Officer	1. Scripts distributed to the wrong subject teacher 2. Scripts distributed without the approved marking guide 3. No record of which teacher received which scripts 4. Scripts lost or damaged between distribution and marking	1. Cross-check each bundle against the subject list before distributing to teachers 2. Issue the approved marking guide with every set of scripts; marking may not begin without it 3. Maintain a signed script distribution log; teacher to sign for receipt of each bundle 4. Scripts to be carried in sealed envelopes; teachers to sign for collection and return	Within 1 day after examinations
9	Mark scripts and conduct moderation of marks	Marking scheme, Moderation rubric	Subject Teachers + Moderators	1. Inconsistent marking between teachers within the same subject 2. Marking scheme applied incorrectly, leading to inaccurate marks 3. No moderation of borderline or high-stakes results 4. Marking completed after the deadline, delaying the reporting cycle	1. Conduct a marking standardisation meeting with all teachers marking the same subject before marking begins 2. All teachers to mark strictly to the approved marking scheme; HOD to review a sample of scripts 3. Moderate all borderline results; conduct a second marking for any script that the first marker flags 4. Issue and enforce a firm marking deadline; HOD to collect all marked scripts on the due date	Within 1 week of examinations
10	Record all results accurately in the mark sheets and school system	Mark sheets, Student lists	Class Teachers + Admin	1. Data entry errors result in incorrect marks being recorded for learners 2. Results entered for the wrong learner or the wrong subject 3. Marks entered without cross-checking against the marked scripts 4. Results not entered within the deadline, delaying report generation	1. Apply double-entry verification: two different staff members check all marks before finalising 2. Cross-reference each mark entry against the student ID and subject on the marked script 3. All data entry to be verified against the signed mark sheets before submission 4. Complete all mark entry within 3 days of receiving marked scripts from teachers	Within 3 days of marking deadline
11	Analyse performance	Performance analysis	Academic Committe	1. Analysis based on incomplete data if not all marks are submitted	1. Confirm all marks are submitted and verified before commencing analysis	Within 1 week

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	data and prepare the examination report	tools, Grade distributions	e	on time 2. Misinterpretation of data leads to incorrect conclusions in the report 3. Report produced without comparing current performance against previous terms 4. Analysis completed but recommendations not acted upon in the following term	2. Use school management software or validated analysis tools; have a second committee member review conclusion 3. Include a comparative analysis against the previous term's and year's results in every report 4. Present the analysis to the Academic Head with specific, actionable recommendations for the next term	after examinati on marking

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Approved by: _____ Date: _____
Head of Centre (HOC) Signature

SOP 13: Examination Paper Preparation and Security

Purpose: To ensure all internal examination papers at MSIS are prepared to a high standard, treated as strictly confidential, and that full paper security is maintained throughout the preparation, printing, storage and distribution process.
Scope: Applies to Subject Teachers, HODs, HOS, the School Administrator and all invigilators involved in the examination paper process. Covers the full examination paper lifecycle from setting through to secure destruction of surplus copies.

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Subject teachers set examination papers aligned to the syllabus	Syllabus, Schemes of work, Exam templates, Assessment objectives	Subject Teachers	1. Questions set outside the scope of the taught syllabus content 2. Examination paper submitted after the deadline, disrupting the moderation schedule 3. Poor quality questions that do not adequately test the stated learning objectives 4. Setting process completed without reference to the approved assessment objectives	1. Cross-reference every question against the scheme of work and assessment objectives before submission 2. Communicate deadlines in writing at least 3 weeks before examinations; enforce them without exception 3. Provide all teachers with a question quality checklist; HOD to review against it before accepting submission 4. Require all question papers to include explicit reference to the assessment objective being tested	2 weeks before examinations
2	HOD / HOS proofreads all submitted papers using a structured checklist	Proofreading checklist	HOD / HOS	1. Errors or ambiguous questions reach the examination room and are discovered only during the session 2. Proofreading conducted by the teacher who set the paper, missing the independent review requirement 3. Insufficient time allocated to proofreading; checklist not completed thoroughly 4. Post-proofreading amendments made without being reviewed and re-approved	1. Assign an independent senior teacher or HOD who did not set the paper to proofread each submission 2. Use a structured proofreading checklist covering accuracy, clarity, formatting and curriculum alignment 3. Allocate a minimum of 2 dedicated proofreading days; do not allow last-day submission and same-day printing 4. Any post-proofreading amendments to be reviewed and signed off by the HOS before the paper proceeds to print	1–2 weeks before examinations
3	Final papers submitted to Admin for printing via a secure channel	Submission log, Final soft copies	HOS / Admin	1. Unauthorised access to digital examination files before printing 2. Incorrect version of the paper submitted to print after amendments 3. Soft copy files lost or corrupted before printing 4. Paper submitted before HOS has signed off on the final proofread version	1. Submit all papers via the school's secure, designated channel only; password-protect all files 2. Include a clear version label on every file (e.g. V2_Final); Admin to reject any file not labelled as Final 3. Maintain both a primary digital copy and a USB backup of every paper before submission 4. Submission to Admin only after HOS has signed and dated the covering submission form	1 week before examinations
4	Papers printed in a restricted, access-controlled environment	Printing log	Admin	1. Examination paper leakage during the printing process through unauthorised observers 2. Printing errors (cut-off text, blurred images) not detected before distribution 3. Extra copies printed but not accounted for, increasing leakage risk 4. Printing area not secured; unauthorised staff enter during printing	1. Printing to take place in a locked, access-controlled room; log all persons present during every print run 2. Print a single test copy for quality check before the full print run; inspect carefully for errors 3. Count and record all copies printed; shred any misprints immediately in the locked room 4. No person other than those explicitly authorised by the HOS may enter the print room during printing	1 week before examinations
5	Papers packed per subject and class, sealed	Packing checklist, Sealed packets,	HOS / Admin	1. Wrong papers placed in a subject packet, discovered only in the examination room 2. Packets sealed without all required	1. Cross-check every packet against the approved packing list before sealing; second person must verify 2. Count the number of scripts in each packet	3–5 days before examinations

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	and labelled	Labels		copies being included 3. Packets not labelled clearly, causing confusion during distribution 4. Packing completed without a second person cross-checking	against the class register before sealing 3. Label each packet clearly with: Subject, Year Group, Class, Date, Number of Scripts 4. Require a second member of staff to countersign the packing checklist before any packet is sealed	
6	Sealed packets stored in a locked, access-controlled room until examination day	Storage log, Access register	HOS	1. Unauthorised access to the storage room and possible tampering with packets 2. Packets stored in a location accessible to learners or non-authorised staff 3. Storage room key held by multiple people, making access control ineffective 4. Damaged packets discovered on examination day with no time to reprint	1. Only the HOS holds the key to the examination storage room; no exceptions 2. Store all packets in a secure, lockable cabinet inside a restricted-access room away from learner areas 3. Maintain an access log; record every entry to the storage room with name, date and reason 4. Inspect all sealed packets on the day before distribution; replace any damaged packet immediately	Until examination day
7	Papers distributed to invigilators on the morning of each examination	Distribution register	HOS	1. Wrong paper distributed to the wrong examination room 2. Distribution happens too early, giving invigilators unsupervised access to sealed packets 3. Invigilator fails to sign the distribution register, leaving no record of receipt 4. Papers opened before learners are seated and the examination has formally started	1. Cross-check room, subject, year group and class before handing each sealed packet to the invigilator 2. Distribute papers no earlier than 30 minutes before the session; HOS to personally oversee distribution 3. Require every invigilator to sign the distribution register against the specific paper received 4. Sealed packets to be opened only in the examination room, in front of seated learners, at the formal start	Examination morning — 30 minutes before sessions
8	All unused or surplus papers destroyed securely after each session	Destruction log	HOS / Admin	1. Surplus examination papers accessed by learners after the session ends 2. Papers not destroyed on the same day as the examination session 3. Destruction carried out without being witnessed and logged 4. Surplus copies left in the examination room after the session by an invigilator	1. Shred or burn all surplus and misprinted papers immediately after the session concludes; do not leave overnight 2. Destruction to take place on the same day as the examination session; no carry-over to the next day 3. Destruction to be witnessed by at least one other staff member and recorded in the destruction log 4. Invigilators to return all surplus papers to the HOS immediately after collecting scripts; no papers left in exam rooms	Immediately after each examination session

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Approved by: _____ Date: _____

Head of Centre (HOC) Signature

SOP 14: Disciplinary Procedure – Learners

Purpose: To ensure that all learner misconduct at MSIS is addressed in a consistent, fair and restorative manner that protects the dignity of the learner while maintaining the school's standards and values.
Scope: Applies to all teaching staff, the DHOC or Discipline Officer, the Discipline Committee, Secretary to the Committee, School Admin and HOC. Covers all levels of learner misconduct from identification through to appeal and monitoring.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Observe and document the misconduct incident	Incident report form	Any staff member	1. Incident report reflects bias or contains only a one-sided account 2. Incident not reported due to uncertainty about whether it qualifies for formal reporting 3. Report submitted without all relevant facts, weakening any subsequent disciplinary action 4. Incident documented on informal notes rather than the official form, creating a records gap	1. Use the standard, objective incident report form for every reported incident without exception 2. Brief all staff at the start of each year that any observed misconduct must be reported 3. Complete all sections of the report form; do not submit a partial report 4. All incident documentation must be on the official form; informal notes are not an acceptable substitute	Immediately upon occurrence
2	Submit the incident report to administration	Student file, Completed incident report form	Class Teacher or Reporting Staff Member	1. Delayed submission allows the incident to be forgotten or downplayed 2. Report submitted to the wrong person, causing it to go unactioned 3. Submitted report not acknowledged; uncertainty about whether it has been received 4. Multiple reports of the same incident submitted, creating conflicting accounts	1. Submit the report within 24 hours of the incident; same-day submission is strongly preferred 2. All reports to be submitted directly to the DHOC or Discipline Officer 3. Admin to issue a written acknowledgement of receipt within 24 hours of receiving the report 4. Only one official report per incident; if multiple witnesses are involved, compile a single combined report	Within 24 hours of incident
3	Notify parents or guardians if required	Phone, Written communication	Secretary to the Disciplinary Committee	1. Miscommunication about the nature of the incident causes unnecessary alarm or minimises serious issues 2. Parent contacted by phone only; no written record of what was communicated 3. Parent cannot be reached; notification not attempted through alternative channels 4. Notification delayed beyond 48 hours, giving the impression the school is not taking the matter seriously	1. Use factual, neutral language when informing parents; avoid speculative or emotive language 2. Follow all verbal notification with a written note or message; retain a copy in the learner's file 3. Attempt contact via all available channels: phone, SMS, WhatsApp and emergency contact 4. Complete all parent notification within 24–48 hours of the incident being reported	Within 24–48 hours
4	Gather statements from the student and all witnesses	Written statement forms	DHOC or Discipline Officer	1. Incomplete or inconsistent accounts due to witnesses not being interviewed separately 2. Student or witness feels pressured and does not give an honest account 3. Statements taken informally; not in writing, making them difficult to rely on 4. Witness statements gathered long after the incident, affecting their accuracy	1. Interview the student and all witnesses separately to avoid collusion or pressure 2. Conduct all interviews in a private, neutral environment; use open, non-leading questions 3. All statements to be written, signed and dated by the person giving the account 4. Complete all witness interviews within 2 school days of the incident being reported	Within 2 school days of report
5	Review all available evidence including	Evidence folder, CCTV footage	Discipline Officer	1. Evidence misinterpreted or taken out of context 2. Only one source of evidence used; other relevant evidence	1. Review evidence from multiple sources; do not rely on a single piece of evidence for any conclusion 2. Cross-reference CCTV footage against	Within 2 school days of report

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	CCTV and past records			overlooked 3. CCTV footage deleted or unavailable before it can be reviewed 4. Past records reviewed selectively, creating a biased picture of the student's history	written accounts before drawing conclusions 3. Request CCTV footage immediately after an incident is reported to prevent automatic deletion 4. Review the student's full discipline history; present it objectively as context, not as evidence of guilt	
6	Classify the offence — minor, major or gross misconduct	School Code of Conduct	Discipline Committee	1. Wrong classification leads to a disproportionate or insufficient consequence 2. Classification made without reference to the documented Code of Conduct 3. Inconsistent classification of similar offences across different learners 4. Classification agreed verbally without being recorded in writing	1. Apply the school's behaviour classification framework strictly; refer to the Code of Conduct at every classification 2. All classification decisions to be made by the committee with direct reference to the Code of Conduct 3. Apply the classification criteria consistently; keep a central record of previous classification decisions for reference 4. Record the classification and the rationale in writing before proceeding to the hearing stage	Immediately after evidence review
7	Schedule the hearing and notify all parties	Hearing notice, SMS, Email	School Admin	1. Parents not given sufficient notice to arrange attendance at the hearing 2. Hearing conducted without confirming that all relevant parties have been notified 3. Notification not delivered through a reliable channel; parties claim they were unaware 4. Hearing scheduled at a time that is inaccessible for the parent	1. Notify all parties of the hearing date at least 1–2 school days in advance 2. Confirm notification receipt from all parties before proceeding with the hearing 3. Use multiple channels for notification: phone, SMS and written notice 4. Offer an alternative hearing time if the scheduled slot is genuinely inaccessible for the parent	1–2 days before the hearing
8	Conduct the disciplinary hearing	Case file, Committee panel	Discipline Committee	1. Hearing conducted in a way that is perceived as biased or unfair 2. Student does not have the opportunity to present their account 3. Minutes of the hearing not recorded accurately 4. Committee member with a conflict of interest participates in the hearing	1. Use a structured hearing agenda and a pre-prepared checklist to ensure procedural fairness 2. Allow the student to present their account fully before the committee deliberates 3. Assign a designated minute-taker; all minutes to be reviewed and signed by the Chair before filing 4. Declare and manage conflicts of interest before the hearing; recuse any conflicted committee member	Within 3–5 days of incident
9	Decide and formally document the outcome	Decision form, Meeting notes	Committee Chair	1. Outcome decision is unclear or ambiguous, leading to disputed interpretation 2. Decision made and communicated without being formally recorded 3. Decision not grounded in the evidence and hearing record 4. Decision reached by the Chair alone rather than by committee consensus	1. Document the decision clearly and unambiguously on the official decision form 2. Record the outcome in writing before it is communicated to any party 3. Ensure the written decision references the evidence and statements considered during the hearing 4. All decisions to be made by majority or consensus of the full committee; the Chair does not decide alone	Immediately after hearing
10	Communicate the outcome to the student and parent	Decision letter, File note	Admin Office	1. Outcome communicated verbally only; parent disputes what they were told 2. Miscommunication of the decision leads to confusion about	1. Issue a written decision letter to the parent on the same day as the hearing outcome 2. Letter to state clearly the finding, the consequence and the conditions going	Same day as decision

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
				expectations going forward 3. Communication delayed; student and parent left uncertain about the outcome 4. Decision communicated before it has been formally recorded and signed off	forward 3. Decision to be communicated in person or by phone and confirmed by written letter 4. Issue the letter only after the decision form has been signed off by the Committee Chair	
11	Apply the disciplinary action	Warning letters, Suspension notices, Action log	Class Teacher + Admin	1. Disciplinary action applied inconsistently across different learners for similar offences 2. Action not implemented within the agreed timeframe after the decision 3. No record kept of the action taken, creating an accountability gap 4. Student continues in the same environment during suspension without oversight	1. Apply consequences strictly in line with the committee's decision; no ad hoc deviations 2. Implement the disciplinary action within 24 hours of the decision being communicated 3. Log every action taken in the student's discipline file with date, nature of action and staff signature 4. Ensure suspended learners are supervised and that work is provided during the suspension period	Within 24 hours of decision

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Approved by: _____ Date: _____

Head of Centre (HOC) Signature

SOP 15: Learner's Clearance

Purpose: To establish a consistent, comprehensive and properly documented clearance process for all learners leaving MSIS — whether at the end of the academic year, on withdrawal, or on transfer — ensuring all institutional obligations are settled before departure.
Scope: Applies to Admin, Class Teachers, HOS, HODs, Librarian, Head of Home, Accountant and HOC. Covers all learner clearance activities from issuance of the clearance form through to record archiving.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Issuance of clearance form to the departing learner	Clearance Form	Admin / Class Teacher	1. Delay in initiating the clearance process means the learner departs without completing it 2. Clearance form issued to the wrong learner due to name confusion 3. Learner or parent not informed of the clearance requirements in advance 4. Clearance form issued without a checklist of all required sign-offs	1. Issue the clearance form and checklist within 24 hours of confirmation of the learner's departure 2. Cross-check the learner's name and admission number before issuing the form 3. Communicate clearance requirements to the parent in writing at least one week before departure 4. Use a standardised clearance form that lists every department sign-off required; no blank sections accepted	Within 24 hours of departure confirmation
2	Verification of academic status by HOS and subject teachers	Academic records, Transcript, Progress reports	HOS / Subject Teachers / Class Teachers / HODs	1. Delays due to missing or incomplete academic records 2. Subject teacher unavailable to sign off within the required timeframe 3. Outstanding coursework or assessment not identified before sign-off 4. Wrong academic records reviewed due to a data entry error	1. Ensure all academic records are updated and verified before the clearance window opens 2. Set a 24-hour sign-off deadline for subject teachers; HOD to chase any outstanding sign-offs 3. HOD to confirm no outstanding coursework, assignments or missing marks before academic clearance is given 4. Admin to cross-check learner ID against the correct academic file before passing to HOS	Within 24 hours of form issuance
3	Library clearance — confirm all borrowed items are returned and charges settled	Library records, List of borrowed items	Librarian / Class Teacher	1. Unreturned textbooks or library materials not identified until after the learner has left 2. Outstanding library charges disputed due to lack of documentation 3. Library clearance given without physical verification of all returned items 4. Clearance blocked by a minor charge that was not communicated to the parent in advance	1. Notify the learner and parent of all outstanding library items and charges at least one week before clearance 2. Maintain an accurate, up-to-date borrowing log; use it as the reference for all library clearance checks 3. Librarian to physically verify all items are returned before signing the clearance form 4. Communicate any charges to the parent in writing; no clearance to be blocked for an undisclosed charge	Within 24 hours of form issuance
4	Dormitory clearance — room inspection and confirmation of no outstanding charges	Dorm occupancy report, Room inspection checklist	Head of Home / Dorm In-charges	1. Damaged property or missing dorm items not identified before the learner departs 2. Dorm clearance given without a physical room inspection being carried out 3. Outstanding boarding charges not communicated to the parent before clearance 4. Dorm records not up to date, making it impossible to identify responsibility for damage	1. Conduct a full room inspection before the learner's departure date; document all findings 2. No dorm clearance to be signed without a completed and signed room inspection checklist 3. Communicate all outstanding boarding charges to the parent in writing before they arrive for clearance 4. Update dorm records at the start of each term; conduct mid-term checks to maintain accuracy	Within 24 hours of form issuance
5	Departmental clearance — confirm all equipment	Departmental clearance form	HOD	1. Unreturned laboratory equipment, sports gear or project materials not identified 2. HOD signs clearance without physically verifying equipment has	1. Maintain a departmental issue log for all equipment given to learners; check it at clearance 2. HOD to physically verify that all issued items are returned before signing	Within 24 hours of form issuance

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	and project materials are returned			been returned 3. Issue log not maintained; no record of what the learner was issued 4. Learner returns damaged equipment but this is not recorded on the clearance form	the clearance form 3. Inform all learners of the departmental handover process at least one week before the clearance window 4. Note the condition of all returned items on the clearance form; do not accept damaged items without recording the damage	
6	Finance and Accounts clearance — confirm all outstanding fees and charges are settled	Fee statement, Outstanding balance report	Accountant	1. Outstanding payments not settled before the learner departs 2. Fee statement not updated with recent charges before clearance is assessed 3. Payment made but not reflected in the system due to a processing delay 4. Parent disputes the outstanding balance due to lack of prior communication	1. No accounts clearance to be given until all fees and charges are fully settled 2. Update the fee statement with all current charges before presenting it to the parent 3. Cross-check the payment record with the bank or M-Pesa statement before confirming clearance 4. Send a fee statement to the parent at least one week before clearance; allow time to resolve disputes	Within 24 hours of form issuance
7	Final review and approval of the consolidated clearance form	Consolidated clearance form	Admin / HOS	1. A department sign-off is missing from the form but not detected during final review 2. Final approval given before all sections of the form are complete 3. HOS signs off without confirming the accounts clearance has been obtained 4. Clearance approved for the wrong learner due to a form mix-up	1. Admin to check every section of the clearance form is signed before passing to HOS for final review 2. HOS to reject any clearance form with an incomplete or missing department sign-off 3. HOS to explicitly confirm that the accounts clearance section is signed before giving final approval 4. Cross-check learner name and admission number on the form before final approval is given	Within 24 hours of all sign-offs being obtained
8	Issuance of the clearance certificate to the learner	Finalised clearance form, Clearance certificate	Admin	1. Certificate issued before all clearance sections have been fully approved 2. Delay in issuing the certificate causes the learner to miss enrolment deadlines elsewhere 3. Certificate contains incorrect information due to a data entry error 4. Certificate handed to the wrong person due to inadequate identity verification	1. Issue the clearance certificate only after the fully completed and HOC-approved form is on file 2. Aim to issue the certificate on the same day as final approval; do not delay unnecessarily 3. Double-check all information on the certificate against the learner's file before printing 4. Verify the identity of the parent or person collecting the certificate before handover; require a signature	Same day as final approval
9	Record keeping — archive all clearance documentation	Digital archive, Clearance file	Admin	1. Loss or misplacement of physical clearance records after issuance 2. Digital records not backed up; data lost in case of system failure 3. Records filed under the wrong learner’s name or admission number 4. Clearance records not retained for the required period; unable to respond to future queries	1. Digitise all clearance records immediately after the process is complete; store in the learner's digital file 2. Back up all digital clearance records to a secure cloud or server at the end of each clearance cycle 3. File all records under the learner's admission number, not name only, to prevent misfiling 4. Retain all clearance records for a minimum of seven years after the learner's departure	Immediately after certificate issuance

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Approved by: _____ Date: _____

Head of Centre (HOC) Signature

SECTION B: BOARDING & RESIDENTIAL LIFE

SOP 16: Boarding Experience

Purpose: To ensure that all boarding learners at MSIS receive a safe, structured, nurturing and enriching residential experience that supports their academic performance, personal development and overall wellbeing.
Scope: Applies to HOD Home, Boarding Masters/Mistresses, TODs (Teachers on Duty), Dorm Prefects, School Nurse, Catering Team, Security Team and Housekeepers. Covers all aspects of the daily and weekly boarding routine.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Admission to boarding — orientation for new boarders and room allocation	Admission checklist	HOD Home / Boarding Master / Mistress	1. New boarders confused about dorm routines, rules and expectations due to inadequate orientation 2. Room allocation completed without considering year group, gender or medical requirements 3. Parents not briefed on boarding routines and communication channels at intake 4. New boarder's personal items not checked against the boarding list at admission	1. Conduct a structured boarding induction for all new boarders on the first day of each term; brief parents separately 2. Cross-reference room allocation against year group, gender and any documented medical or welfare requirements 3. Hold a parent boarding briefing at the start of each term covering rules, communication channels and visiting procedures 4. Check all new boarders' items against the official boarding list at check-in; record any discrepancies	At the start of each term or as needed
2	Daily routine implementation — wake-up, meals, prep, recreation and lights-out	Daily routine schedule, Boarders' programme	HOD Home / Boarding Staff / Dorm Prefects	1. Disorganisation due to absence of a structured daily programme 2. Routine not enforced consistently across different dorms 3. Learners missing key activities (prep, meals) without staff awareness 4. Routine not adapted during examination periods when learners need more study time	1. Display a clear daily routine schedule in every dorm; brief all boarding staff on it at the start of term 2. Apply the routine consistently in all dorms; HOD Home to conduct daily checks across dormitories 3. Roll call to be taken at every scheduled activity; absences reported to the TOD immediately 4. Review and adjust the boarding programme during examination periods to increase prep time allocation	Daily during the boarding experience
3	Supervision during prep time — TODs patrol and ensure productive study	Prep timetable	TODs	1. Indiscipline and time-wasting during prep go unchallenged 2. TOD not physically present in the prep area for the full duration of prep time 3. Learners using electronic devices for entertainment rather than study 4. TOD does not log attendance for prep time; absenteeism goes unrecorded	1. TOD to be physically present in the prep area throughout the full prep session; no desk-only supervision 2. Apply progressive discipline for indiscipline during prep; log all incidents in the prep incident log 3. Collect all unauthorised devices before prep begins; return them after prep is formally closed 4. Take prep attendance at the start of every session; report absentees to the HOD Home immediately	Daily during prep hours
4	Health and sick bay management — access to nurse, isolation and medical care	Medical records	School Nurse / Boarding Master / Mistress / HOD Home	1. Health condition deteriorates due to delayed medical attention 2. Infectious illness spreads in the dormitory due to inadequate isolation 3. Medical information for a boarder is incomplete or not available to the nurse 4. Parent not informed promptly when a boarder requires medical attention	1. Any learner reporting illness to be assessed by the school nurse within 30 minutes 2. Implement isolation procedures immediately for any learner presenting with symptoms of a contagious illness 3. Collect complete medical records from all boarders at check-in; update records at the start of every term 4. Notify the parent of any boarder requiring medical attention within 2 hours of the initial assessment	As needed
5	Meals and dining —	Menu plan, Allergies	Catering Team /	1. Poor nutrition due to an unbalanced	1. Plan weekly menus that are nutritionally balanced; have them approved by the HOD	Daily — all meal

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	meal schedules, nutrition and dietary management	list	Boarding Staff / HOD Home	or repetitive menu 2. Food-related illness due to inadequate hygiene during food preparation or service 3. Learner with a food allergy or dietary restriction not catered for 4. Learners skipping meals without staff detection	Home before each week begins 2. Conduct daily hygiene inspections of the dining area and kitchen; log all findings 3. Maintain an up-to-date dietary and allergy register; ensure catering staff are briefed on it at the start of term 4. Take boarding attendance at every meal; report any learner who misses two consecutive meals to the HOD Home	times
6	Roll call and head count — morning, evening and after activities	Roll call register	TODs / Dorm Prefects	1. Missing boarder not detected promptly due to infrequent roll calls 2. Roll call conducted by prefects only, without staff oversight 3. Absence recorded but not reported to the HOD Home in a timely manner 4. Head count conducted superficially without confirming physical presence of each learner	1. Conduct a minimum of three roll calls daily: morning, evening and after evening activities 2. Prefects to assist with roll calls but a TOD must be present and countersign the register for every roll call 3. Any absence from roll call to be reported to the HOD Home within 15 minutes of the roll call closing 4. Physically confirm each learner's presence; do not accept a verbal count from prefects without verification	Daily at set times — morning and evening minimum
7	Discipline management — enforcing school rules and managing misconduct	Code of Conduct, Incident report forms	Boarding Staff / HOD Home / Disciplinary Committee	1. Bullying occurring in the dormitory environment without staff detection 2. Inconsistent application of rules across different dorms and different members of boarding staff 3. Incident reports not completed for minor disciplinary issues; patterns go undetected 4. Disciplinary action taken without informing or involving parents	1. Conduct regular welfare checks specifically designed to detect bullying; brief prefects on how to report it 2. Hold a boarding staff briefing at the start of each term to align on rules and disciplinary responses 3. Complete an incident report for every discipline issue, regardless of severity; log in the central register 4. Parents to be informed of any disciplinary action within 24 hours; HOD Home to make or authorise the call	Ongoing
8	Visitors' management — authorised visitors only with proper identity checks	Visitor register	Security / Boarding Staff / HOD Home	1. Unauthorised persons gaining access to the boarding area 2. Visitor access not recorded; no audit trail if an incident occurs 3. Parent collecting a boarder early does not follow the sign-out procedure 4. Learner released to a visitor not on the authorised persons list	1. Strictly enforce the visitors-on-authorised-visiting-days-only policy; reject all unscheduled visitor requests 2. Record every visitor in the visitor register: name, ID number, purpose, time in and time out 3. Require HOD Home approval for any early or unscheduled collection; boarding staff cannot release independently 4. Verify every collecting adult against the authorised persons list before releasing any boarder	Visiting days and times only
9	Laundry services — supervision of collection, washing and return	Laundry logbook	Matron / Housekeeper	1. Learner clothes mixed up or lost during the laundry process 2. Laundry not completed within the scheduled cycle, leaving learners without clean uniform 3. Wet or damp clothes not dried properly, creating a hygiene risk 4. Laundry service provided without a logbook, making disputes impossible to resolve	1. Ensure all clothing is clearly labelled with the learner's name and admission number before the first wash 2. Complete the full laundry cycle within the scheduled timeframe; report any delay to the HOD Home 3. Confirm all laundry is fully dry before returning it to learners; do not return damp items 4. Log all items collected and returned in the laundry logbook; learner to sign on return of clothes	Weekly or as scheduled
10	Weekend and leisure activities — structured	Activity schedule, Permission forms	Boarding Staff / HOD Home /	1. Learners bored and disengaged due to unstructured weekend time 2. Learners moving around the school grounds unsupervised during free time	1. Publish a structured weekend activity programme at the start of each term; share with parents 2. Define permitted zones for boarders during	Weekends and as scheduled

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	recreation and supervision		TODs	3. Activities not inclusive of all boarders; some learners left out 4. Weekend activity permission not collected from parents for off-site activities	free time; TOD to conduct regular patrols of all areas 3. Design activities that are accessible and inclusive for all year groups and abilities 4. Collect written parental permission for any off-site weekend activity at least one week in advance	
11	Fire and emergency drills — evacuation procedures and safety training	Fire drill log, Emergency procedures	Boarding Staff / Security Team	1. Learner's panic or are injured during a real emergency due to lack of drill practice 2. Evacuation routes not clearly marked or known to all boarding staff 3. Drill not conducted every term; learners and staff lose familiarity with procedures 4. Drill outcomes not reviewed; same weaknesses recur without correction	1. Conduct at least one fire and emergency drill per term; ensure all boarders and boarding staff participate 2. Display evacuation routes in every dormitory and common area; brief all new boarding staff on routes before the drill 3. Schedule drills at varied times (day and night) to test readiness in different scenarios 4. Review drill performance immediately after each drill; log findings and implement improvements before the next drill	At least once per term
12	Lights out and quiet time — enforcement for adequate rest	Lights-out policy	TODs / Dorm Prefects	1. Fatigue and poor academic performance due to inadequate sleep 2. Lights-out not enforced consistently; some dorms stay up later than others 3. Learners using phones or other devices after lights-out 4. TOD does not conduct a post-lights-out check to confirm compliance	1. Enforce lights-out at the same time every night throughout the term; no exceptions without HOD Home approval 2. Apply lights-out consistently across all dorms simultaneously; HOD Home to spot-check compliance 3. Collect all phones and electronic devices before lights-out; store them securely until the following morning 4. TOD to conduct a post-lights-out walk-through of all dorms within 30 minutes to confirm compliance	Daily at the set time
13	Exit and return procedures — mid-term, exeat and end of term	Exit clearance form	Boarding Staff / HOD Home	1. Learner departs without completing the exit clearance procedure 2. Learner collected by an unauthorised adult without verification 3. Return of boarder not recorded; missing boarder not detected after the holiday 4. Learner leaves with school property that has not been accounted for	1. All boarders to complete the exit clearance form before leaving the boarding facility on any occasion 2. Verify every adult collecting a boarder against the authorised persons list; request ID if uncertain 3. Confirm the return of every boarder after an exeat or holiday; report any overdue return to HOD Home within 2 hours 4. Check that no school property has been taken during the exit clearance process; note any items on the clearance form	Mid-term, exeat and end of term

APPROVAL

Approved by: _____ Date: _____
Head of Centre (HOC) Signature

Approved by: _____ Date: _____
Administrator Signature

SOP 17: Flexi Boarding

Purpose: To provide a consistent, safe and well-documented process for admitting, supervising and exiting learners under the Flexi Boarding arrangement, ensuring their welfare and accountability throughout their stay.
Scope: Applies to HOD Home, Boarding Staff, Boarding Master/Mistress, TODs, Nurse, and Administrator. Covers all Flexi Boarding activities from registration through to exit clearance.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Registration for Flexi Boarding	Flexi Boarding Application Form	HOD Home, Boarding Staff	1. Incomplete or incorrect learner details submitted 2. Learner admitted without a fully processed application 3. Medical or dietary information omitted from the form 4. Registration accepted without parental authorisation	1. Ensure forms are thoroughly checked before acceptance 2. Confirm all mandatory fields are completed before admission 3. Cross-check medical/dietary details with the school nurse 4. Verify parental signature and authorisation on the form	At least 1 week before intended start date
2	Orientation for Flexi Boarders	Orientation Schedule	HOD Home	1. Learners feeling lost or overwhelmed on arrival 2. Key boarding rules not communicated clearly 3. Learner unaware of emergency and dormitory procedures 4. Orientation skipped due to late arrival	1. Hold a mandatory orientation session for every new boarder 2. Provide a clear, structured briefing on house rules 3. Walk the learner through emergency and dormitory procedures 4. Reschedule orientation promptly for any late arrival	On first day of boarding
3	Allocation of dormitory space	Dormitory Allocation List	Boarding Master/ Mistress / HOD Home	1. Inappropriate allocation by age or gender 2. Dormitory congestion beyond capacity 3. Allocation not matched to the learner's specific needs 4. Allocation list not updated after changes	1. Use pre-planned allocations based on age and gender 2. Monitor and enforce dormitory capacity limits 3. Consider medical or welfare needs during allocation 4. Keep the allocation list updated in real time	Before learner reports
4	Daily attendance record keeping	Daily Attendance Register	Boarding Staff / TODs	1. Unaccounted absences going unnoticed 2. Register not completed for every roll call 3. Discrepancies between register and physical headcount 4. Delayed reporting of an absent learner	1. Conduct a strict roll call every morning and evening 2. Ensure the register is signed off at each roll call 3. Reconcile register entries against physical headcounts 4. Report any absence to HOD Home immediately	Daily
5	Meals and dining supervision	Meal Timetable, Attendance List	Boarding Staff, Catering Staff	1. Missed meals for a boarder 2. Food quality complaints unresolved 3. Dietary/allergy requirements not observed 4. Supervision absent during a meal sitting	1. Supervise all meal sittings without exception 2. Maintain a feedback mechanism for meal quality 3. Flag dietary/allergy requirements to the kitchen in advance 4. Cross-check attendance against the meal timetable	Daily, as per meal times
6	Health monitoring	Health Records	Boarding Staff, Nurse / TODs	1. Undetected illness among boarders 2. Delayed reporting of symptoms to the nurse 3. Health records not updated consistently 4. Chronic conditions not flagged to boarding staff	1. Conduct daily health checks for all boarders 2. Ensure prompt reporting of any symptoms to the nurse 3. Keep health records current and accessible to boarding staff 4. Flag known chronic conditions in the boarding handover	Daily

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
7	Supervised study time	Study Timetable, Attendance	TODs	1. Learners missing scheduled study time 2. Disruption during the study period 3. Study attendance not recorded 4. Unsupervised study areas	1. Conduct regular roll calls during study time 2. Carry out spot checks throughout the session 3. Record study attendance against the timetable 4. Ensure a TOD is present in every study area	As per timetable (usually evenings)
8	Weekend check-in and check-out for Flexi Boarders	Check-In/Out Register, Consent Forms	Boarding Staff, Parents	1. Unauthorised exit from the boarding facility 2. Delayed return beyond the agreed time 3. Learner released to an unverified collector 4. Check-in/out register not properly completed	1. Require written parental consent for every exit 2. Verify the transport and collector before release 3. Match the collector's identity against the consent form 4. Ensure the register is completed for every check-in/out	Every weekend or as agreed
9	Emergency handling (illness)	Emergency Contacts List, First Aid Kit	Boarding Staff, Nurse, HOD Home	1. Delayed response to a medical emergency 2. Emergency contacts unreachable or outdated 3. Staff untrained in first aid response 4. First aid kit not adequately stocked	1. Display emergency contacts clearly in every dormitory 2. Ensure boarding staff are trained in basic first aid 3. Verify and update emergency contacts each term 4. Check and restock the first aid kit regularly	Immediate when incident occurs
10	Communication with parents	Contact Database, Communication Log	Boarding Staff, Admin Office Staff	1. Miscommunication with parents about a boarder's status 2. Delayed information reaching the parent 3. Contact database containing outdated details 4. Communication not logged for accountability	1. Send regular updates via SMS, email, or WhatsApp 2. Update the contact database at the start of each term 3. Log all parent communication in the communication log 4. Escalate any urgent update to HOD Home immediately	Weekly and as needed
11	End of Flexi Boarding period/exit process	Exit Form, Clearance Checklist	Boarding Staff, Administrator	1. Incomplete clearance at exit 2. Lost or unreturned items 3. Dormitory inspection skipped before departure 4. Exit form not signed off by all relevant parties	1. Use the exit clearance form and dormitory inspection checklist 2. Verify all issued items are returned or accounted for 3. Conduct the dormitory inspection before final sign-off 4. Ensure all relevant signatures are obtained before exit	Upon exit

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SOP 18: Boarders Checking in and Out

Purpose: To ensure a consistent, documented and accountable process for checking boarding learners in and out of MSIS at the start and end of each term, including fee clearance and belongings verification.
Scope: Applies to Receptionist/Staff, Accountant, Boarding Masters, Dorm Mothers, Parents/Guardians and Learners. Covers the full process from arrival and fee clearance at check-in through to retention of records at check-out.

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	(Check-in) Parent reports to the front office/designated reporting area	Clearance Register for Learners with Fee Arrears	Receptionist /Staff	1. Congestion or delays at reporting 2. No separate area for fee-arrears cases 3. Reporting parents not directed correctly 4. Reporting log not maintained	1. Set up a separate, designated reporting area for fee clearance cases 2. Direct parents clearly on arrival to the correct point 3. Maintain a reporting log for accountability 4. Deploy extra staff during peak reporting hours	Reporting day
2	(Check-in) Parent/Guardian with fee issues proceeds to accounts office	Fee Records	Accountant	1. Fee disputes over billing 2. Incorrect billing information 3. Delays in resolving fee queries 4. Parents arriving without prior notice of the balance	1. Provide prior communication on fees two days before school opens 2. Verify fee records before the parent arrives at the counter 3. Resolve disputes promptly and document the resolution 4. Confirm balances immediately upon arrival	During opening days / Immediately upon arrival
3	(Check-in) Clearance issued by accountant	Clearance Sheet	Accountant	1. Unauthorized admission without payment 2. Learners with fee balances accessing dorms 3. Clearance issued without verifying payment 4. Clearance sheet not properly filed	1. Require no check-in without clearance 2. Ensure no learner is allowed into the dorm without clearance 3. Verify payment before issuing the clearance sheet 4. File clearance sheets systematically for reference	Opening day/reporting day
4	(Check-in) Movement to the dorms after clearance by accounts	Clearance Sheet	Dorm Mothers and Boarding Masters	1. Learners with fee arrears accessing dorms 2. Clearance proof not checked at dorm entry 3. Staff not stationed at entry points 4. Learners bypassing the clearance check	1. Station staff at dorm entry points 2. Verify clearance proof before allowing entry 3. Cross-check names against the cleared list 4. Report any bypass attempt to the Boarding Master immediately	Opening day/reporting day
5	(Check-in) Inspection of student items against boarding lists	Boarders Checking-In Lists	Boarding Master, Parent, Learner	1. Assumption by staff without physically checking items one by one 2. Items missed during inspection 3. Boarding list not updated with actual items 4. Inspection rushed due to time pressure	1. Enforce mandatory physical verification of each item against the list 2. Allow adequate time for a full item-by-item check 3. Update the boarding list to reflect actual items brought 4. Involve both parent and learner in the verification	During check-in on the opening day
6	(Check-in) Sign-off of verification (boarding list confirmation) and filing	Signed Boarding List, Files	Boarding Masters, Parent/Guardian	1. Future disputes or claims for items not brought 2. Inaccurate or incomplete sign-off 3. Signed list not filed for future reference 4. Only one party signing the list	1. Require joint sign-off on the boarding list by Parent/Guardian and Boarding Master 2. Verify the list is complete before signing 3. File the signed list securely for the term 4. Retain a copy for both the school and the parent where practical	Reporting day
7	(Check-in) Learner proceeds to dorm with	Dorm Allocation List	Boarding Staff	1. Misallocation of dorm space 2. Learner unsettled or missing essentials	1. Use updated dorm lists for allocation 2. Verify bed and mattress assignment on arrival	After clearance

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	belongings; confirm dorm allocation			3. Bed and mattress assignment not verified 4. Allocation list not updated	3. Confirm the learner has all essential items settled 4. Update the allocation list immediately after placement	
8	(Check-in) Box/suitcase taken to the box room for storage	Box Room List	Dorm Mothers and Boarding Masters, Learners	1. Loss, mix-up, or unauthorized access to learners' belongings 2. Boxes not labelled clearly 3. Box room list not maintained 4. Access to the box room uncontrolled	1. Label each box/suitcase clearly with the student's name 2. Maintain an accurate box room list 3. Restrict access to the box room to authorised staff 4. Verify boxes against the list when storing	Reporting day
9	(Check-out) pre-check of items before closing day	Boarding List	Boarding Master, Learners	1. Last-minute rush before closing day 2. Pre-check skipped due to time pressure 3. Items not verified in good time 4. Discrepancies discovered too late	1. Start the pre-check one day earlier 2. Allocate adequate time for a thorough pre-check 3. Verify all items ahead of the closing day 4. Flag any discrepancy early for resolution	One day before closing
10	(Check-out) Verify items against TERM 'IN' recording them under TERM 'OUT'	Boarding List	Boarding Master, Learners	1. Lost or damaged items not identified 2. Verification not matched against the original TERM 'IN' record 3. Learner not present during verification 4. Records not updated consistently	1. Record discrepancies during weekly meetings with learners declaring any issues 2. Match TERM 'OUT' verification directly against TERM 'IN' records 3. Ensure the learner is present during the check 4. Update records consistently for every item	During inspection
11	(Check-out) Note missing/damaged items	Boarder's Weekly Report Form for Missing Items (lost or damaged)	Boarding Master, Learners	1. Disputes with parents over missing or damaged items 2. Items not documented at the time of discovery 3. Report form not completed consistently 4. Evidence not retained	1. Use clear documentation for every missing or damaged item 2. Complete the report form at the time of discovery 3. Retain evidence to support the report 4. Communicate findings to the Boarding Master promptly	Immediately
12	(Check-out) Parent informed of discrepancies (if any)	Report	Boarding Master	1. Conflict arising from the discrepancy report 2. Parent not informed before departure 3. Report lacking written evidence 4. Verbal-only communication causing disputes	1. Provide signed evidence or written communication on reported discrepancies 2. Inform the parent before departure wherever possible 3. Retain a copy of the communication sent 4. Offer the parent an opportunity to respond	Before departure
13	(Check-out) Retain form for next term use	Files, Boarding Lists	Boarding Masters	1. Loss of continuity between terms 2. Form not retained or misplaced 3. Different forms used each term 4. Records not accessible when needed	1. Keep the same form for the full academic year 2. Store forms securely for continuity 3. Standardise the form used across all terms 4. Ensure forms are accessible to relevant staff when needed	Every end of term

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SOP 19: Dormitory Cleaning and Housekeeping

Purpose: To ensure that all MSIS dormitories are maintained to a consistently high standard of cleanliness, hygiene and order, providing a healthy, safe and comfortable living environment for all boarding learners.
Scope: Applies to Housekeepers, the Matron, Dorm Captains and the entire cleaning team. Covers all dormitory cleaning activities from daily morning routines through to end-of-term deep cleaning.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Sweep and mop all dormitory floors every morning	Brooms, Mops, Disinfectant	Housekeepers	1. Slippery floors cause learner falls and injury immediately after mopping 2. Mop water not changed regularly, spreading dirt across floors 3. Disinfectant not diluted correctly, damaging floor surfaces or posing health risks 4. Floor cleaning missed in some areas of the dormitory due to incomplete task assignment	1. Place wet floor signs in every area being mopped; remove only when the floor is completely dry 2. Change mop water every 30 minutes; use clean water in every room to prevent cross-contamination 3. Follow the manufacturer's dilution instructions for all disinfectants; post instructions in the cleaning store 4. Assign specific dormitory zones to named housekeepers; supervisor to inspect every zone on completion	Daily — every morning
2	Dust all beds, windows, shelves and lockers	Dusting cloths, Step stool	Housekeepers	1. Dust accumulation triggers allergic reactions in learners 2. High surfaces (top bunks, window ledges) missed during routine dusting 3. Dusting carried out without PPE, causing housekeeper to inhale dust 4. Lockers dusted on the outside only; interiors accumulate dust and debris	1. Dust all surfaces systematically from top to bottom; wear a dust mask at all times during dusting 2. Include the top of every bunk, window ledge and shelf in the dusting checklist 3. Provide all housekeepers with masks and gloves for use during dusting; check compliance daily 4. Include locker interiors in the bi-weekly dusting schedule; open and dust inside every locker	Twice per week
3	Check and clean under all beds and behind lockers	Mops, Brooms	Housekeepers	1. Pest presence (rats, cockroaches) not detected due to infrequent under-bed inspection 2. Lost clothing or food items under beds create hygiene and pest risks 3. Heavy lockers not moved during cleaning; dust and debris accumulate permanently behind them 4. Pest activity discovered but not reported to management promptly	1. Conduct a full under-bed inspection as part of the weekly clean; look specifically for food, clothing and pest activity 2. Remove all items from under beds before cleaning; return only clearly identifiable belongings 3. Move lockers at least once per term for a full behind-locker clean; log in the deep-cleaning checklist 4. Report any sign of pest activity to the Facilities Manager on the same day it is discovered	Weekly
4	Remove all cobwebs from ceilings, corners and light fittings	Long-handled broom, Step ladder	Housekeepers	1. Housekeeper falls from an unstable step ladder while reaching for high cobwebs 2. Cobwebs around electrical fittings not removed, creating a fire or safety risk 3. Knocked cobwebs fall onto beds or learner belongings 4. High corners not reached due to insufficient equipment	1. Use only stable, non-slip step ladders; always have a second person present when working at height 2. Exercise particular care around all electrical fittings; use a dry, non-conductive tool for cobweb removal 3. Move all bedding and personal items away from the area before removing cobwebs from above 4. Provide long-handled cobweb brushes to reach high corners without requiring ladder access where possible	Weekly
5	Clean and disinfect all shared areas — study rooms and	Disinfectant, Mop, Gloves	Housekeepers	1. Spread of germs and infection in high-traffic shared spaces 2. Shared area cleaning skipped because it is not assigned to a specific housekeeper	1. Clean and disinfect all shared spaces at the scheduled times; include them in the daily cleaning roster 2. Assign named housekeepers to each shared area; include in the zone assignment schedule	Weekly for routine cleaning; deep

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	lounges			3. Disinfection carried out with incorrect product concentration 4. Shared areas not deep-cleaned during school breaks when they are most accessible	3. Post a dilution guide for all cleaning products in the cleaning store; supervisor to spot-check compliance 4. Conduct a full deep clean of all shared areas during every school holiday period	clean every term
6	Empty and clean all dustbins — waste disposal management	Waste bags, Dustbins	Housekeepers	1. Waste contamination due to overflowing bins not being emptied daily 2. Housekeeper handling waste without gloves; health and hygiene risk 3. Waste not disposed of in the correct waste stream; environmental compliance risk 4. Dustbins not cleaned after emptying; residue and odour accumulate	1. Empty all dustbins every morning without exception; check and empty again in the evening if needed 2. Provide all housekeepers with gloves and sealed waste bags for all waste handling; enforce compliance 3. Post waste segregation instructions near all bins; brief all housekeepers on correct waste disposal 4. Wash and disinfect all dustbins after emptying; line with a fresh bag before replacing	Daily
7	Supervise learner laundry collection and distribution	Laundry logbook	Matron / Housekeeper	1. Learner clothing mixed up, lost or damaged during the laundry process 2. Clothing returned without being fully dry, creating a hygiene and mould risk 3. Laundry not completed within the scheduled cycle, leaving learners without clean clothes 4. Laundry logbook not maintained; disputes about missing items cannot be resolved	1. Ensure all clothing is clearly labelled with name and admission number before any item enters the laundry 2. Confirm all clothing is fully dry before returning it to learners; do not return damp items 3. Complete the laundry cycle within the scheduled timeframe; report any delay to the HOD Home immediately 4. Update the laundry logbook for every collection and return; learner to sign on receipt of their items	Weekly or as scheduled
8	Ventilate all dormitories daily — open windows and draw curtains	Open windows, Curtains, Fans	Housekeepers / Dorm Captains	1. Poor air circulation causes stuffiness, mould growth and respiratory discomfort 2. Windows left open unsupervised after learners return; security risk at night 3. Windows in poor repair cannot be opened; ventilation inadequate in some dorms 4. Ventilation not carried out consistently in all dorms; dependent on individual initiative	1. Open all windows and draw back curtains in every dormitory every morning as the first cleaning task 2. Ensure all windows are closed and secured before learners return in the evening; include in the evening checklist 3. Report any window that cannot be opened due to disrepair to the Facilities Manager on the same day 4. Include dormitory ventilation as a daily task on the housekeeping checklist; supervisor to sign off on completion	Daily — every morning
9	Conduct end-of-term deep cleaning of all dormitory areas	All cleaning supplies, Team schedule	Entire cleaning team	1. Missed areas during the deep clean due to absence of a structured checklist 2. Cleaning team not organised or briefed before the deep clean begins 3. Insufficient cleaning supplies available to complete the deep clean 4. Deep clean not completed before the start of the next term	1. Use a comprehensive room-by-room deep cleaning checklist; supervisor to inspect and sign off every area 2. Hold a team briefing before each end-of-term deep clean to assign areas, timelines and responsibilities 3. Conduct a supplies stock count at least one week before the end of term; order all required materials in advance 4. Schedule the deep clean to be completed at least 2 days before the start of the new term	End of every term

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SECTION C: GUIDANCE & COUNSELLING

SOP 20: Group Counselling Sessions – Guidance & Counselling

Purpose: To provide a consistent, well-planned process for identifying, delivering and evaluating group counselling sessions that respond to the developmental and wellbeing needs of MSIS learners.
Scope: Applies to HOD Guidance & Counselling, Counsellors, Admin, and Class Teachers. Covers group counselling activities from topic identification through to review of impact.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Identify theme/topic for group session	Needs Assessment Tools, Teacher Feedback, Student Requests	HOD, Counsellors	1. Irrelevant or outdated topics selected 2. Topic selection not grounded in actual student needs 3. Sensitive topics chosen without adequate preparation 4. Selection influenced by a single, narrow source of feedback	1. Use feedback and trending issues among students 2. Draw on multiple sources including teacher and peer leader input 3. Prepare age-appropriate framing for sensitive topics 4. Cross-check topic relevance with recent needs assessments	Start of each term
2	Develop session objectives and plan	Session Lesson Plans	HOD	1. Unclear goals which are not SMART 2. Session plan lacking structured activities 3. Objectives misaligned with the identified topic 4. Plan not reviewed before finalisation	1. Set SMART objectives for every session 2. Structure activities to support the stated objectives 3. Align objectives directly with the identified topic 4. Have the plan reviewed by the HOD before use	2 weeks before session
3	Select target student group	Class Lists, Behaviour/Performance Reports	HOD, Counsellor	1. Exclusion of deserving students 2. Selection based on incomplete information 3. Bias in choosing participants 4. Group size too large for effective facilitation	1. Use multiple sources and ensure inclusion 2. Cross-check class lists against behaviour and performance reports 3. Apply consistent, transparent selection criteria 4. Cap group size to a manageable, effective number	2 weeks before session
4	Design session materials and activities	Presentations, Videos, Handouts	Counsellor	1. Low engagement due to unsuitable materials 2. Materials not age-appropriate for the group 3. Content technically difficult to deliver on the day 4. Handouts not ready in time for the session	1. Use interactive and age-appropriate materials 2. Pilot-test materials with the counsellor before the session 3. Confirm technical requirements (e.g. projector) in advance 4. Prepare and print handouts at least a day before	1 week before session
5	Coordinate logistics (venue, time, resources)	Room, Equipment (e.g. PA)	HOD, Admin	1. Scheduling clash with another school activity 2. Venue unavailable or unsuitable on the day 3. Equipment not functioning during the session 4. Logistics confirmed too close to the session date	1. Pre-book the venue well in advance 2. Consult key term dates before scheduling 3. Test equipment ahead of the session 4. Confirm logistics with Admin at least a week prior	1 week before session
6	Send out invitations/notifications	Notice Board	HOD	1. Bad attitude or reluctance among invited students 2. Students attending without notebooks or materials 3. Noise or disruption during notification/preparation 4. Notification reaching students too late	1. Sensitise students on the need for such sessions 2. Class teachers to ensure students carry required materials 3. Post notifications with enough lead time 4. Class teachers to reinforce the notice in registration time	5–7 days before session

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
7	Conduct group counselling session	Attendance Register, Session Plan	HOD, Counsellor	1. Disruptive behaviour during the session 2. Disengagement from part of the group 3. Session running over or under allocated time 4. Confidentiality boundaries not respected	1. Establish ground rules at the start of the session 2. Use group management strategies to sustain engagement 3. Keep the session within its planned time frame 4. Reiterate confidentiality expectations to the group	Scheduled day
8	Collect feedback from participants	Feedback Forms, Anonymous Slips	HOD, Counsellor	1. Incomplete or dishonest feedback 2. Low response rate to feedback forms 3. Feedback not representative of the whole group 4. Sensitive feedback not handled discreetly	1. Use anonymous submissions and brief forms 2. Allow time within the session for feedback collection 3. Encourage all participants to respond 4. Handle sensitive feedback with appropriate discretion	Immediately after session
9	Document session outcomes	Session Report, Attendance, Photos (if appropriate)	HOD	1. Loss of session records 2. Inconsistent documentation across sessions 3. Outcomes not clearly captured for follow-up 4. Sensitive information stored insecurely	1. Store records in the department folder and digital backup 2. Use a standard reporting template for every session 3. Record clear, actionable outcomes for follow-up 4. Restrict access to sensitive session records	1–2 days after session
10	Review and evaluate impact	Feedback Summary, Observation Notes	HOD	1. No follow-up action taken on findings 2. Recurring issues not identified across terms 3. Evaluation not linked back to original objectives 4. Improvements not communicated to relevant staff	1. Discuss findings in the departmental meeting 2. Track recurring themes across terms for trend analysis 3. Assess outcomes against the original session objectives 4. Share planned improvements with relevant staff	End of term

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SOP 21: Parenting Sessions – Guidance & Counselling

Purpose: To ensure termly parenting sessions are well planned, professionally facilitated, and consistently reviewed to strengthen parent engagement and support for learners.
Scope: Applies to HOD Guidance and Counselling, Admin Office, Accountant, IT Team, External Facilitators, and Counselling Staff. Covers the process from session planning through to SOP review.

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Plan and schedule termly parenting session	G&C Program, Newsletter, Key Term Dates	HOD Guidance and Counselling	1. Sessions not included in the newsletter 2. Session date clashing with another school event 3. Planning not aligned with key term dates 4. Session objectives not defined in advance	1. Include the session in the newsletter dispatched by HOC 2. Cross-check the date against the school calendar 3. Align scheduling with key term dates 4. Define clear objectives before scheduling	Week 1–2 of term
2	Identify and contract external facilitator	Facilitator Profile, Payment Agreement, Requisition Sheet	HOD, Accountant, Admin	1. Unqualified or unavailable facilitator engaged 2. Costly facilitators straining the budget 3. Contract terms not agreed in writing 4. Facilitator confirmed too close to the session date	1. Vet facilitators and confirm early 2. Bargain with the facilitator on cost where possible 3. Formalise terms through a signed payment agreement 4. Set a deadline for facilitator confirmation	Week 2–3 of term
3	Announce session to parents (date, venue/online platform)	Newsletter, Poster, WhatsApp Platforms	Admin Office, HOD	1. Low parent attendance at the session 2. Facilitator arriving late for the session 3. Announcement not reaching all parents 4. Venue/platform details unclear in the announcement	1. Communicate clearly and early via multiple platforms 2. Confirm facilitator's arrival time in advance 3. Send reminders closer to the session date 4. State venue/platform details explicitly in the announcement	Week 4 of term
4	Prepare venue/online logistics	Zoom or Google Link/Meeting Hall Preparation	IT Team (Online), Admin Staff (Face to Face)	1. Technical issues on the online platform 2. Physical space inadequate for expected attendance 3. Logistics not tested before the session 4. Backup plan unavailable in case of failure	1. Conduct a test run for online sessions 2. Prepare the room early for physical sessions 3. Test all equipment the day before 4. Have a backup platform or venue on standby	1 week before session
5	Conduct parenting session	Presentation Materials, Attendance Register	External Facilitator, HOD Oversight	1. Poor engagement or irrelevant content delivered 2. Parents arriving late to the session 3. Session running significantly over time 4. Facilitator deviating from the agreed agenda	1. Pre-discuss the agenda with the facilitator 2. Collect parent expectations ahead of the session 3. Manage time actively during the session 4. Have the HOD oversee delivery against the agenda	As scheduled
6	Monitor attendance and participation	Attendance Register, Feedback Form	HOD, Counselling Staff	1. Low engagement or lack of follow-up 2. Attendance register not fully completed 3. Participation not observed or recorded 4. Disengaged parents not identified for follow-up	1. Use interactive elements to boost engagement 2. Collect feedback during the session 3. Ensure the attendance register is completed fully 4. Flag disengaged parents for individual follow-up	During session
7	Collect parent feedback	Feedback Forms (Google or Paper)	HOD, Counselling Team	1. Lack of improvement over time due to unused feedback 2. Some parents not responding to the feedback form	1. Make feedback anonymous and actionable 2. Encourage parents to respond before leaving the session	Immediately after session

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
				3. Feedback not analysed after collection 4. Sensitive feedback not handled appropriately	3. Analyse feedback promptly after each session 4. Handle sensitive feedback with discretion	
8	Review session outcomes and compile report	Session Report Template	HOD, Secretary	1. No record kept for improvement or reporting 2. Report not compiled within a reasonable timeframe 3. Outcomes not linked to future planning 4. Report not submitted to the Head of Centre	1. Submit a standardised report format to the Head of Centre 2. Compile the report within one week of the session 3. Link outcomes directly to future session planning 4. Track submission to ensure timely delivery	1 week after session
9	Process facilitator payment	Requisition	Accountant, Admin	1. Delayed payment to the facilitator 2. Invoice details incomplete or incorrect 3. Payment processed without required documentation 4. Facilitator relationship strained by payment delays	1. Confirm documents in advance and follow up promptly 2. Verify invoice details before processing 3. Ensure all required documentation accompanies the payment 4. Process payment within the agreed timeframe	Within a day post-session
10	Review and update parenting session SOP	This SOP Document	HOD	1. SOP becomes outdated over time 2. Review skipped for a term 3. Updates not communicated to relevant staff 4. Feedback from sessions not incorporated into the SOP	1. Review the SOP after each term's session based on feedback 2. Schedule the review as a standing termly task 3. Communicate updates to all relevant staff 4. Incorporate session feedback into SOP revisions	End of each term

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SOP 22: Peer Mentorship – Counselling

Purpose: To establish and sustain a structured peer mentorship programme that supports learner wellbeing and development through trained peer leaders and consistent supervision.
Scope: Applies to HOD Guidance & Counselling, Counsellors, Class Teachers, G&C Members, and External Trainers. Covers the process from needs identification through to programme revision.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Identify need for peer mentorship program	Needs Assessment Reports, Student Behaviour/Performance Data	HOD, Teacher Counsellors	1. Lack of clarity or justification for the program 2. Needs assessment based on limited data 3. Program initiated without leadership buy-in 4. Objectives not linked to school improvement goals	1. Base the program on data and school improvement goals 2. Draw on multiple sources of student data 3. Secure leadership buy-in before proceeding 4. Align objectives clearly with school improvement priorities	Start of academic year
2	Develop peer mentorship framework and objectives	Program Guide, Objectives, Role Descriptions	HOD, Counsellors	1. Vague roles or poor structure in the framework 2. Objectives not measurable 3. Framework not reviewed before rollout 4. Role descriptions unclear to participants	1. Define clear goals, roles, and structure 2. Set measurable objectives for the program 3. Have the framework reviewed before rollout 4. Communicate role descriptions clearly to all participants	2 weeks after needs assessment
3	Select peer leaders (students)	Application Forms, Teacher Recommendations, Interview Rubrics	HOD, Class Teachers, G&C Members	1. Favouritism or bias in selection 2. Selection criteria applied inconsistently 3. Unsuitable candidates selected as peer leaders 4. Selection process not transparent to applicants	1. Use transparent selection with set criteria 2. Apply the interview rubric consistently for all applicants 3. Involve multiple staff in the selection panel 4. Communicate selection outcomes transparently	Beginning of academic year
4	Train selected peer leaders	Training Manual, G&C Program, Attendance List	HOD, Counsellors, External Trainers	1. Unprepared mentors entering the program 2. Training content not covering realistic scenarios 3. Low attendance at training sessions 4. Training not assessed for effectiveness	1. Provide practical training and mentorship scenarios 2. Ensure training covers common mentoring situations 3. Track attendance and follow up on absentees 4. Assess mentor readiness before deployment	Start of each term
5	Assign mentees to peer mentors	Mentor-Mentee List, Consent Forms	HOD	1. Mismatch of personalities or needs 2. Assignment made without mentee consent 3. Mentor overloaded with too many mentees 4. Assignment list not communicated to relevant staff	1. Consider interests, background, and year group 2. Obtain consent forms before finalising assignments 3. Cap the number of mentees per mentor 4. Share the assignment list with class teachers	Week after training
6	Facilitate regular peer leaders' sessions	Logbooks, Supervision Sheets	HOD	1. Inconsistency or drop-off in engagement 2. Sessions not adequately supervised 3. Logbooks not maintained consistently 4. Peer leaders losing motivation over time	1. Schedule regular check-ins and supervised meetings 2. Maintain consistent logbook entries per session 3. Recognise and encourage active peer leaders 4. Address disengagement early through direct conversation	Weekly or biweekly
7	Monitor mentor-mentee relationships	Observation Notes, Feedback Forms	HOD	1. Conflict or breakdown in relationships 2. Issues not identified until they escalate 3. Monitoring inconsistent across pairs 4. Feedback not collected regularly	1. Provide early mediation and flexible reassignments 2. Monitor all pairs on a consistent schedule	Monthly reviews

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
					3. Collect feedback regularly from both mentor and mentee 4. Escalate unresolved conflicts to the HOD promptly	
8	Provide ongoing support and supervision	Meeting Notes, Follow-up Checklists	HOD	1. Mentor burnout or poor guidance 2. Follow-up checklists not completed 3. Support not tailored to individual mentor needs 4. Supervision gaps during busy school periods	1. Offer continuous coaching and emotional support 2. Use follow-up checklists consistently 3. Tailor support to individual mentor challenges 4. Maintain supervision even during busy periods	Ongoing
9	Evaluate program outcomes	Survey Results, Mentor/Mentee Reports	HOD	1. Lack of measurable impact demonstrated 2. Evaluation relying on incomplete data 3. Outcomes not compared against original objectives 4. Evaluation findings not documented	1. Use qualitative and quantitative evaluation tools 2. Ensure survey participation from all pairs 3. Compare outcomes against original program objectives 4. Document evaluation findings for the record	End of each term
10	Revise and improve the program	Review Reports, Feedback Summaries	HOD, Counsellor	1. Repetition of past issues without correction 2. Revisions not informed by evaluation data 3. Changes not communicated to peer leaders 4. Revision process skipped for a term	1. Apply data-informed changes and termly reviews 2. Base revisions directly on evaluation findings 3. Communicate program changes to all peer leaders 4. Treat termly revision as a mandatory step	End of academic year

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SOP 23: Socio-Emotional Support – Guidance & Counselling

Purpose: To ensure learners experiencing socio-emotional difficulties are identified, assessed, supported and monitored through a structured, confidential and collaborative process.
Scope: Applies to Teachers, Counsellors, Counselling Team, HOD Guidance & Counselling, and Admin. Covers the process from identification of learners in need through to annual SOP review.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Identify learners in need of socio-emotional support	Referral Forms, Observation Reports	Teachers, Counsellors	1. Learners remain unnoticed and unsupported 2. Referral system underused by teachers 3. Observation reports inconsistent across classes 4. Early warning signs missed	1. Maintain ongoing teacher observation 2. Use a timely referral system for at-risk learners 3. Standardise observation reporting across classes 4. Train teachers to recognise early warning signs	Weekly monitoring
2	Initial assessment and counselling intake	Intake Form, Interview Notes	Counselling Team	1. Incomplete understanding of learner needs 2. Intake delayed beyond the target window 3. Confidentiality not maintained during intake 4. Intake notes inconsistent across counsellors	1. Use a structured intake process with confidentiality 2. Complete intake within the target timeframe 3. Restrict access to intake notes to authorised staff 4. Standardise the intake form for consistency	Within 1 week of referral
3	Develop individual support plan	Support Plan Template	Counsellor + HOD Approval	1. Unclear support goals or roles 2. Plan developed without HOD approval 3. Support plan not measurable 4. Plan not shared with relevant staff	1. Use collaborative goal setting with measurable outcomes 2. Require HOD approval before implementation 3. Define clear, trackable milestones in the plan 4. Share the plan with relevant staff on a need-to-know basis	Within a week post-assessment
4	Conduct one-on-one or group counselling sessions	Session Logs, Counselling Plan/Program	Counselling Staff	1. Irregular support and loss of trust 2. Sessions cancelled without rescheduling 3. Continuity broken by counsellor changes 4. Session logs not maintained consistently	1. Schedule sessions with continuity from the assigned counsellor 2. Reschedule promptly for any cancelled session 3. Minimise changes to the assigned counsellor 4. Maintain session logs after every meeting	Weekly or as needed
5	Monitor learner progress and update support plan	Progress Monitoring Forms	Counsellor + Teachers	1. No adaptation to changing needs 2. Progress not reviewed on schedule 3. Teacher input not incorporated into updates 4. Monitoring forms incomplete	1. Review plans monthly and adjust as needed 2. Keep monitoring reviews on a fixed schedule 3. Incorporate teacher observations into updates 4. Ensure monitoring forms are completed fully	Monthly
6	Engage parents/guardians for support at home	Meeting Notes, Parent Communication Logs, Phone	Counsellor + HOD	1. Lack of home reinforcement of support strategies 2. Parents unresponsive to engagement attempts 3. Sensitive information shared inappropriately 4. Engagement inconsistent across terms	1. Maintain regular, respectful engagement and follow-up 2. Escalate persistent non-response to the HOD 3. Share only necessary information with parents 4. Schedule termly parent engagement as standard practice	Termly or as required
7	Coordinate with teachers for classroom strategies	Strategy Checklist, Teacher Briefs	Counselling Team + Class Teachers	1. Disconnection between support and academics 2. Strategies not implemented	1. Use joint planning and regular communication 2. Brief teachers on strategies via the	Ongoing

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
				consistently in class 3. Teachers unaware of updated support plans 4. Coordination limited to a single meeting	strategy checklist 3. Update teachers whenever a support plan changes 4. Maintain ongoing, not one-off, coordination	
8	Emergency intervention for crises (e.g. grief, trauma)	Crisis Intervention Protocol	Counselling Team + Admin	1. Delayed or poor handling of critical cases 2. Crisis protocol not followed correctly 3. Learner not referred for external help when needed 4. Staff untrained in crisis response	1. Provide immediate response guided by the crisis plan 2. Follow the crisis intervention protocol strictly 3. Refer to external professionals where warranted 4. Train relevant staff in crisis response procedures	As needed (within 24 hrs)
9	Evaluate program effectiveness and learner feedback	Feedback Forms, Review Reports	HOD + Counselling Team	1. Ineffective strategies continuing unchanged 2. Evaluation lacking learner input 3. Review not conducted consistently each term 4. Findings not acted upon	1. Use data-driven review with input from learners and staff 2. Ensure learner feedback is actively sought 3. Conduct the review as a standing termly task 4. Act on review findings before the next term	End of each term
10	Review and update SOP	This SOP Document	HOD	1. Outdated practices persisting in the SOP 2. Review skipped for an extended period 3. Updates not communicated to counselling staff 4. Feedback from incidents not incorporated	1. Conduct an annual review or review after critical incidents 2. Treat the annual review as a mandatory task 3. Communicate SOP updates to all counselling staff 4. Incorporate lessons from incidents into revisions	Annually or post-incident

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SOP 24: Training – Guidance & Counselling

Purpose: To ensure staff and student peer leader training delivered by the Guidance & Counselling department is well planned, evidence-based, and consistently evaluated for effectiveness.
Scope: Applies to HOD Guidance & Counselling, Counsellors, and External Facilitators. Covers the process from identifying training needs through to maintaining training records.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Identify training needs	Needs Assessment Tools, Feedback Forms	HOD, Counsellor	1. Misalignment with actual training needs 2. Needs assessment relying on a single source 3. Emerging needs not captured in time 4. Assessment findings not documented	1. Use multiple feedback sources 2. Draw on staff, student, and observation data 3. Conduct needs assessment each term 4. Document findings for reference in planning	Start of term / as needed
2	Develop annual training plan	Training Calendar, Budget Proposal	HOD	1. Incomplete or unfeasible training goals 2. Plan developed without stakeholder input 3. Budget proposal not aligned with the plan 4. Plan not aligned with school goals	1. Consult stakeholders and align with school goals 2. Verify feasibility of each planned training item 3. Ensure the budget proposal matches the training calendar 4. Review the plan against strategic priorities	Term 1
3	Design training content	Lesson Plans, Training Modules	Counsellor, HOD	1. Ineffective or irrelevant content 2. Content not contextualised to MSIS needs 3. Materials not reviewed before use 4. Content not updated from previous terms	1. Use evidence-based and contextual materials 2. Review and update content before every session 3. Contextualise materials to the target audience 4. Pilot content with the HOD before delivery	2–4 weeks before session
4	Organize staff training	Attendance Registers, Feedback Forms	HOD, External Facilitators	1. Low participation or poor engagement 2. Training scheduled at an inconvenient time 3. Facilitator not confirmed in advance 4. Attendance not tracked	1. Use participatory methods and convenient timing 2. Confirm facilitators well ahead of the session 3. Track attendance using the attendance register 4. Follow up with staff who miss the session	Once per term
5	Train student peer leaders	Peer Training Modules, Role Descriptions, Program	Counsellor, HOD	1. Peer misuse of their assigned role 2. Training content too advanced or unclear 3. Supervision of peer leaders inconsistent 4. Role expectations not clearly set	1. Provide clear guidelines, supervision, and mentorship 2. Set clear role expectations before deployment 3. Adjust training content to the peer leaders' level 4. Maintain ongoing supervision after training	Twice per term
6	In-house training for staff	Workshop Materials, Department Meeting Notes	HOD, Counsellor	1. Resistance or low uptake among staff 2. Sessions perceived as low value 3. Materials not tailored to department needs 4. Sessions not linked to practical application	1. Use collaborative reflection during sessions 2. Tailor content to specific department needs 3. Link training to practical classroom or work application 4. Gather feedback to improve future sessions	Termly
7	Evaluate training effectiveness	Pre/Post Tests, Evaluation Reports	HOD, Counsellor	1. Subjective or biased evaluations 2. Evaluation relying on a single measure	1. Use mixed methods and objective indicators 2. Link evaluation directly to training	After each session

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
				3. Evaluation not linked to training objectives 4. Results not documented	objectives 3. Combine pre/post tests with qualitative feedback 4. Document evaluation results for the record	
8	Report training outcomes	Training Report Template, Recommendations	HOD	1. Incomplete or delayed reports 2. Recommendations not acted upon 3. Report not shared with relevant stakeholders 4. Reporting deadlines missed	1. Use templates and calendar reminders 2. Track recommendations through to implementation 3. Share reports with relevant stakeholders promptly 4. Submit reports within the set deadline	End of each term
9	Maintain training records	Training Logbooks, HOD Reports	HOD, Counsellor	1. Lost or disorganized records 2. Records not backed up digitally 3. Access to records not controlled 4. Records incomplete for some sessions	1. Use digital backup systems 2. Maintain organised, up-to-date training logbooks 3. Restrict access to authorised staff 4. Ensure every session has a complete record	Continuous

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SOP 25: Transition Support – Guidance & Counselling

Purpose: To provide structured, timely support to learners undergoing transitions — including admission, section changes, and progression between school levels — ensuring a smooth adjustment.
Scope: Applies to Counselling Team, HOD Guidance & Counselling, Class Teachers, HOSs, Admissions Office, Admin and HOC. Covers all transition support activities from admission orientation through to annual SOP review.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Orientation for new learners upon admission	Orientation Checklist, Welcome Pack	Counselling Team, Class Teachers, HOSs	1. Anxiety, fear, or withdrawal in new learners 2. Orientation rushed or incomplete 3. Welcome pack not provided consistently 4. Peer buddy not assigned promptly	1. Provide a warm welcome and peer buddy system 2. Run structured orientation sessions for every new learner 3. Ensure the welcome pack is issued to all new admissions 4. Assign a peer buddy within the first week	First week after admission
2	Meet and greet with parents during admission	Admission Forms, Counselling Notes	HOD Guidance, Admissions Office	1. Poor communication of learner needs 2. Meeting rushed due to admission-day pressure 3. Key information not captured on the intake form 4. Follow-up on flagged needs not scheduled	1. Hold a detailed intake discussion and needs assessment 2. Allocate adequate time for the meet and greet 3. Capture all relevant details on the admission form 4. Schedule follow-up for any flagged learner needs	Day of admission
3	Transition support from Early Years to Junior School	Transition Checklist, Observation Notes	Class Teachers, Counselling Team, HOSs	1. Learners feel lost or confused by the new structure 2. Transition rushed without preparation 3. Classroom tours not conducted 4. New teachers not introduced in advance	1. Provide gradual introduction and classroom tours 2. Introduce new teachers ahead of the transition 3. Use the transition checklist to track readiness 4. Observe and support learners during the first weeks	Last term in Early Years and first term in Junior
4	Parent sensitization on transition changes	Parent Communication Letters, WhatsApp, Meeting Agenda	HOD Guidance, Admin, HOSs, HOC	1. Parental anxiety or resistance to the change 2. Sensitization held too close to the transition 3. Communication not reaching all affected parents 4. Concerns raised by parents not addressed	1. Hold pre-transition meetings and issue info packs 2. Schedule sensitization with adequate lead time 3. Use multiple channels to reach all parents 4. Address parent concerns during the meeting	End of previous term
5	Transition workshops for Junior to Senior School learners	Workshop Materials, Feedback Forms	Counselling Team, HOSs	1. Learners stressed about new expectations 2. Workshops not engaging or interactive 3. Testimonials from older students not included 4. Feedback not collected after the workshop	1. Use interactive sessions and testimonials from older students 2. Design workshops to be engaging and participatory 3. Collect feedback to improve future workshops 4. Address specific learner concerns raised during sessions	End of final term in Junior School
6	Individual counselling for learners facing challenges during transition	Counselling Logs, Referral Forms	Counsellors, HOD	1. Unaddressed emotional stress in affected learners 2. Referral not made promptly 3. Sessions not confidential 4. Follow-up check-ins not scheduled	1. Provide confidential sessions and regular check-ins 2. Ensure prompt referral for learners showing distress 3. Maintain confidentiality throughout counselling 4. Schedule regular follow-up check-ins	As needed, within first term
7	Teacher briefing on new learners	Learner Profiles, Confidential	HOD Guidance,	1. Teachers unaware of learner needs	1. Share confidential information during staff meetings appropriately	Beginning of new term

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	and their background needs	Notes	Class Teachers	2. Confidential information shared inappropriately 3. Briefing conducted too late in the term 4. Learner profiles incomplete	2. Restrict sensitive information to a need-to-know basis 3. Conduct the briefing at the start of the term 4. Ensure learner profiles are complete before briefing	
8	Peer mentor assignment for new learners	Mentor Log, Peer Support Policy	Counselling Team, Student Leaders	1. Isolation or lack of social integration 2. Mentors assigned without adequate training 3. Mismatch between mentor and mentee 4. Mentor log not maintained	1. Assign trained, responsible peer mentors 2. Match mentors and mentees thoughtfully 3. Maintain the mentor log for accountability 4. Monitor the mentor-mentee relationship in the first weeks	First 2 weeks of term
9	Review of transition outcomes and learner adjustment	Observation Forms, Progress Reports	HOD Guidance, Teachers	1. Poor adaptation overlooked by staff 2. Review not conducted mid-term 3. Progress reports incomplete 4. Follow-up meetings not scheduled	1. Conduct mid-term evaluations and follow-up meetings 2. Ensure progress reports are completed for all learners 3. Flag learners showing poor adaptation early 4. Schedule a formal review at both mid and end of term	Mid and end of term
10	Update and review of transition SOP	This SOP Document	HOD Guidance, Head of Centre	1. Outdated support strategies persisting 2. Review skipped for an academic year 3. Feedback from transitions not incorporated 4. Updates not communicated to relevant staff	1. Conduct an annual review based on feedback and outcomes 2. Treat the annual review as a mandatory task 3. Incorporate feedback from each transition phase 4. Communicate SOP updates to relevant staff	Annually or post major transition phase

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SECTION D: CUSTOMER SERVICE & COMMUNICATIONS

SOP 26: Communication to Customers

Purpose: To ensure all official communication to parents and other customers of MSIS is accurate, timely, consistent and properly approved before dispatch.
Scope: Applies to Staff, Class Teachers, Front Office, School Administration, and HOC. Covers all communication channels from drafting through to emergency communication.

No.	Activity/How	Documents/Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Draft official communication (letters, memos, SMS)	Communication Template, School Letterhead	Staff	1. Miscommunication or incorrect information 2. Draft not reviewed before dispatch 3. Inconsistent tone or format used 4. Letterhead or template not used	1. Have all drafts reviewed and approved by HOC before dispatch 2. Use the standard communication template 3. Proofread drafts for accuracy before submission 4. Use the official school letterhead for all formal communication	As needed
2	Share the approved communication to parents	Digital Platforms (email, WhatsApp)	Staff	1. Delay in reaching parents 2. Communication sent through only one channel 3. Some parents missing the communication 4. Distribution not tracked	1. Use multiple channels (hard copy & digital) 2. Send within the target timeframe after approval 3. Confirm distribution lists are up to date 4. Track delivery to identify any gaps	Within 24 hours of approval
3	Phone call follow-ups for urgent matters	Contact List, Call Log Sheet	Class Teachers, Front Office	1. Incomplete or missed communication 2. Contact list outdated 3. Call not logged 4. No confirmation of receipt obtained	1. Maintain an updated contact list 2. Confirm receipt of the message with the parent 3. Log every follow-up call made 4. Escalate unreachable contacts to Admin	Same day for urgent issues
4	Organize Parents' Meetings – for communication purposes	Meeting Reminder message & Agenda, Attendance Register	HOC, Staff	1. Low turnout at the meeting 2. Notice sent too close to the meeting date 3. Agenda not shared in advance 4. Attendance not recorded	1. Give early notice, reminders, and flexible timing 2. Share the agenda ahead of the meeting 3. Send reminders closer to the meeting date 4. Record attendance using the register	As need arises
5	Respond to parent inquiries	Inquiry Log Book, Email, Call Records	Front Office, Staff	1. Delayed or no response to an inquiry 2. Inquiry not logged 3. Response inconsistent across staff 4. Urgent inquiries not prioritised	1. Set a response timeframe (within 24 hours) 2. Log every inquiry in the inquiry log book 3. Use a consistent response approach across staff 4. Prioritise urgent inquiries for same-day response	Daily, as inquiries arise
6	Share term dates, events, and updates	Digital Platforms	HOC, Staff	1. Information gaps between term communications 2. Calendar not shared at the start of term 3. Reminders not sent before events 4. Updates inconsistent across platforms	1. Share the calendar at the start of term and send reminders before events 2. Use consistent information across all platforms 3. Update the calendar promptly when changes occur 4. Confirm receipt through a read/acknowledgement mechanism where possible	Start of term & ongoing
7	Communicate policy changes	Policy Documents, Meetings	HOC	1. Misunderstanding or resistance to the change 2. Policy change communicated too late 3. Written communication lacking clarity 4. Parents not given a chance to	1. Engage parents through meetings and clear written communication 2. Communicate changes with adequate lead time 3. Use plain, unambiguous language in written notices 4. Provide a channel for parents to raise	As needed

No.	Activity/How	Documents/Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
				ask questions	questions	
8	Feedback collection from parents	Digital Surveys	School Administration	1. Low participation in feedback collection 2. Feedback forms not accessible to all parents 3. Feedback not analysed after collection 4. No action taken on feedback received	1. Use both physical and digital survey formats 2. Promote participation through reminders 3. Analyse feedback promptly after each collection round 4. Share planned actions arising from feedback	Once per term or as needed
9	Emergency communication (e.g. closure, incidents)	Emergency Contact List	HOC, Staff	1. Delayed communication during emergencies 2. Emergency contact list outdated 3. Templates not ready when needed 4. System not tested for reliability	1. Use pre-approved emergency templates 2. Keep the emergency contact list updated 3. Conduct periodic system tests 4. Assign clear responsibility for emergency communication	Immediate, real-time

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SOP 27: Customer Communication Management

Purpose: To establish a consistent, professional and effective framework for managing all communication between MSIS and its customers — primarily parents and guardians — ensuring all messages are accurate, timely and appropriately approved before dispatch.
Scope: Applies to all MSIS staff who communicate with parents, including Class Teachers, Front Office, HOS and HOC. Covers all outbound and inbound communication channels including letters, email, SMS, WhatsApp, meetings and emergency notices.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Draft official communication — letters, memos, SMS	Communication Template, School Letterhead	Staff	1. Miscommunication or incorrect information dispatched to parents 2. Inconsistent tone or format across communications from different staff members 3. Communication dispatched without HOC approval 4. Sensitive information included in a mass communication meant for general updates	1. All communication drafts to be reviewed and approved by HOC or a designated communication lead before dispatch 2. Use standardised templates for all external communication; no free-form letters without template compliance 3. Establish and enforce a no-dispatch-without-approval policy; all staff briefed on this at the start of the year 4. Route all sensitive individual communications through HOS or HOC; do not include personal learner information in group messages	As needed
2	Share approved communication to parents	Printed copies, Digital Platforms (email, WhatsApp)	Staff	1. Delay in reaching parents due to reliance on a single communication channel 2. Digital communication not reaching parents with inactive email addresses or offline status 3. Printed copies not reaching parents because they are given to learners to take home 4. Parents in a different time zone or with limited connectivity not reached	1. Use at least two communication channels simultaneously for all important communications 2. Confirm email delivery where possible; follow up undelivered digital messages via SMS or phone 3. For critical communications, have learners sign a receipt slip and return it; retain copies at school 4. Maintain an updated communication preferences register; note preferred channels for each family	Within 24 hours of approval
3	Phone call follow-ups for urgent matters	Contact List, Call Log Sheet	Class Teachers / Front Office	1. Incomplete or missed communication because calls go unanswered 2. No record kept of calls made; disputes arise over what was communicated 3. Staff using personal phone numbers for school communication 4. Urgent message communicated but not followed up in writing	1. Make at least three call attempts at different times of day before escalating to a written notice 2. Log every call in the call log: date, time, purpose, outcome and name of person who made the call 3. All school communication calls to be made from the school's designated phone; no personal numbers 4. Follow up every urgent verbal communication with a written message within the same working day	Same day for urgent issues
4	Organise and facilitate parents' meetings	Meeting Notices, Agenda, Attendance Register	HOC / Staff	1. Low parent turnout reduces the effectiveness of the meeting 2. Meeting agenda not shared in advance; parents arrive unprepared 3. Meeting runs overtime or off-agenda, reducing efficiency 4. No record of who attended or what was decided	1. Issue meeting notice with full agenda at least 2 weeks in advance; send a reminder 3 days and 1 day before 2. Share the meeting agenda with parents at least 3 days before the meeting 3. Appoint a timekeeper and chair; keep discussions on agenda; table off-agenda items for a separate follow-up 4. Take formal minutes including attendance; share a summary with all parents within 3 days of the meeting	As needs arise
5	Respond to all parent inquiries within the agreed	Inquiry Log Book, Email, Call Records	Front Office / Staff	1. Delayed or no response erodes parent trust in the school's communication 2. Inquiry passed between staff	1. Acknowledge every inquiry within 4 hours and provide a full response within 24 hours 2. Assign every inquiry to a specific named staff member; front office to track resolution	Daily — within 24 hours

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	timeframe			without resolution; parent receives no definitive answer 3. No log of inquiries received; follow-up falls through the gap 4. Response given verbally without any written record	3. Log every inquiry in the inquiry log book immediately on receipt; record the outcome when resolved 4. All substantive responses to parent inquiries to be followed up in writing and retained on file	for all inquiries
6	Share term dates, events and school updates with parents	Digital Platforms, School calendar	HOC / Staff	1. Information gaps due to updates shared too close to the event or date 2. Calendar information sent at the start of term but not repeated as key dates approach 3. Some parents miss updates due to inactive or unsupported communication channels 4. Updates shared inconsistently across different sections and year groups	1. Share the full-term calendar with all parents on the first day of each term 2. Send reminders for key dates at least one week before the date; include a 3-day reminder for major events 3. Use multiple channels for calendar updates; confirm receipt for critical date communications 4. Ensure all calendar communications are consistent across all sections and year groups	Start of term and ongoing
7	Communicate all policy changes to parents	Policy Documents, Meeting notices	HOC	1. Parents misunderstand or resist policy changes due to insufficient explanation 2. Policy changes communicated to some parents but not all 3. Policy communicated without adequate notice before it takes effect 4. Parents not given an opportunity to ask questions about the change	1. Accompany every policy change communication with a plain-language explanation of the rationale 2. Use all available channels simultaneously to ensure 100% parent reach for policy changes 3. Communicate all policy changes at least 2 weeks before they take effect 4. Hold a Q&A session or provide a dedicated contact for parents to ask questions after any policy change	As needed — at least 2 weeks before implementation
8	Collect feedback from parents	Feedback Forms, Digital Surveys	School Administration	1. Low participation rates due to feedback fatigue or lack of anonymity 2. Feedback collected but not analysed or acted upon 3. Feedback cycle infrequent; emerging issues not identified in time 4. Feedback results not shared with staff who can act on them	1. Offer multiple feedback channels: online survey, printed form and anonymous suggestion box 2. Assign a designated staff member to analyse all feedback within one week of collection; report to HOC 3. Collect feedback at least once per term; collect additional targeted feedback after major events 4. Share a summary of feedback findings and planned responses with all relevant staff within 2 weeks of analysis	Once per term minimum
9	Emergency communication — school closure, incidents or crises	Emergency Contact List, Pre-approved templates	HOC / Staff	1. Delayed emergency communication causes unnecessary alarm or a dangerous information vacuum 2. Inconsistent messages sent by different staff members during an emergency 3. Emergency contact list out of date; some parents cannot be reached 4. Primary communication system unavailable during an emergency	1. Use pre-approved emergency communication templates; issue within 30 minutes of any confirmed emergency 2. Designate a single spokesperson for all emergency communications; no other staff to send messages 3. Update the emergency contact list at the start of every term; test the contact list annually 4. Identify and test a backup communication system (e.g. SMS broadcast) in case the primary system is unavailable	Immediate — real-time response required

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SOP 28: Customer Information and Updates

Purpose: To ensure that all MSIS customers — primarily parents and guardians — receive accurate, timely and relevant information and updates throughout the academic year, maintaining trust, transparency and a strong school-home partnership.
Scope: Applies to HOC, DHOC, HOS, Admin, Accountant, HQ Finance, Class Teachers, Subject Teachers, HOD Activities and Games, IT Team, Head of Home and HOD Guidance and Counselling. Covers all scheduled and triggered parent information activities.

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Termly newsletter — compile and distribute to all parents	HOC's Newsletter, Key term dates	HOC / DHOC / HOS / Admin	1. Unexpected changes within the term render published dates in the newsletter inaccurate 2. Newsletter not distributed to all parents due to incomplete contact database 3. Newsletter content not approved before distribution; errors reach parents 4. Newsletter released too late in the term to be useful for planning purposes	1. Build flexibility into the newsletter by noting that dates are subject to change and will be communicated promptly 2. Cross-check the distribution list against the current enrolment register before every newsletter dispatch 3. HOC to review and approve the newsletter content before distribution; no release without sign-off 4. Distribute the termly newsletter in the first week of each term; do not delay beyond week two	Termly — first week of term
2	Fee debit notes and invoices — generate and send to parents	Mzizi billing system, SMS/Email Templates	Accountant / HQ Finance	1. Parents default on payment deadlines due to late or missed invoice communication 2. Invoice sent with an incorrect amount due to a system or data entry error 3. Financial strain not identified early; parent falls into arrears without a support conversation 4. Invoice sent to an inactive email address; parent claims non-receipt	1. Send fee invoices at least 3 weeks before the payment deadline to allow adequate preparation time 2. Cross-check every invoice against the Mzizi system before dispatch; have a second person verify the amount 3. Monitor accounts for early signs of payment difficulty; contact the parent proactively before a deadline is missed 4. Confirm delivery of fee invoices sent by email; follow up undelivered invoices via SMS or phone	Monthly or termly as per the fee schedule
3	Weekly updates and emerging issues — communicate to parents regularly	Class diaries, WhatsApp class platforms, Phone	HOS / Class Teachers / Admin	1. Inconsistent updates across different classes and year groups create a perception of unfairness 2. Delayed updates during an emerging situation cause parent anxiety 3. Sensitive emerging issues shared on a group platform without HOC approval 4. No response received from parents after updates are sent; concern not escalated	1. Standardise the day and time for all weekly class updates across the school to ensure consistency 2. Issue communication on any emerging issue within 24 hours of it being identified; do not wait for the weekly update 3. Any emerging issue involving individual learner welfare or school safety must be cleared by HOC before communication 4. Track parent acknowledgement of critical updates; follow up non-respondents within 48 hours	Every Friday for routine updates; immediately for emerging issues
4	Parent-Teacher Meeting notifications and scheduling	Termly newsletter, Diaries, WhatsApp, Calendar invites	Class Teachers / Admin Officer	1. Parents miss the meeting notification or forget the appointment date 2. Meeting scheduled at a time when many parents cannot attend 3. Meeting date changes after notification has already been sent 4. Parent arrives without any preparation; meeting time is wasted	1. Send the meeting notification at least 2 weeks before the date; send a reminder 2 days before 2. Survey parents for availability before scheduling; choose the most commonly available time slot 3. If the date changes, communicate the change immediately via all channels; apologise for any inconvenience 4. Send parents a brief pre-meeting agenda at least 3 days before so they can prepare questions	2 weeks and 2 days before the meeting
5	Parenting training and capacity building	Meeting link, Venue, Presentation	HOD Guidance and	1. Parents not acknowledging meeting invites or attending sessions	1. Send personalised invitations via multiple channels; send reminders 1 week, 3 days and 1 day before	As scheduled and when needs arise

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	sessions	materials	Counsellin g / HOS	2. Session content not relevant to current parenting challenges; low engagement 3. Session held at an inaccessible time for working parents 4. Virtual session link not shared in time for parents to join 5. No record kept of who attended; no follow-up for absentees	2. Base session content on parent feedback and current learner wellbeing data; make it practical and relevant 3. Offer both physical and virtual attendance options; schedule sessions in the evening or at school pick-up time 4. Share the virtual session link at least 48 hours before the session; resend as a reminder 30 minutes before start 5. Record attendance; share session notes or a recording with all parents who could not attend	
6	Academic reports dispatch — mid-term and end of term	Report cards, Case history, Merit list, Mzizi system	HOS / Class Teacher / Head of Home / IT Team	1. Wrong report sent to a parent due to a data entry or system error 2. Report not delivered due to an inactive or incorrect email address 3. Report released before HOC has reviewed and approved it 4. Surrogate parent or guardian receives a report intended for the legal parent	1. Double-check all student information against the report before dispatch; second person to verify 2. Test email addresses before mass dispatch; use SMS notification to prompt parents to check email 3. HOC to review and sign off on all reports before any dispatch occurs 4. Verify the authorised report recipient for each learner in the student information system before dispatch	Mid-term and end of each term
7	Complaint and concern response — acknowledge and resolve all parent concerns	Feedback Form, Incident Report	DHOC / HOS / Class Teacher / Admin / Relevant Teacher	1. Delayed response erodes parent trust and escalates the concern unnecessarily 2. Concern passed between staff members without resolution or a clear owner 3. Response given verbally only; concern recurs with no written record to reference 4. Parent concern categorised incorrectly; treated as urgent when it is long-term or vice versa	1. Acknowledge every concern within 24 hours of receipt; provide a resolution or update within 5 working days 2. Assign every concern to a named owner immediately upon receipt; front office to track to resolution 3. All concern responses to be followed up in writing; retain a copy in the school communication file 4. Categorise all concerns on receipt as urgent (requiring same-day response) or standard (5-day resolution)	24-hour acknowledge ment; 5-day resolution target
8	Event invitations — sports day, cultural events and school activities	Poster, Email, SMS, Social media	HOS / HOD Activities and Games	1. Short notice causes low parent attendance at school events 2. Event invitation sent without confirming the event date with the school calendar 3. Invitation not sent to all parents; some sections or year groups missed 4. RSVP not collected; catering or seating is under or over-prepared	1. Send event invitations at least 3 weeks before the event date; include an RSVP deadline 2. Confirm the event date against the school calendar before any invitations are issued 3. Use the full parent contact database for all event invitations; cross-check against the enrolment register 4. Include a clear RSVP link or SMS response option in all event invitations; chase RSVPs 1 week before the event	At least 3 weeks before the event
9	New policy and policy change communication	Policy Document, Memo Template, FAQ Document	HOC / DHOC / HOS / Admin	1. Parents misinterpret the policy change due to unclear language in the communication 2. Policy change communicated with insufficient notice; parents feel blindsided 3. Resistance from parents not managed through engagement; complaints escalate 4. Policy change communication not retained on file; parents dispute what was communicated	1. Use plain language in all policy communications; accompany the policy document with a one-page FAQ 2. Communicate all policy changes at least 2 weeks before the effective date 3. Hold a Q&A session or make HOC or HOS available for questions within one week of the policy communication 4. Retain a copy of all policy communications in the school records; log the date and channel of dispatch	At least 2 weeks before the effective date
10	End-of-term closure message — communicate	Newsletter, WhatsApp, Holiday	HOC / DHOC / HOS /	1. Parents miss the closure message due to inactive communication channels	1. Send the end-of-term closure message at least 2 weeks before the closing date 2. Cross-check all dates in the closure	Last week of term

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	closure dates and holiday guidance	activities guide	Admin	2. Closure message sent with incorrect dates due to a last-minute calendar change 3. Holiday guidance not included; parents unprepared for the break 4. Message sent too late in the term for parents to make holiday arrangements	message against the approved school calendar before dispatch 3. Include a brief holiday activities suggestion or learning guide with the closure message 4. Prompt parents to confirm receipt; follow up non-respondents via SMS within 48 hours of dispatch	

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SOP 29: Handling Customer Complaints

Purpose: To ensure all customer complaints — from parents, students or other stakeholders — are received, investigated, resolved and reviewed in a fair, timely and well-documented manner.
Scope: Applies to Receptionist, Admin, HOS, HODs, HOC, DHOC, Customer Care Officer, Class Teachers, TODs, HR and Quality Assurance Officer. Covers all complaint channels from receipt through to trend review.

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Receive complaint (written, verbal, digital, phone, email, suggestion box, class platform, survey form)	Complaint Form, Digital Complaint Form, Suggestion Box, Complaint Logbook, Customer Survey Forms	Receptionist, Admin, HOS, Customer Care, All Staff	1. Complaint overlooked at the point of receipt 2. Complaint mis recorded or details lost 3. Complaint not reaching the relevant office 4. Multiple channels leading to duplicate or missed records	1. Maintain multiple, well-publicised complaint channels 2. Use a centralised complaint register with timestamps 3. Route every complaint to the relevant office same day 4. Review all complaint channels daily to catch omissions	Immediately upon receipt
2	Acknowledge receipt of complaint	Acknowledgement Template, SMS, Email, Phone Call Log	School Secretary, Admin, HOS, Class Teachers, TODs, Customer Care	1. Parents or students feel ignored or dismissed 2. Acknowledgement delayed beyond the expected window 3. Acknowledgement lacking assurance of follow-up 4. Wrong contact used for the acknowledgement	1. Send a prompt acknowledgement within the set timeframe 2. Use active listening and empathetic language 3. Assure the complainant of a clear follow-up timeline 4. Confirm the correct contact details before sending	Within 24 hours
3	Log and classify complaint according to type and urgency	Complaint Logbook, Digital Complaint Management System, Classification Guide	Admin, HOS, HOC, DHOC, Customer Care Officer	1. Incorrect classification leading to delayed action 2. Urgency underestimated for a critical complaint 3. Logging inconsistent across different staff 4. Classification not reviewed by a supervisor	1. Apply a predefined classification protocol 2. Provide staff training on urgency assessment 3. Standardise logging fields across all channels 4. Have classifications spot-checked by a supervisor	Within 24 hours
4	Assign complaint to the relevant officer or department	Complaint Assignment Tracker, Routing Matrix, Escalation Protocol	HOC, DHOC, HOS, Admin, Customer Care Officer	1. Complaint stalls due to unclear accountability 2. Assignment delayed beyond the target window 3. Wrong department assigned to handle the complaint 4. Assignment not tracked for follow-up	1. Use a clear responsibility matrix for assignment 2. Track every assignment against a target resolution date 3. Apply the routing matrix consistently 4. Confirm assignment ownership with the receiving officer	Within 48 hours
5	Investigate complaint and gather evidence	Investigation Form, Student Records, Incident Reports, Interview Notes	Assigned Officer, HOD, HOS, HOC, DHOC, Admin, Class Teacher	1. Biased findings from the investigation 2. Incomplete information gathered 3. Cover-ups or withheld information 4. Investigation exceeding the expected timeframe	1. Conduct fair and transparent investigations 2. Document all evidence gathered during the investigation 3. Involve a witness or second officer where needed 4. Monitor investigation progress against the timeline	Within 2–3 working days
6	Provide resolution and feedback to complainant	Response Letter, Resolution Template, Email, Phone Call Log	Assigned Officer, HOC, DHOC, HOS, Admin, Class Teacher	1. Dissatisfaction with the proposed outcome 2. Communication delays in relaying the resolution 3. Resolution not clearly explained to the complainant 4. No documented action plan provided	1. Give a clear explanation of the findings 2. Provide a documented action plan alongside the resolution 3. Conduct a quality review before sending the response 4. Follow up verbally where the matter is sensitive	Within 5 working days
7	Escalate	Escalation	HOC,	1. Reputational damage from an	1. Follow a defined escalation ladder	Within 1

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	unresolved or critical complaints	Form, Leadership Review Notes, Principal/School Leadership Records	DHOC, HOS, Admin, HR, Principal	unresolved complaint 2. Escalation ladder not followed consistently 3. Critical complaints delayed in reaching leadership 4. Stakeholders not kept informed during escalation	for all cases 2. Involve relevant stakeholders promptly 3. Fast-track escalation for critical cases 4. Keep the complainant informed of escalation progress	week or sooner for critical cases
8	Document resolution and close case	Case Closure Form, Complaint Management System, Resolution Log	HOC, DHOC, HOS, Admin, Quality Assurance Officer	1. Closure without complete resolution 2. Poor record-keeping at closure 3. Case closed without sign-off 4. Resolution log not updated consistently	1. Complete final documentation before closure 2. Require sign-off by the responsible officer 3. Maintain the resolution log for every case 4. Audit closed cases periodically for completeness	Within 1 day of resolution
9	Follow up with parent/student	Follow-up Form, Satisfaction Survey, Email or Phone Call Record	Class Teacher, Admin, Customer Care Officer	1. Persistent dissatisfaction after closure 2. No improvement tracking after the follow-up 3. Follow-up skipped for minor complaints 4. Feedback from follow-up not recorded	1. Send a satisfaction survey after closure 2. Log follow-up communication and outcomes 3. Apply follow-up consistently regardless of complaint size 4. Record survey feedback for trend analysis	Within 7–10 days after closure
10	Review complaint trends and recommend improvements	Complaint Dashboard, Trend Analysis Reports, Leadership Meeting Minutes	HOC, DHOC, HOS, Admin, HR, Quality Assurance Officer	1. Recurring complaints and systemic issues unaddressed 2. Trends not identified due to inconsistent data 3. Corrective actions not implemented after review 4. Review findings not communicated to relevant departments	1. Conduct monthly and quarterly trend reviews 2. Maintain consistent data entry to support analysis 3. Develop corrective action plans from each review 4. Share review findings with affected departments	Monthly and quarterly

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SOP 30: Intercom Calls Handling

Purpose: To ensure all intercom calls received at MSIS are answered promptly, handled professionally, and relayed accurately to the intended recipient without delay.
Scope: Applies to the Receptionist and all staff receiving relayed messages. Covers the full intercom call handling process from answering the call to message delivery confirmation.

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Promptly answer the school extension line within 2 rings using a standard, polite tone	Telephone/ Extension Line	Receptionist	1. Missed calls due to inattention or absence 2. Caller forced to wait, causing frustration 3. No relief coverage during receptionist breaks 4. Inconsistent tone used across different callers	1. Always remain at the desk or have a relief person during breaks 2. Prioritise answering within 2 rings at all times 3. Arrange scheduled relief coverage for peak periods 4. Use a consistent, polite greeting for every caller	Within 2 rings
2	Respond to inquiries within scope or refer to the appropriate extension	List of Extension Numbers	Receptionist	1. Giving incorrect referrals to the wrong extension 2. Giving incorrect information to the caller 3. Caller transferred multiple times without resolution 4. Outdated extension list used for referral	1. Encourage the receptionist to clarify the caller's request first 2. Refer to an updated, accurate list of extension numbers 3. Confirm the correct department before transferring 4. Review and update the extension list each term	During the call
3	Relay messages to the intended staff member promptly via appropriate channel	Email System, WhatsApp, SMS	Receptionist	1. Delay in message delivery affecting operations 2. Message details lost or altered in relay 3. Intended recipient unreachable through the chosen channel 4. No confirmation that the message was received	1. Standardise the follow-up procedure with message confirmation 2. Relay messages verbatim using the recorded details 3. Use an alternative channel if the first attempt fails 4. Confirm receipt with the intended staff member	Within 10 minutes of call

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SOP 31: Reception Telephone Call

Purpose: To ensure all incoming telephone calls to MSIS reception are answered promptly, handled professionally, and followed up consistently to give callers a positive experience.
Scope: Applies to the Receptionist. Covers the full call handling process from receiving the call through to follow-up on messages.

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Receive incoming calls promptly (within 2 rings) using a standard, polite tone	Telephone, Headset	Receptionist	1. Missed calls due to receptionist being away from the desk 2. Caller hangs up due to delays in answering 3. No backup coverage during breaks 4. Inconsistent tone used when answering	1. Always be at the desk during work hours 2. Have a backup or call-forwarding system during breaks/peak times 3. Prioritise picking up within 3 rings at most 4. Use a consistent, polite tone for every call	Pick up (within 3 rings)
2	Greet the caller professionally, e.g. 'Thank you for calling Mustard. Good morning. This is (your name) speaking. How may I help you?'	None	Receptionist	1. Caller confusion or frustration from an unclear greeting 2. Unprofessional or unclear tone used 3. Greeting script not followed consistently 4. Receptionist name omitted from the greeting	1. Use a consistent script for greeting 2. Provide receptionist training on tone, pace, and clarity 3. Reinforce use of the standard script through spot checks 4. Ensure the receptionist states their name every time	Constantly
3	Listen and clarify the need (do not interrupt; ask clarifying questions)	Notepad, Pen	Receptionist	1. Miscommunication of the caller's need 2. Wrong details taken down 3. Caller interrupted before finishing their request 4. Clarifying questions not asked when needed	1. Confirm details by repeating them back for clarity 2. Use active listening throughout the call 3. Allow the caller to finish before responding 4. Ask clarifying questions where the need is unclear	During the call
4	Respond to or refer the caller appropriately	None	Receptionist	1. Receptionist gives incorrect or incomplete information 2. Caller referred to the wrong department 3. Response delayed beyond a reasonable time 4. Referral made without confirming availability	1. Ask clarifying questions to understand the caller's need before responding 2. Confirm the correct department before referring 3. Respond within 1–2 minutes where possible 4. Verify the receiving party's availability before transfer	Within 1–2 minutes
5	Take messages when required (record caller name, contact, date, time, message)	Message Book, Pen	Receptionist	1. Missing or incorrect message details 2. Miscommunication due to lack of clarity 3. Message book not used consistently 4. Message not delivered to the intended recipient promptly	1. Use a structured message template 2. Repeat back to the caller to confirm accuracy 3. Ensure the message book is used for every message 4. Deliver the message to the intended party without delay	During the call
6	Log call details after each call (write a summary in the call log)	Call Logbook	Receptionist	1. Missed entries in the call log 2. Incomplete documentation of the call 3. Logging delayed until end of day 4. Call log not reviewed for accuracy	1. Log immediately after each call 2. Use a checklist or daily log format 3. Complete entries in real time, not retrospectively 4. Spot-check the log periodically for completeness	Immediatel y after call
7	End the call politely, e.g.	None	Receptionist	1. Abrupt or impolite ending to the call	1. Use a standard closing line 2. Wait for the caller to end the call	End of each call

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	'Thank you for calling. Have a good day.'			2. Caller feels rushed at the end of the call 3. Closing line not used consistently 4. Call ended before caller has finished speaking	first 3. Reinforce the standard closing through training 4. Ensure the caller has no further questions before closing	
8	Follow up on messages (deliver message to concerned party and confirm receipt)	WhatsApp Messages, Email	Receptionist	1. Message not received by the intended person 2. No action taken on a delivered message 3. Follow-up delayed beyond a reasonable time 4. Delivery not confirmed with the recipient	1. Send messages within 30 minutes 2. Track follow-up using a simple tracker 3. Confirm receipt with the intended recipient 4. Escalate to the Admin office if no response is received	Within the same working day

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SECTION E: CATERING & NUTRITION

SOP 32: Menu Planning and Nutritional Assessment

Purpose: To ensure MSIS meals are nutritionally balanced, appropriately budgeted, and planned in line with the school population and approved dietary guidelines each term.
Scope: Applies to Cateress, Kitchen Staff, Receptionist, Administrator, Accountant and Store Keeper. Covers the process from nutritional guideline review through to printing of the approved menu.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Review nutritional guidelines	Nutritional Guidelines – Balanced Diet	Cateress, Kitchen Staff	1. Misalignment with recommended dietary needs 2. Guidelines reviewed inconsistently across terms 3. Outdated guidelines used for planning 4. Kitchen staff unaware of updated guidelines	1. Use approved and updated guidelines 2. Review guidelines at the start of every term 3. Source guideline updates from a recognised nutrition authority 4. Brief kitchen staff on any guideline changes	2 weeks before close of a school term
2	Assess the school population	Daily Roll	Cateress, Receptionist	1. Incomplete or outdated population data 2. Roll figures not reconciled with actual attendance 3. Population changes not captured before planning 4. Data collected from a single, unverified source	1. Update records before assessment begins 2. Reconcile the daily roll with attendance records 3. Capture population changes promptly each term 4. Cross-check figures with the admin office	2 weeks before close of a school term
3	Menu planning	Previous Term Menu, Weekly Menu Plan, Nutritional Guidelines	Cateress, Administrator	1. Unbalanced diet in the planned menu 2. Menu not varied enough across the week 3. Planning not informed by the previous term's menu 4. Guidelines not consistently applied	1. Consult a nutritionist where needed 2. Follow the laid-down nutritional guidelines 3. Reference the previous term's menu for variety 4. Cross-check the plan against the guidelines before finalising	2 weeks before close of a school term
4	Establish a budget	Budget Plans, Consumption Records	Cateress, Administrator, Accountant, Store Keeper	1. Under-estimation of required budget 2. Over-budgeting beyond available funds 3. Components omitted from the budget (e.g. fuel, labour) 4. Consumption records not accurate	1. Itemise all components (ingredients, fuel, labour, etc.) for accuracy 2. Cross-check the budget against past consumption records 3. Involve the Accountant in budget verification 4. Review the budget before submission for approval	One week before school closes
5	Conduct a food availability survey	Quotations	Cateress, Store Keeper	1. Inconsistent food supply from suppliers 2. Survey conducted with a limited supplier pool 3. Prices quoted not competitive 4. Survey findings not documented	1. Identify alternative suppliers in advance 2. Obtain quotations from multiple suppliers 3. Compare prices before finalising suppliers 4. Document survey findings for reference	One week before school closes
6	Plan a balanced weekly menu — for a whole term	Menu Templates, Dietary Needs, List of Fruits/Food in Season	Cateress, Store Keeper	1. Unbalanced meals across the week 2. Seasonal food availability not considered 3. Dietary needs of specific learners overlooked 4. Menu repeated too frequently within the term	1. Cross-check with guidelines and population needs 2. Plan around seasonal fruits and produce 3. Flag known dietary needs for accommodation 4. Vary the weekly menu to avoid repetition	One week before school closes
7	Finalize the	Computer, Draft Menu	Cateress, Administrator	1. Errors when keying in data 2. Budget and menu figures not	1. Cross-check the document before presenting for approval	One week before school

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	budget and menu	Copy	, Accountant, Store Keeper	reconciled 3. Draft finalised without a final review 4. Version confusion between drafts	2. Reconcile budget and menu figures before submission 3. Conduct a final review with all involved parties 4. Clearly label and control document versions	closes
8	Approval of the menu and the budget	Budget, Menu	Cateress, Administrator , HOC	1. Delay in presenting the menu for approval 2. Budget not approved as submitted 3. Approval sought without complete documentation 4. Feedback from approval not incorporated	1. Adhere to approval timelines strictly 2. Ensure complete documentation accompanies the submission 3. Address any queries raised during approval promptly 4. Incorporate approval feedback before finalising	First week of every holiday month
9	Printing of the approved menu	Menu	Administrator	1. Delay in approval of the menu affecting printing 2. Printed menu not matching the approved version 3. Copies not ready before term opens 4. Correctness of the budget not verified before printing	1. Ensure correctness of the budget before printing 2. Print only from the final approved version 3. Plan printing to be complete before school opens 4. Verify printed copies against the approved menu	2 weeks before the school opens

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SOP 33: Menu Costing Approval and Implementation

Purpose: To ensure the school menu is accurately costed, properly approved by the relevant authorities, and correctly implemented within the approved budget each term.
Scope: Applies to Cateress, Admin, Store Keeper, Typist, Accountant, HQ, Finance Director, Board, D/HOC, HOC and HOS. Covers the process from data collection through to menu implementation.

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Collection of data — list of requirements	Writing Materials, Pens, List of Market Prices, List of Cereals	Cateress, Admin, Store Keeper	1. Inaccurate information collected from the market 2. Delay in getting the required information 3. Lack of a complete list of requirements 4. Data collected from an unreliable source	1. Verify the information given before use 2. Ensure timeliness in collecting all required data 3. Cross-check the requirements list for completeness 4. Source information from consistent, reliable suppliers	Last week of every term
2	Coming up with a menu / computation	Previous Term's Menu, List of Ingredients & Quantities, Recipes	Cateress	1. Omission of key ingredients or meals 2. Miscalculations in quantity computations 3. Menu not aligned with the previous term's learnings 4. Nutritional balance overlooked during drafting	1. Ensure accuracy in all computations 2. Cross-check against the previous term's menu 3. Reference the nutritional guidelines during drafting 4. Have the draft menu reviewed before costing	Termly
3	Menu costing	Budget, Store Balances, Food/Cereal Costs, Quotations/ Prices	Cateress, Accountant, Store Keeper	1. Assumptions made on costs and budgets 2. Wrong data used for the roll (learner numbers) 3. Inaccurate store balances used in costing 4. Current market prices not reflected	1. Ensure current market prices are considered 2. Ensure the roll figures are accurate before costing 3. Verify store balances against physical stock 4. Cross-check quotations from at least two suppliers	1st week of every holiday month
4	Typing of the menu	Computer/Laptop	Typist	1. Omission of items during typing 2. Typing errors in quantities or prices 3. Formatting inconsistent with the approved template 4. Draft not proofread before submission	1. Ensure all data is captured as per the manuscript (hard copy) 2. Proofread the typed menu against the manuscript 3. Use the standard menu template for consistency 4. Have a second person verify the typed document	1st week of every holiday month
5	Presentation of the menu for approval	Costed Menu	Cateress, Admin, HOC	1. Delay in approval affecting implementation timelines 2. Menu presented without full costing details 3. Approval sought without required supporting documents 4. Presentation scheduled too close to term start	1. Ensure the menu is handed in good time 2. Attach full costing details to the presentation 3. Include all required supporting documents 4. Schedule presentation with adequate lead time	2nd week of every holiday month
6	Presentation of the menu to the Board for approval	Menu File	Administrator, Accountant, HQ, Finance Director, Board	1. Menu not approved by the Board 2. Menu inconsistent with the approved budget 3. Board review delayed due to incomplete file 4. Feedback from the Board not incorporated	1. Ensure the menu corresponds with the budget 2. Ensure the menu file is complete before submission 3. Follow up promptly on the Board's review timeline 4. Incorporate Board feedback before final sign-off	2nd week of every holiday month
7	Printing and giving copies to the	Copies of Approved Menu	Cateress, Cooks, Account	1. Delay in giving copies to the relevant offices 2. Incomplete distribution list used	1. Ensure copies are distributed to all relevant offices 2. Maintain a checklist of offices	Immediately after approval

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	relevant offices		ant, Admin, Store Keeper, D/HOC, HOC, HOS	3. Copies printed with the wrong version 4. Offices proceeding without their copy of the menu	requiring copies 3. Print only from the final approved version 4. Confirm receipt of the copy with each office	
8	Implementation of the menu	Copy of Approved Menu	Cateress, Cooks, Admin, Store Keeper	1. Going over the approved budget 2. Staff failing to follow the approved menu 3. Ingredients unavailable for the planned meal 4. Implementation not monitored for compliance	1. Continuously monitor and evaluate menu budgets 2. Apply punitive measures for failure to follow the approved menu 3. Identify alternative ingredients in advance where needed 4. Assign a supervisor to check daily menu compliance	Immediately after approval / Beginning of a term

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SECTION F: FACILITIES & MAINTENANCE

SOP 34: Pool Deck and Pool Tile Cleaning

Purpose: To maintain a clean, safe and hygienic swimming pool deck and tile surface through a consistent daily, weekly and as-needed cleaning routine.
Scope: Applies to Pool Attendants/Cleaners, Maintenance staff, and the Supervisor. Covers all pool deck and pool tile cleaning activities from daily sweeping through to post-clean inspection.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Sweep pool deck to remove dirt, leaves, litter	Broom, Dustpan, Waste Bin	Pool Attendant/ Cleaner	1. Slips from debris left on the deck 2. Sweeping not covering all deck areas 3. Waste bin overflowing before disposal 4. Sweeping skipped on a scheduled day	1. Sweep thoroughly and wear non-slip footwear 2. Follow a room-by-room, section-by-section approach 3. Empty the waste bin before it overflows 4. Supervisor to confirm daily sweeping is completed	Daily, morning before pool opens
2	Scrub deck tiles with detergent and water	Soft/Medium Brush, Mild Detergent, Bucket, Mop	Pool Attendant/ Cleaner	1. Slippery surfaces during cleaning 2. Detergent residue left on tiles 3. Cleaning done without warning signage 4. Sections missed during scrubbing	1. Put up 'Wet Floor' signage; clean in sections 2. Rinse thoroughly to remove detergent residue 3. Ensure signage is visible before starting 4. Follow a checklist to confirm all sections are scrubbed	Twice weekly/As needed
3	Pressure wash pool deck for deep cleaning	Pressure Washer, Water Hose	Pool Attendant/ Maintenance	1. Electrical hazard from pressure washing equipment 2. Slippery surface during and after washing 3. Improper machine use causing tile damage 4. Washing conducted without PPE	1. Use an outdoor-rated machine with proper signage and PPE 2. Keep electrical connections away from wet areas 3. Follow manufacturer guidance for the pressure washer 4. Ensure PPE is worn throughout the activity	Weekly
4	Disinfect deck tiles	Chlorine Solution (diluted), Mop	Pool Attendant	1. Chemical burns from concentrated chlorine 2. Strong fumes affecting attendant or nearby persons 3. Incorrect dilution ratio used 4. Ventilation inadequate during disinfection	1. Use gloves and dilute as per the safety guide 2. Ensure adequate ventilation during disinfection 3. Follow the correct dilution ratio strictly 4. Restrict access to the area during disinfection	Weekly/After heavy use
5	Brush inside pool tiles (walls, waterline, steps, corners)	Long-Handled Pool Brush	Pool Attendant	1. Muscle strain from repetitive brushing 2. Risk of falling into the pool 3. Corners and steps missed during brushing 4. Brushing done without proper footing	1. Use proper footing and brush slowly 2. Take breaks to avoid muscle strain 3. Pay particular attention to corners and steps 4. Ensure the deck surface is dry underfoot where possible	Daily
6	Vacuum pool floor tiles	Pool Vacuum (manual/auto), Hose	Pool Attendant	1. Electrical hazard from vacuum equipment 2. Tripping over hoses or cables 3. Equipment malfunction during use 4. Vacuuming incomplete on the pool floor	1. Ensure equipment is insulated and cables are secured 2. Route hoses away from walkways 3. Inspect equipment before each use 4. Follow a set pattern to ensure full floor coverage	Daily
7	Scrub stubborn stains and grout lines	Pool Tile Cleaner (non-acidic), Scrubbing	Pool Attendant	1. Skin irritation from cleaning chemicals 2. Grout lines damaged by abrasive scrubbing 3. Stains not fully removed	1. Wear gloves and avoid direct contact with skin 2. Use a non-abrasive pad suited to the grout 3. Re-treat stubborn stains as needed	Weekly

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
		Pad		4. Cleaner used without checking compatibility	4. Confirm the cleaner is safe for the tile type	
8	Shock treatment to prevent algae on tiles	Chlorine Shock Chemicals, Test Kit	Pool Attendant under the Supervisor	1. Over-chlorination causing chemical burns 2. Pool used too soon after treatment 3. Chemicals measured inaccurately 4. Treatment conducted without supervision	1. Use PPE and measure chemicals precisely 2. Close the pool for the required period after treatment 3. Use the test kit to confirm safe chemical levels 4. Ensure the Supervisor oversees the treatment	Weekly/As scheduled
9	Rinse and inspect deck and pool tiles	Clean Water, Hose, Inspection Checklist	Supervisor/ Attendant	1. Missed debris left after cleaning 2. Unnoticed damage to tiles or deck 3. Inspection not recorded in the logbook 4. Rinsing incomplete in some areas	1. Conduct a walk-through inspection after every clean 2. Record findings in the logbook 3. Ensure rinsing covers the entire deck and tile area 4. Report any damage found to the Facilities Manager	After each cleaning session

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SOP 35: Repairs and Maintenance

Purpose: To ensure all maintenance and repair needs across MSIS facilities are reported, assessed, approved, executed and closed out through a consistent, well-documented and timely process.
Scope: Applies to Staff, Teachers, Learners, Works Officer/Maintenance Supervisor, Maintenance Team, Contractors, Administration and HOC. Covers all repair and maintenance activities from initial reporting through to preventive maintenance scheduling.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Reporting maintenance or repair needs	Maintenance Request Form, Email, Phone	Staff, Teachers, Learners/Students	1. Delay in reporting an identified issue 2. Minor issues escalating into major problems 3. Report submitted through an untracked channel 4. Reporting party unaware of the correct procedure	1. Encourage prompt reporting of any issue observed 2. Maintain visible, well-publicised reporting channels 3. Route all reports through the maintenance request form 4. Brief staff and learners on the reporting procedure	Within 24 hours of identifying the issue
2	Logging and prioritizing reported issues	Maintenance Logbook	Works Officer/Maintenance Supervisor	1. Failure to track or follow up on reported issues 2. Incorrect prioritisation of urgent cases 3. Duplicate entries for the same issue 4. Logbook not updated in real time	1. Maintain both digital and physical records 2. Assign a clear priority level to every report 3. Cross-check new reports against existing entries 4. Update the logbook as soon as a report is received	Same day the report is received
3	Inspection and assessment of the reported issue	Inspection Checklist	Works Officer/Maintenance Team	1. Inaccurate assessment of the problem 2. Inspection delayed beyond the target window 3. Relevant staff not consulted during inspection 4. Inspection findings not documented	1. Use a standard inspection checklist 2. Involve relevant staff during the inspection 3. Conduct the inspection within the target timeframe 4. Record findings clearly on the checklist	Within 48 hours of reporting
4	Approval of maintenance or repair works	Requisition Form, Approval Form, Budget Documents	Head of Campus (HOC)	1. Budget constraints delaying necessary works 2. Delays in approval for non-urgent cases 3. Urgent cases not flagged appropriately 4. Approval granted without full cost information	1. Maintain a pre-approved budget for minor works 2. Flag urgent cases for expedited approval 3. Attach full cost information to every request 4. Review pending approvals daily to avoid backlog	Within 2 days for urgent cases; within 1 week for non-urgent
5	Engaging internal maintenance personnel or external contractors	Approved Supplier List, Work Order, Approved Requisition	Works Officer/Maintenance Supervisor	1. Use of unqualified personnel 2. Contractor engaged without a work order 3. Costs exceeding the approved requisition 4. Work assigned without verifying availability	1. Use approved suppliers and verify qualifications before engaging 2. Issue a work order before any work begins 3. Confirm costs align with the approved requisition 4. Confirm contractor availability before scheduling	Within 3 days for urgent cases; within 1 week for non-urgent
6	Communication to stakeholders	Email, WhatsApp, Notice Board, Memo	Administration, HOC	1. Stakeholders unaware of planned works or disruptions 2. Communication sent too close to the work start date 3. Affected areas not clearly identified in the notice 4. Follow-up updates not sent for prolonged works	1. Communicate promptly through appropriate channels before works begin 2. Send notices at least 24 hours in advance 3. Clearly identify affected areas in the communication 4. Issue follow-up updates for works spanning several days	At least 24 hours before works commence
7	Execution of repair and	Work Order, Tools and	Maintenance Team,	1. Injury or accidents during execution	1. Ensure proper use of PPE at all	Minor works: same day;

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	maintenance works	Equipment, Personal Protective Equipment	Works Officer, Contractor	2. Poor-quality work delivered 3. Work extending beyond the approved schedule 4. PPE not worn consistently during works	times 2. Supervise works throughout execution 3. Conduct quality checks during and after the work 4. Monitor progress against the approved schedule	major works: as per approved schedule
8	Inspection and confirmation of completed work	Completion Certificate/Report, Inspection Checklist	Works Officer/Maintenance Supervisor	1. Substandard work not detected at handover 2. Inspection skipped due to time pressure 3. Feedback from the requester not sought 4. Completion certificate issued without verification	1. Conduct post-completion inspections 2. Obtain feedback from the original requester 3. Verify work against the inspection checklist before sign-off 4. Withhold the completion certificate until verified	Within 1 day of completion
9	Documentation and closure of the issue	Updated Maintenance Log, Maintenance Records	Works Officer/Maintenance Supervisor	1. Poor record-keeping and loss of information 2. Closure recorded without full details 3. Maintenance records not backed up 4. Issue closed without requester confirmation	1. Update digital and manual records promptly and accurately 2. Record full details of the resolution at closure 3. Maintain a digital backup of maintenance records 4. Confirm closure with the original requester where practical	Within 24 hours of completion
10	Preventive maintenance scheduling	Preventive Maintenance Plan	Works Officer/Maintenance Supervisor	1. Equipment breakdowns due to neglect 2. Preventive schedule not followed consistently 3. Critical assets omitted from the plan 4. Preventive checks not documented	1. Adhere to the preventive maintenance schedule 2. Conduct regular equipment checks as planned 3. Ensure all critical assets are included in the plan 4. Log every preventive check for accountability	Monthly, quarterly, or as specified in the maintenance plan

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SOP 36: Sewer Lines, Drainage Cleaning and Gutters

Purpose: To maintain functional, blockage-free sewer lines, drainage channels and gutters at MSIS through routine inspection and cleaning, preventing overflow, flooding and associated hazards.
Scope: Applies to Maintenance Staff and trained personnel handling sewer, drainage and gutter cleaning. Covers all activities from visual inspection of sewage lines through to cleaning of gutters and downpipes.

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Visual inspection of sewage lines for blockages	Inspection Checklist, Torchlight	Maintenance Staff	1. Undetected blockages causing overflow 2. Inspection skipped during dry periods 3. Findings not recorded consistently 4. Inspection points not fully covered	1. Conduct routine scheduled inspections 2. Record findings after every inspection 3. Inspect all known blockage-prone points 4. Increase inspection frequency after heavy rains	Weekly and after heavy rains
2	Opening of manholes to check flow	Manhole Keys, Gloves, Overalls	Maintenance Staff	1. Exposure to harmful waste 2. Manhole left open unsupervised 3. Incorrect tools used to open the manhole 4. Inspection conducted without protective clothing	1. Use protective clothing and proper tools 2. Ensure the manhole is securely closed after checking 3. Use only the designated manhole keys 4. Never leave an open manhole unattended	Monthly and when blockage suspected
3	Cleaning of blocked sewage lines	Sewer Rods, Gloves, Overalls, Disinfectant	Trained Maintenance Staff	1. Health hazards from contact with waste 2. Untrained personnel attempting the task 3. Waste disposed of improperly after cleaning 4. Disinfection step skipped after cleaning	1. Ensure only trained personnel handle this task 2. Use PPE throughout the cleaning process 3. Dispose of waste properly per school procedure 4. Disinfect the area after every cleaning	As needed upon blockage detection
4	Inspection of drainage channels and culverts	Inspection Checklist, Torchlight	Maintenance Staff	1. Blockages leading to flooding 2. Culverts not inspected before rainy season 3. Debris accumulation not identified early 4. Inspection findings not escalated	1. Conduct routine inspections especially before rainy season 2. Inspect all culverts on a fixed schedule 3. Identify and clear debris before it accumulates 4. Escalate significant findings to the Facilities Manager	Monthly and after heavy rains
5	Cleaning of blocked drainage channels	Shovels, Rakes, Wheelbarrows	Maintenance Staff	1. Injuries from debris or contaminated materials 2. Cleaning conducted without proper tools 3. Cleared debris not disposed of correctly 4. Channel left partially blocked	1. Use PPE and handle debris carefully 2. Ensure the correct tools are available before starting 3. Dispose of cleared debris at the designated point 4. Verify the channel is fully clear before closing out	As needed upon blockage detection
6	Inspection of gutters and downpipes	Ladder, Inspection Checklist	Maintenance Staff	1. Accumulated leaves causing water overflow 2. Inspection missed on hard-to-reach gutters 3. Ladder used without safety precautions 4. Inspection not scheduled ahead of rainy season	1. Conduct routine checks especially before and during rainy seasons 2. Use a stable, properly secured ladder 3. Schedule inspection of all gutters, including hard-to-reach ones 4. Plan inspections ahead of the rainy season	Monthly and after heavy winds/rains
7	Cleaning of gutters and downpipes	Ladder, Gloves, Cleaning Tools	Maintenance Staff	1. Falls from height during cleaning 2. Contact with dirty or contaminated materials 3. Cleaning conducted alone	1. Use stable ladders and work in pairs 2. Use PPE throughout the cleaning task 3. Never conduct height work without a second person present	Quarterly and after heavy rains

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
				without a second person 4. Downpipes left partially blocked	4. Verify downpipes are fully clear before finishing	

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SECTION G: HUMAN RESOURCES & ADMINISTRATION

SOP 37: Business Permits and Licences Renewal

Purpose: To ensure all business permits, operating licences and statutory certificates held by MSIS are renewed on time, in full compliance with all applicable Kenyan regulations, protecting the school from operational disruption or legal penalties.

Scope: Applies to the Administrator, PA, Accountant and HOC. Covers the full permit and licence renewal cycle from identification and documentation through to filing, reporting and annual audit.

No.	Activity /How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Identify all required business permits and licences for the year	Regulatory checklist, Previous year's licences	Admin	1. A required licence is overlooked, exposing the school to regulatory non-compliance 2. Checklist not updated to reflect new regulatory requirements introduced since the last renewal 3. Responsibility for the renewal process not clearly assigned to a specific staff member 4. Checklist maintained informally and not shared with HOC for verification	1. Maintain a comprehensive, annually reviewed checklist of all required permits and licences 2. Review the checklist at the start of each year against current regulatory requirements; consult legal counsel if needed 3. Assign the Administrator as the primary owner of the renewal process with clear written responsibility 4. Submit the permit and licence checklist to the HOC for review and approval every January	Early January
2	Check all expiry dates and set renewal deadlines for each licence	Previous permits, Licence documents	Admin	1. Renewal deadline missed because expiry dates were not tracked systematically 2. Expiry date transcribed incorrectly from the licence document 3. No reminder system in place; renewal only identified when the licence has already expired 4. Renewal calendar not shared with the HOC; no oversight of approaching deadlines	1. Use a renewal calendar or digital reminder system; set the first reminder 60 days before each expiry 2. Cross-check all transcribed expiry dates against the original licence document; have a second person verify 3. Set reminders at 60 days, 30 days and 14 days before each renewal deadline 4. Share the renewal calendar with the HOC at the start of each year; provide monthly status updates	January — immediately after identification
3	Collect all documentation required for each renewal	Official documents (PIN certificate, registration, tax compliance)	PA / Admin	1. Incomplete or expired supporting documents cause the renewal application to be rejected 2. Documents collected at the last minute, leaving insufficient time to address gaps 3. Original documents lost; copies cannot be authenticated 4. Required documents differ from the previous year; new requirements not identified in advance	1. Begin document collection at least 6 weeks before the renewal deadline to allow time to resolve any gaps 2. Maintain updated records of all supporting documents throughout the year; do not allow them to lapse 3. Store all original documents in a secure, labelled physical file and a scanned digital backup 4. Check requirements with the issuing authority at the start of each renewal cycle; do not assume requirements are unchanged	January
4	Engage relevant authorities — County offices, Public Health, NEMA	Application forms, Online portals	Admin	1. Long queues or unclear procedures at county offices cause significant delay 2. Online portal not functional on the day of submission, requiring a physical visit 3. Authority contact person changed; previous contact no longer relevant 4. Engagement delayed too close to the deadline; insufficient time to resolve complications	1. Visit county and public health offices early in the morning to reduce queue time; use online systems where available 2. Identify and save the online portal login and submission process before the deadline; have a physical backup plan 3. Establish and maintain relationships with a named contact at each relevant authority 4. Engage all authorities at least one month before the renewal deadline; do not leave contact to the last two weeks	At least one month before each renewal deadline
5	Place a procurement requisition for renewal	Requisition form	Accountant	1. Requisition delayed due to approval bottleneck, causing payment to miss the deadline 2. Requisition raised for the wrong	1. Submit the requisition at least one month before the renewal payment deadline 2. Confirm the current renewal fee with the issuing authority before raising the	One month to one week before renewal

No.	Activity /How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	fees			amount due to an outdated fee schedule 3. Requisition not approved before the payment deadline 4. No record of the requisition raised; disputes arise over whether payment was authorised	requisition 3. Escalate any unapproved requisition to the HOC at least 2 weeks before the payment deadline 4. Retain a signed copy of every requisition in the finance file for audit purposes	
6	Make payments for all renewals through official channels	Payment receipts, M-Pesa or bank slips	Accountant	1. Overpayment or fraud due to payment being made through an unofficial channel 2. Payment made but receipt not obtained or retained 3. Payment processed after the deadline; late penalty incurred 4. Payment made to the wrong account or entity	1. Pay only through official, government-designated payment channels; never to personal accounts 2. Obtain and file an official receipt immediately for every payment made 3. Process all renewal payments at least 2 weeks before the renewal deadline 4. Verify the payee's name and account details against the official authority records before every payment	At least 2 weeks before renewal deadline
7	Submit renewal applications and follow up on processing	Acknowledgement receipts	Accountant	1. Application lost or delayed in processing without the school's knowledge 2. No acknowledgement of submission obtained; no proof of timely application 3. Follow-up not conducted; delay discovered only when the licence has expired 4. Application submitted to the wrong department or office	1. Obtain a dated, signed acknowledgement of every application submitted; retain in the permit file 2. Follow up with the issuing authority every 5 working days after submission until the renewed licence is received 3. If the renewed licence is not received within 2 weeks of the expected date, escalate to the HOC 4. Confirm the correct department and submission address with the authority before submitting each application	2 weeks before renewal deadline
8	Receive and verify all renewed licences and permits	Valid renewed licences	Admin	1. Forged or invalid renewed documents received and filed without verification 2. Renewed licence contains an error (wrong name, wrong period) not detected at receipt 3. Licence received but not filed promptly; misplaced before entry into the compliance register 4. Renewed licence for a different year or period accepted by mistake	1. Cross-check every renewed licence against the issuing authority's official records before accepting 2. Inspect all details on the renewed licence (name, registration number, validity period) before filing 3. File the renewed licence in the compliance register on the same day of receipt 4. Confirm the renewal period on the licence explicitly matches the expected validity before accepting	One week before the renewal date
9	File all valid permits and update the compliance register	Compliance register, Physical and digital filing system	Admin	1. Documents misplaced after receipt due to absence of a structured filing system 2. Compliance register not updated, leaving an incomplete record of valid licences 3. Only physical copies retained; digital backup not maintained 4. Filing not completed promptly; documents pile up and risk being lost	1. File every renewed document in both a labelled physical folder and a digital folder on the same day of receipt 2. Update the compliance register immediately after filing; include the new expiry date for each licence 3. Maintain a digital scan of every permit in a cloud-based backup accessible to the HOC 4. Establish a same-day filing rule: no document to remain unfiled after the day it is received	Immediately after renewal is received
10	Report renewal status to school management	Summary report	HOC	1. Management unaware of the compliance status of the school's permits 2. Renewal status reported only verbally; no written record for governance purposes 3. Expired or non-compliant permits not flagged to management in time for remedial action 4. Report not included in the board	1. Include a written permit and licence renewal status report in every termly management report 2. Report in writing to the HOC and board on the same day any renewed document is received 3. Flag any permit that is pending renewal or at risk of expiry immediately to the HOC; do not wait for the termly report 4. Include the permit compliance status in	Same day documents are received; included in termly reports

No.	Activity /How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
				reporting cycle; governance gap	the termly board report as a standing governance item	
11	Conduct an internal compliance audit of all permits and licences	Internal audit checklist	HOC / Admin	1. Non-compliance discovered during an external inspection rather than an internal audit 2. Audit conducted without reference to the regulatory requirements for each licence 3. Audit findings not acted upon; same gaps found in subsequent audits 4. Audit not conducted annually; compliance status drifts without detection	1. Conduct the internal audit by the end of March each year using the compliance checklist 2. Cross-reference each licence against its current regulatory requirements during the audit 3. Produce a written audit findings report with a specific action plan for each gap identified 4. Schedule the annual audit as a fixed item in the school's governance calendar; do not allow it to be deferred	End of March annually

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SOP 38: Casual Hiring

Purpose: To ensure casual staff are engaged through a fair, documented and compliant process, from identification of need through to end-of-engagement feedback.
Scope: Applies to Department Heads/Supervisors, Admin, HOC, HR, and Accounts. Covers the process from identifying the need for casual staff through to end-of-engagement feedback.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Identify need for casual staff	Departmental Request Form / Workload Assessment	Department Head / Supervisor / Admin	1. Understaffing may delay service delivery 2. Need identified too late for timely hiring 3. Workload assessment not documented 4. Request submitted without justification	1. Conduct a timely needs assessment and approval 2. Identify staffing needs ahead of peak periods 3. Document the workload assessment supporting the request 4. Include clear justification in the request	At least 3–7 days before need
2	Obtain approval for casual hiring	Casual Staff Request Form, Budget Approval	HOC, HR	1. Budget overruns from unauthorized hiring 2. Approval delayed beyond the target window 3. Hiring proceeding without policy compliance check 4. Funds availability not verified	1. Verify availability of funds and policy compliance 2. Process approval within the target timeframe 3. Confirm compliance with hiring policy before approval 4. Flag any budget concern to HOC before proceeding	Within 1 day of request
3	Prepare job description and terms	Job Brief, Work Schedule	Admin, HOD	1. Incomplete or unclear terms of engagement 2. Job classification not aligned with the role 3. Standard template not used 4. Work schedule not specified	1. Use standard templates and job classification 2. Ensure all terms are clearly stated before engagement 3. Specify the work schedule in the job brief 4. Have the HOD review the job description	1 day
4	Source candidates	Internal Database, Referrals	Admin	1. Poor quality or unfit candidates sourced 2. Sourcing limited to a narrow pool 3. Candidates not pre-screened 4. Referrals not verified	1. Pre-screen candidates using set criteria 2. Draw from the internal database and verified referrals 3. Verify candidate suitability before shortlisting 4. Maintain a pool of vetted candidates for future needs	1–2 days
5	Conduct briefing and orientation	Orientation Checklist, Code of Conduct	Admin, Supervisor	1. Safety incidents due to inadequate orientation 2. Misconduct from unclear expectations 3. Orientation skipped for urgent hires 4. Code of conduct not communicated	1. Provide mandatory orientation on rules and safety 2. Communicate the code of conduct clearly before work begins 3. Do not waive orientation even for urgent hires 4. Use the orientation checklist to confirm coverage	On first day of hire
6	Sign contract and documents	Casual Hiring Form, ID Copy	Admin, Accountant, Casual Staff	1. Legal disputes from incomplete documentation 2. Work commencing before documentation is signed 3. ID copy not verified 4. Contract terms not explained to the casual staff	1. Ensure all documentation is complete before work starts 2. Verify ID copy against the contract details 3. Explain contract terms clearly to the casual staff member 4. Retain signed documentation on file	Before deployment
7	Assign duties and monitor performance	Daily Task Allocation, Attendance Register	Supervisor, Admin	1. Low productivity going unaddressed 2. Absenteeism not tracked 3. Duties not clearly assigned	1. Maintain close supervision and daily performance check-ins 2. Track attendance using the register 3. Assign duties clearly at the start of	Ongoing

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
				4. Performance issues not raised promptly	each shift 4. Address performance issues promptly with the casual staff member	
8	Process payment	Requisition, Petty Cash Vouchers	Accounts, Admin	1. Underpayment or overpayment of casual staff 2. Timesheets not validated before processing 3. Payment delayed beyond the schedule 4. Hours worked not reconciled	1. Validate timesheets and hours worked before processing 2. Process payment within the agreed schedule 3. Reconcile hours against the attendance register 4. Retain payment records for audit	Weekly or monthly
9	End of engagement and feedback	Exit Form, Feedback Notes	Admin, Supervisor	1. No record of the casual staff's experience or issues 2. Exit debrief skipped 3. Feedback not documented 4. Lessons not carried forward to future hires	1. Conduct a short debrief and collect feedback 2. Complete the exit form for every casual engagement 3. Document feedback notes for future reference 4. Apply lessons learned to improve future hiring	Last day of engagement

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SOP 39: Staff Housing Allocation

Purpose: To ensure staff housing is allocated fairly, transparently and in a well-documented manner, from identification of available units through to periodic inspection and eventual exit.
Scope: Applies to Housing Chairman, Housing Committee, Admin, Staff and HOC. Covers the process from identifying available housing units through to exit clearance for vacating staff.

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Identify available housing units	Housing Inventory Register	Housing Chairman	1. Inaccurate information on available houses 2. Inventory not updated after a unit becomes vacant 3. Physical verification skipped 4. Register accessible to unauthorised persons	1. Regularly update and physically verify housing inventory 2. Update the register immediately after any change 3. Conduct a physical walk-through periodically 4. Restrict access to the register to authorised staff	Monthly or as need arises
2	Communicate housing application process to staff	Housing Policy, Application Forms	Housing Chairman	1. Lack of awareness among staff of the process 2. Application forms not readily available 3. Communication reaching only some staff 4. Deadlines not clearly stated	1. Use clear communication via email, WhatsApp, and staff meetings 2. Make application forms readily accessible 3. Ensure communication reaches all eligible staff 4. State application deadlines clearly	At the start of each term or when vacancies arise
3	Receive and record housing applications	Housing Application Forms, Application Register	Housing Chairman	1. Loss or misplacement of applications 2. Applications recorded inconsistently 3. Register not maintained securely 4. Receipt of application not acknowledged	1. Maintain secure, centralized records 2. Log every application immediately upon receipt 3. Restrict access to the application register 4. Acknowledge receipt of each application to the applicant	Within 7 days of application submission
4	Vet applications based on eligibility criteria	Housing Policy, Staff Records	Housing Committee	1. Perception of favouritism or bias 2. Eligibility criteria applied inconsistently 3. Vetting decisions not documented 4. Committee members with conflicts of interest not excluded	1. Use transparent criteria and panel decision-making 2. Apply eligibility criteria consistently to all applicants 3. Document vetting decisions and reasoning 4. Exclude committee members with a conflict of interest	Within 14 days of application deadline
5	Allocate housing and communicate outcome	Allocation Letters, Housing Agreements	Housing Committee	1. Disputes or dissatisfaction over allocation 2. Outcome communicated verbally only 3. Allocation letter issued without clear reasoning 4. Unsuccessful applicants not informed promptly	1. Provide written communication with clear reasons 2. Issue a formal allocation letter to successful applicants 3. Inform unsuccessful applicants promptly and respectfully 4. Retain a copy of all communication for reference	Within 7 days after vetting process
6	Staff accept and sign housing agreement	Housing Checking Form	Staff, HOC, Housing Chairman	1. Misunderstandings on terms of occupancy 2. Agreement signed without an orientation session 3. Terms not explained clearly to the staff member 4. Signed agreement not filed	1. Hold an orientation session before signing 2. Ensure the agreement documentation is fully signed 3. Explain all terms clearly before signature 4. File the signed agreement in the staff housing record	Before occupancy date
7	Handover of house and inventory check	House Handover Checklist	Admin, Housing Chairman	1. Missing or damaged items not documented 2. Handover conducted by only one party 3. Checklist not signed by both	1. Conduct a joint inspection with checklist signed by both parties 2. Document all items and their condition at handover 3. Ensure both parties sign the	On occupancy date

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
				parties 4. Inventory discrepancies discovered too late	completed checklist 4. Resolve any discrepancy before finalising the handover	
8	Periodic inspection and maintenance reporting	Maintenance Request Forms, Inspection Reports	Admin	1. Undetected damages accumulating over time 2. Delayed maintenance response to reported issues 3. Inspections skipped due to scheduling conflicts 4. Inspection reports not filed	1. Conduct scheduled inspections consistently 2. Maintain a responsive maintenance process 3. Reschedule promptly if an inspection is missed 4. File inspection reports for each housing unit	Quarterly or as need arises
9	Exit clearance for vacating staff	Exit Clearance Form, Final Inspection Checklist	Staff, Admin, Housing Chairman	1. Property damage or disputes on handover 2. Final inspection skipped or rushed 3. Deposit deductions not clearly justified 4. Clearance delayed beyond the exit date	1. Conduct a final inspection and document any damages 2. Deduct any justified cost from the deposit with clear reasoning 3. Complete the final inspection before the exit date 4. Communicate clearance outcomes in writing to the staff member	Upon notice of vacating

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SOP 40: Staff Housing Clearance

Purpose: To ensure a consistent, well-documented clearance process for staff vacating school housing, protecting both the institution's property and the departing staff member's interests.
Scope: Applies to Staff Member, Housing Chairman, Administrator, Works Officer and HOC. Covers the process from submission of exit notice through to updating of housing records.

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Staff submits notice of exit or housing clearance request	Clearance Request Form	Staff Member	1. Delays in initiating the clearance process 2. Request submitted with insufficient notice 3. Notice submitted verbally without documentation 4. Request lacking key departure details	1. Require staff to submit the request at least one month in advance 2. Ensure the request is submitted in writing on the form 3. Confirm receipt of the request promptly 4. Capture all key departure details on the form	At least 1 month before exit
2	Inspection of allocated housing unit	Housing Inspection Checklist	Housing Chairman / Administrator / Works Officer	1. Missed damages or incomplete inspection 2. Inspection conducted without the staff member present 3. Checklist not covering all rooms/fixtures 4. Inspection delayed beyond target window	1. Use a detailed checklist and conduct a joint inspection 2. Ensure the staff member is present during inspection 3. Cover all rooms and fixtures on the checklist 4. Complete inspection within the target timeframe	Within 3 days of request
3	Documentation of damages or outstanding repairs	Housing Damage Report	Works Officer	1. Disputes over the condition of the house 2. Damage report incomplete or inaccurate 3. No photographic evidence taken 4. Report not shared with the staff member	1. Use photo evidence and joint verification with staff 2. Ensure the report is complete and accurate 3. Share the damage report with the staff member for agreement 4. Retain photographic evidence for the record	Immediately after inspection
4	Staff addresses identified damages or outstanding issues	Repair Receipts or Payment Proof	Staff Member	1. Staff refusal to address identified damages 2. Repairs not completed within the agreed timeframe 3. Liabilities not communicated clearly upfront 4. Payment proof not retained	1. Clearly communicate liabilities upfront 2. Involve HR to follow up on non-compliance 3. Set a firm deadline for addressing damages 4. Retain copies of repair receipts or payment proof	Within 5 days of inspection
5	Final clearance inspection, filling of staff gate pass	Clearance Inspection Form, Staff Gate Pass	HOC, Housing Chairman, Administrator, Works Officer	1. Overlooked issues causing delayed clearance 2. Gate pass missing or not issued in time 3. Final inspection conducted without all required parties 4. Clearance form incomplete	1. Use the standard clearance form and involve HR if needed 2. Ensure the gate pass is prepared ahead of the exit day 3. Coordinate all required parties for the final inspection 4. Verify the clearance form is fully completed	Within 2 days of staff repairs / 2 days before the day of exit
6	Clearance confirmation and return of keys	Housing Clearance Form; Key Handover Form	Works Officer	1. Loss of keys or disputes over handover 2. Key handover not documented 3. Clearance confirmed without keys returned 4. Handover form not signed by both parties	1. Document the key handover with signatures 2. Confirm all keys are accounted for before clearance 3. Withhold final clearance until keys are returned 4. Ensure both parties sign the key handover form	On the day of exit or agreed date
7	Update housing records and	Updated Housing Allocation	Housing Chairman	1. House left vacant for a prolonged period 2. Housing records not updated	1. Ensure timely updates to housing records 2. Communicate availability to the	Within 2 days after clearance

No.	Activity/How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	reallocate house if applicable	Register		promptly 3. Availability not communicated to prospective applicants 4. Register showing inaccurate occupancy status	housing waiting list promptly 3. Update the register within the target timeframe 4. Verify occupancy status matches the physical situation	

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SECTION H: TRANSPORT & VEHICLES

SOP 41: Vehicle Handover

Purpose: To ensure a documented and accountable handover of school vehicles between the school and drivers for every trip, protecting vehicle condition and ensuring accurate usage records.
Scope: Applies to Requesting Staff, HOC, Driver, Admin, and Transport Manager. Covers the process from vehicle request through to final sign-off and log update.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Request for vehicle use	Vehicle Request Form, Trip Schedule	Requesting Staff Member	1. Miscommunication or lack of availability 2. Request submitted with insufficient notice 3. Request not logged in the vehicle movement system 4. Trip details incomplete on the form	1. Ensure the request is made in advance and logged in the vehicle movement system 2. Require at least 24 hours' notice for requests 3. Confirm vehicle availability before submission 4. Capture complete trip details on the form	At least 24 hours prior
2	Approval of request	Approved Trip Schedule, Authorization Log	HOC	1. Unauthorized trips being conducted 2. Approval delayed beyond the target window 3. Request approved without checking the schedule 4. Authorization log not updated	1. Verify request aligns with the school schedule and authorize formally 2. Process approvals within the target timeframe 3. Cross-check against the trip schedule before approving 4. Update the authorization log immediately	Within 12 hours of request
3	Pre-handover inspection (condition check)	Vehicle Condition Checklist	Driver, Admin, Transport Manager	1. Missed faults or pre-existing damage 2. Inspection rushed before departure 3. Checklist not fully completed 4. Fuel level not verified before handover	1. Use a checklist to verify lights, fuel, tires, scratches, etc. 2. Allow adequate time for a thorough inspection 3. Ensure the checklist is fully completed and signed 4. Confirm fuel level before handover	Immediately before handover
4	Handover to driver	Vehicle Handover Form	Administrator/Transport In-charge	1. Inaccurate documentation of the handover 2. Handover form not signed by both parties 3. Vehicle handed over without confirming the pre-inspection 4. Handover details inconsistent with the request	1. Confirm the handover by ensuring both parties sign the form 2. Cross-check the handover against the pre-inspection checklist 3. Verify handover details match the approved request 4. Retain a copy of the signed handover form	At time of handover
5	Fuel and documentation check	Logbook, Insurance, Fuel Card	Driver	1. Lack of valid documentation or fuel 2. Insurance documents expired or missing 3. Logbook not present in the vehicle 4. Fuel card not available for the trip	1. Ensure the driver confirms possession of all required documents 2. Verify insurance validity before departure 3. Confirm the logbook is present in the vehicle 4. Check fuel card availability before the trip	Before trip commencement
6	Post-trip vehicle return and inspection	Return Condition Checklist	Driver, Administrator, Transport Manager	1. Undetected new damage or low fuel 2. Return inspection skipped or rushed 3. Discrepancies not compared against the pre-handover form 4. Refuelling not confirmed	1. Check and compare the vehicle against the pre-handover form 2. Refuel if needed before completing the return 3. Conduct the return inspection without delay 4. Document any new damage found at return	Immediately upon return
7	Final sign-off and log update	Vehicle Movement Log, Mileage Book	Admin	1. Misreporting or record gaps 2. Mileage not recorded accurately 3. Log update delayed beyond the	1. Ensure all trip details are recorded (date, time, kilometres, etc.) 2. Complete the log update the same day as return	Same day of return

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
				same day 4. Sign-off completed without full trip details	3. Verify mileage entries against the odometer 4. Confirm sign-off only after full details are recorded	

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SOP 42: Vehicle Repair and Maintenance

Purpose: To ensure all MSIS vehicles are maintained in a roadworthy, safe and compliant condition through a systematic reporting, approval, repair and follow-up process.
Scope: Applies to Drivers, Mechanics, Supervisor/Transport Manager, HOC/Admin, Procurement Officer and Accountant. Covers the process from reporting a vehicle issue through to post-repair follow-up.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Report vehicle issue	Vehicle Issue Report Form/Logbook /Job Card/Vehicle Repair Book	Driver	1. Incomplete or unclear report submitted 2. Report delayed beyond the target window 3. Issue reported verbally without documentation 4. Urgency of the issue not indicated	1. Use a structured reporting format 2. Train staff on issue reporting standards 3. Ensure every report is documented on the form/logbook 4. Indicate the urgency level on every report	Within 24 hours of issue
2	Preliminary vehicle inspection	Inspection Checklist using the Job Card	Mechanic/Driver/Supervisor/Transport Manager	1. Misdiagnosis or missed issues 2. Inspection conducted without a checklist 3. No second opinion sought for complex issues 4. Inspection findings not recorded on the job card	1. Use a standardized checklist 2. Seek a second opinion if needed 3. Record all findings on the job card 4. Cross-check findings against the driver's report	Within 1 day
3	Approval for repair	Repair Request Form; Budget Approval Sheet	HOC/ Admin	1. Delayed approval affecting vehicle availability 2. Overlooked costs in the approval process 3. Approval granted without checking the budget sheet 4. Approval workflow bypassed for urgent repairs	1. Use pre-approved thresholds and a clear approval workflow 2. Review the budget approval sheet before signing off 3. Fast-track approval for urgent, safety-critical repairs 4. Log every approval decision for accountability	Within 1 day
4	Sourcing parts	Parts Requisition List; Supplier Contacts	Procurement Officer, Accountant	1. Wrong or poor-quality parts sourced 2. Parts sourced from an unapproved supplier 3. Requisition list incomplete 4. Delays due to unavailable parts	1. Use an approved supplier list 2. Verify parts against the requisition list before purchase 3. Confirm part availability before finalising the order 4. Identify an alternative supplier for hard-to-find parts	Within 1 day
5	Conducting repair	Repair Tools, Spare Parts, Repair Manual	Qualified Mechanic	1. Injury during the repair process 2. Poor workmanship affecting vehicle safety 3. Repair manual not followed 4. Quality control checks skipped	1. Use PPE and follow the manufacturer repair guide 2. Ensure the mechanic is appropriately qualified 3. Conduct quality control checks during the repair 4. Follow the repair manual step by step	Depending on issue (1–7 days)
6	Quality check & testing	Test Drive Checklist	Mechanic/Driver	1. Incomplete repair going undetected 2. Recurrence of the same issue 3. Test drive skipped or rushed 4. Observations from the test drive not recorded	1. Test all relevant systems post-repair 2. Record observations on the test drive checklist 3. Ensure the test drive covers the reported issue specifically 4. Sign off only after a satisfactory test result	Same day as repair completion
7	Recording repair and updating log	Vehicle Maintenance Logbook	Driver	1. Loss of maintenance history 2. Logbook not updated immediately after repair 3. Entries inconsistent across vehicles 4. Records not available for audit	1. Conduct routine audits of the maintenance logbook 2. Update the logbook immediately after every repair 3. Standardise entries across all vehicles 4. Make records available for periodic audit	Immediately after repair

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
8	Communicate vehicle readiness to user	Notification Record or Notification Log	Admin/Mechanic	1. Delay or confusion over vehicle availability 2. Readiness communicated informally only 3. Usage schedule not updated after the repair 4. User not notified in writing	1. Confirm readiness in writing and update the usage schedule 2. Notify the original requester promptly 3. Update the notification log immediately 4. Confirm the vehicle is available before releasing it	Same day of completion
9	Follow-up after repair (feedback/monitoring)	Vehicle Maintenance Logbook	Driver/Transport Manager	1. Recurrence of an undetected problem 2. Driver feedback not collected after the repair 3. Monitoring period skipped 4. Follow-up findings not logged	1. Monitor the vehicle for 1 week post-repair 2. Encourage driver feedback after the repair 3. Log any follow-up findings in the maintenance logbook 4. Escalate any recurrence immediately to the mechanic	1–7 days after repair

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SECTION I: SECURITY

SOP 43: Security Guard Handover

Purpose: To ensure a consistent, documented and accountable handover process between outgoing and incoming security guards at every shift change, safeguarding continuity of security coverage.
Scope: Applies to Incoming Guards, Outgoing Guards, and the Supervisor. Covers the handover process from arrival of the incoming guard through to supervisor confirmation.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Arrival of incoming guard	Duty Roster	Incoming Guard	1. Delay in reporting for shift 2. Guard arrives without checking the duty roster 3. No coverage gap plan if a guard is late 4. Late arrival not logged	1. Enforce punctuality for all shift changes 2. Maintain a sign-in record for every guard 3. Arrange relief coverage in case of a delay 4. Log any late arrival with the reason given	10 minutes before shift
2	Briefing of current situation	Guard Handover Logbook	Outgoing Guard	1. Incomplete information passed to the incoming guard 2. Key incidents omitted from the briefing 3. Briefing rushed due to time pressure 4. Verbal briefing not backed by the logbook	1. Use a checklist to ensure all areas are covered 2. Reference the logbook throughout the briefing 3. Allow adequate time for a full handover briefing 4. Require the incoming guard to confirm understanding	At start of the shift
3	Inspection of duty post and premises	Torch, Checklist, Security Tools	Incoming Guard with Outgoing Guard	1. Missed anomalies during inspection 2. Inspection conducted by only one guard 3. Poorly lit areas not properly checked 4. Inspection findings not recorded	1. Conduct a joint inspection before acceptance 2. Use a torch and checklist to cover all areas 3. Pay particular attention to poorly lit or remote points 4. Record inspection findings before sign-off	10–15 minutes
4	Handover of keys and access items	Key Register	Outgoing Guard	1. Loss or misplacement of keys 2. Handover of keys not documented 3. Key register not countersigned 4. Access items handed over incomplete	1. Ensure proper documentation and countersigning 2. Verify all keys and access items against the register 3. Require both guards to sign the key register 4. Report any missing item immediately to the Supervisor	During the shift change
5	Reporting logged incidents	Occurrence Book, Incident Report Form	Outgoing Guard	1. Hidden or unreported incidents 2. Incident report incomplete or inaccurate 3. Verification of incidents not carried out 4. Incident details lost between shifts	1. Conduct random verification by the Supervisor 2. Ensure all incidents are logged in the occurrence book 3. Require full details on every incident report form 4. Review incident reports at the start of the next shift	During briefing
6	Checking of security equipment	Radios, Whistles, Lights, CCTV Status	Incoming Guard	1. Non-functional tools not identified before shift starts 2. Faults not reported promptly 3. Equipment shortage not flagged 4. CCTV status not verified	1. Conduct daily checks of all security equipment 2. Log faults immediately upon discovery 3. Report equipment shortages to the Supervisor 4. Confirm CCTV is operational before shift starts	Start of shift
7	Signing off handover	Handover Logbook	Both Guards	1. Disputes later over what was handed over	1. Ensure the log is signed by both guards and the Supervisor, where applicable	Upon completion of

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
	log			2. Log signed without full review 3. Supervisor sign-off skipped where required 4. Handover log illegible or incomplete	2. Review the completed log before signing 3. Require Supervisor sign-off for all shift changes 4. Keep the handover log clear and complete	the handover
8	Supervisor confirmation (optional)	Duty Roster, Handover Log	Supervisor	1. Improper handover going undetected 2. Spot checks conducted too infrequently 3. Supervisor confirmation skipped altogether 4. Audit findings not followed up	1. Conduct spot checks and random audits 2. Confirm the handover log against the duty roster 3. Schedule regular supervisor confirmations 4. Follow up on any audit finding promptly	Within 30 minutes of the handover

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SECTION J: STORES, PROCUREMENT & WASTE MANAGEMENT

SOP 44: Receiving and Issuing

Purpose: To ensure all deliveries of goods to MSIS are received, inspected, verified and stored correctly, and that discrepancies are identified and reported promptly.
Scope: Applies to Cateress, Storekeeper, Chef and Kitchen staff. Covers the process from scheduling delivery times through to reporting discrepancies with suppliers.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Schedule delivery time	Delivery Schedule	Cateress / Storekeeper	1. Delays or disruption to service 2. Deliveries arriving during peak hours 3. Schedule not agreed with the supplier 4. Multiple suppliers arriving simultaneously	1. Agree on delivery times with suppliers to avoid peak hours 2. Schedule off-peak hours for deliveries 3. Confirm the schedule with suppliers in advance 4. Stagger delivery times across suppliers	Daily / As needed
2	Inspect delivery vehicle	Inspection Log	Storekeeper / Receiver	1. Contamination from an unclean vehicle 2. Cold chain broken during transport 3. Inspection skipped due to time pressure 4. Findings not logged	1. Check cleanliness and temperature (for cold trucks) 2. Reject the delivery if the vehicle is unclean 3. Record findings in the inspection log 4. Verify temperature control equipment is functioning	On arrival
3	Verify delivery documentation	Purchase Order, Delivery Note	Storekeeper/ Cateress	1. Wrong items delivered against the order 2. Documentation not matched carefully 3. Delivery note missing or incomplete 4. Discrepancies not flagged before acceptance	1. Match the delivery note/invoice to the purchase order 2. Review documents carefully before accepting the delivery 3. Flag any mismatch immediately 4. Retain copies of all delivery documentation	During receiving
4	Inspect items visually	Receiving Checklist	Storekeeper / Chef	1. Accepting poor-quality items 2. Damage or spoilage not identified 3. Packaging integrity not checked 4. Inspection rushed	1. Check for damage, spoilage, and packaging integrity 2. Reject damaged or spoiled goods 3. Use the receiving checklist for every delivery 4. Allow adequate time for a thorough inspection	Immediately on receipt
5	Check weights and counts	Scale, Counting Log	Storekeeper	1. Short deliveries not identified 2. Scale not calibrated correctly 3. Counts not verified against the order 4. Discrepancies not documented	1. Use a scale or count items to confirm quantities 2. Document discrepancies and report to the supplier 3. Verify scale calibration periodically 4. Cross-check counts against the purchase order	Immediately on receipt
6	Temperature check (perishables)	Temperature Log	Storekeeper / Chef	1. Food safety risk from items outside safe limits 2. Temperature not measured consistently 3. Log not maintained for every delivery 4. Unsafe items accepted despite reading	1. Measure and record temperature of chilled/frozen items 2. Reject items outside safe limits 3. Maintain the temperature log for every delivery 4. Escalate unsafe readings to the Cateress immediately	Immediately on receipt
7	Accept or reject delivery	Delivery Note, Return Log	Storekeeper / Chef	1. Disputes with the supplier over rejected items 2. Delivery note signed without full inspection 3. Rejected items not documented	1. Sign the delivery note only for accepted items 2. Clearly document all rejections in the return log 3. Ensure inspection is complete before	Immediately on receipt

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
				4. Return log not updated	signing 4. Communicate rejection reasons to the supplier	
8	Label and date items	Labelling System	Storekeeper / Kitchen	1. Stock rotation issues from missing labels 2. Expiry dates not marked 3. Labelling inconsistent across items 4. Items mixed with older stock unlabelled	1. Mark items with delivery date and expiry date if applicable (FIFO) 2. Apply labelling consistently for every item 3. Store labelled items separately from unlabelled stock 4. Check labels during routine stock checks	After acceptance
9	Store items properly	Storage Log	Storekeeper / Kitchen	1. Spoilage or contamination from incorrect storage 2. Items left out before storage 3. Storage guidelines not followed 4. Storage log not updated	1. Move items to the correct storage area immediately (cold store, dry store, etc.) 2. Follow storage guidelines for each item type 3. Update the storage log immediately after storing 4. Avoid delays between receipt and storage	Immediately after check
10	Record in inventory	Inventory Log / System	Storekeeper	1. Inventory inaccuracy affecting stock counts 2. Entries not double-checked 3. Recording delayed after storing 4. System not updated consistently	1. Update stock records/inventory management system promptly 2. Double-check entries for accuracy 3. Record inventory immediately after storing 4. Reconcile inventory periodically against physical stock	After storing
11	Report discrepancies	Discrepancy Report	Storekeeper / Chef	1. Repeat errors from the same supplier 2. Discrepancies not communicated promptly 3. Report not documented formally 4. No follow-up on reported issues	1. Notify the supplier/management of issues with the delivery (quantity, quality, etc.) the same day 2. Maintain timely communication with the supplier 3. Document every discrepancy on the discrepancy report 4. Follow up to confirm the issue is resolved	Same day as delivery

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SOP 45: Waste Recycling and Disposal Process

Purpose: To ensure all waste generated at MSIS is collected, sorted, stored, and disposed of or sold responsibly and transparently, in compliance with approved procedures and financial controls.
Scope: Applies to Support Staff, Store Keeper, Works Officer, Procurement Officer, Accountant, Admin, HOC and Directors. Covers the process from waste collection through to record keeping and reporting.

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
1	Collection of waste materials	Waste Collection Log	All Support Staff	1. Mixing recyclable items with general waste 2. Injury from sharp or hazardous waste 3. Collection log not maintained 4. Waste left uncollected for extended periods	1. Provide separate bins for paper, plastics, and metals 2. Use gloves and proper handling techniques 3. Maintain the waste collection log daily 4. Schedule regular collection rounds throughout the day	Daily – all the time
2	Temporary storage in the designated waste area	Waste Storage Records	Store Keeper	1. Theft of recyclable materials 2. Fire hazard from paper waste 3. Pest infestation in the storage area 4. Storage records not updated	1. Lock the storage area with controlled access 2. Keep the storage area dry and well-ventilated 3. Conduct regular pest control checks 4. Update waste storage records continuously	Continuous
3	Sorting	Sorting & Weighing Record	Works Officer/ Store Keeper	1. Incorrect sorting leading to contamination of recyclables 2. Wrong weight recorded for sorted materials 3. Untrained staff conducting sorting 4. Sorting delayed beyond term end	1. Train staff on proper sorting 2. Use calibrated weighing scales 3. Assign sorting to trained personnel only 4. Complete sorting within the planned timeframe	End term or as the need arises
4	Contact at least three vendors for quotations	Quotations	Procureme nt Officer	1. Limited competition leading to low sale price 2. Quotations obtained from unlicensed vendors 3. Vendor list outdated 4. Quotation comparison not documented	1. Maintain an updated list of licensed vendors 2. Request at least three competitive quotations 3. Document the comparison of quotations received 4. Verify vendor licensing before engagement	Within three days after sorting approval
5	Preparation of disposal/ sale request	Proposal for Disposal	Store Keeper	1. Incomplete documentation in the disposal request 2. Overlooking valuable recyclable materials 3. Quantities not verified before submission 4. Proposal not aligned with the sorting record	1. Use a standardized disposal request form 2. Verify quantities before submission 3. Cross-check the proposal against the sorting record 4. Flag any valuable materials for separate consideration	Within one week after sorting
6	Approval by HOC (Head of Centre)	Approved Disposal Request	HOC	1. Delay in approval affecting the sale timeline 2. Approval granted without reviewing quotations 3. Approval process bypassed 4. Approved request not communicated promptly	1. Set clear approval timelines (max 3 days) 2. Review quotations before granting approval 3. Follow the approval process without exception 4. Communicate the approved request promptly to procurement	Within 3 days of request
7	Approval by Directors	Director Approval Record	Directors	1. Delay in final authorization 2. Unapproved request proceeding to sale 3. Directors not notified with full information 4. Approval record not maintained	1. Notify Directors promptly with quotation comparison sheet 2. Ensure no sale proceeds without director approval 3. Provide full information to support quick decision-making	Within 5 days of receiving quotations

No.	Activity/ How	Documents/ Resources	Who	Risk	Risk Mitigation	Timeline
					4. Maintain a record of every director approval	
8	Sale to selected recycling vendor	Sales Receipt/Delivery Document	Procurement Officer/Store Keeper	1. Underpayment or fraud during the sale 2. Delay in payment from the vendor 3. Sale conducted without an approved vendor 4. Sales receipt not issued	1. Have the Accountant confirm payment 2. Ensure payment is made before the materials are released 3. Sell only to the vendor approved by the Directors 4. Issue a sales receipt for every transaction	Same day of sale
9	Weighing and preparation of delivery document after sale	Delivery Document	Store Keeper	1. Materials released before payment confirmation 2. Omissions in the delivery document 3. Weight discrepancies between sorting and delivery 4. Delivery document not signed by the vendor	1. Confirm with the Accountant that payment has been received before release 2. Cross-check delivery weight against the sorting record 3. Ensure the delivery document is complete 4. Obtain the vendor's signature on the delivery document	Immediately after payment confirmation
10	Record keeping and reporting	Waste Disposal & Sales Report	Accountant /Admin	1. Missing records of the transaction 2. Delay in reporting the sale 3. Report not reconciled with the sales receipt 4. Records not backed up	1. Maintain both digital and hard copy records 2. Ensure the report is submitted the same day 3. Reconcile the report against the sales receipt 4. Keep a digital backup of all disposal records	Same day of sale

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